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NATIONAL & STATES AFFAIRS

News - 1

- PPPAC granted in-principle approval for privatisation of operations, management & development of 11 AAI airports
  - Through Public-Private Partnership (PPP) route | Total private investment – ₹8,622 Cr
- Public Private Partnership Appraisal Committee (PPPAC) – chaired by Anuradha Thakur (Secretary, DEA, MoF)
- Airports will be offered in 5 bundles (with investment):
  - Amritsar (Punjab) with Kangra-Gaggal (Himachal Pradesh) – ₹523 Cr
  - Varanasi (Uttar Pradesh) with Gaya (Bihar) & Kushinagar (Uttar Pradesh) – ₹2,467 Cr
  - Bhubaneswar (Odisha) with Hubballi (Karnataka) – ₹2,725 Cr
  - Raipur (Chhattisgarh) with Aurangabad (Maharashtra) – ₹1,496 Cr
  - Tiruchirappalli (Tamil Nadu) with Tirupati (Andhra Pradesh) – ₹1,411 Cr
- HQs of AAI – New Delhi | Chairman – Vipin Kumar

News - 2

- WAE Ltd – joined "United Nations Global Compact Network India", Indian Local Network of UN Global Compact
- By joining UNGCNI, WAE commits to advancing Ten Principles of United Nations Global Compact
- HQs of WAE Limited – Noida, UP | Founder & CEO – Anupam V Joshie | Established in – 2008

News - 3

- IICT + Netflix = announced scholarships for 100 students, offering up to 80% financial support across 6 professional programmes, comprising 2 one-year diploma programmes & 4 six-month certificate programmes
  - Supported by – Netflix Fund for Creative Equity
- 6 programmes are: Diplomas in Interactive Comics & Sequential Arts and Visual Effects Mastery
  - Certificates in Virtual Art Department Content Creation, Media Tech Workflow, Art of Character Animation, and E-Sports & Gaming Management
- HQs of IICT – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO – Dr. Vishwas Deoskar | Established in – 2025
- HQs of Netflix – Los Gatos, California, USA | Co-CEOs – Ted Sarandos & Greg Peters | Executive Chairman – Reed Hastings | Established in – 1997

News - 4

- DGFT – relaxed 'One Star Export House' eligibility condition, revising export performance criteria applicable across 3 consecutive financial years
- Now, export firms reporting required performance in any 2 of 3 preceding FYs will now be eligible to receive recognition
- This relaxation does not apply to gems & jewellery sector
  - It already operates under a separate 2-year requirement under Foreign Trade Policy (FTP) 2023
- Exporters holding a valid Importer-Exporter Code (IEC) can apply to DGFT for recognition as One Star, Two Star, Three Star, Four Star or Five Star Export House, based on their export performance
  - Certificates generally valid for 5 years from date of issue once granted
- HQs of DGFT – New Delhi | Director General – Lav Aggarwal | Established in – 1991

News - 5

- Mizoram – currently has 79 monuments & archaeological sites declared as 'State Protected Monuments'
  - under 'Mizoram Ancient Monuments and Archaeological Sites and Remains Act, 2001'
- 2 sites in Champhai district – recognised as 'Monuments of National Importance' by ASI
  - Kawtchhuah Ropui & Ralven Puk at Vangchhia village | Lianpui Hmun (Lungphun Ropui) at Lianpui village
- Mizoram Government – proposed 4 additional heritage sites for protected monument status, including Ruhro Puk in Saitual district
- Vangchhia heritage site – ₹5.2 Cr allocated for infrastructure development
- Mizoram: Capital – Aizawl | CM – Lalduhoma | Governor – General V. K. Singh

News - 6

- BIS expanded its Hallmark Unique Identification (HUID)-based silver hallmarking network to 341 centres across 102 districts nationwide, with more than 25,000 registered silver jewellers now part of ecosystem
- From Sep 1, 2025, BIS made HUID marking mandatory for any silver article that is hallmarked
  - Under revised IS 2112:2025 standard
- HUID – a 6-digit alphanumeric code laser-marked on each hallmarked silver article
  - Alongside BIS Standard Mark, word "SILVER" & purity grade
- Region leading the country in hallmarking volume – Southern Region (62%)
  - Followed by – Western Region (18%) & Central Region (10%)
- HQs of BIS – Manek Bhawan, Old Delhi | Director General – Sanjay Garg

News - 7

- G. Kishan Reddy – launched "Critical Minerals Innovation Hackathon 2026 (CMiH 2026)"
  - To strengthen objectives of National Critical Mineral Mission
  - It will be organised & hosted by – Jawaharlal Nehru Aluminium Research Development & Design Centre, Nagpur
- It will focus on 2 problem statements:
  - 'Mineral Prospectivity Mapping from Open Data'
  - 'Smart Technology and Patent Tracker for Critical Minerals'
- Last date for idea submission – Sep 20, 2026
  - Winners will be announced during India Mining Week 2026, scheduled from Nov 15-17, 2026
- 2 winning teams will be awarded prizes for each problem statement
  - 1st prize – ₹1.50 lakh | 2nd prize – ₹1 lakh
- Minister of Coal & Mines: G. Kishan Reddy | Constituency – Secunderabad, Telangana

  MoS in Ministry of Coal & Mines: Satish Chandra Dubey

News - 8

- National Shipping Board (NSB) – held its 1st "Sagar Samvad", using day-long dialogue to press for a five-pillar roadmap
  - Theme – "Charting the Roadmap Towards Maritime India Vision 2030" & "Maritime Amrit Kaal Vision 2047"
  - It was held at – Civil Services Officers Institute, New Delhi
- India currently pays close to $75 billion every year to foreign shipping lines to move critical cargo
- HQs of NSB – New Delhi | Chairperson – Sameer Kumar Khare | Established in – 1959

News - 9

- Department of Legal Affairs – notified establishment of 'Mediation Council of India (MCI)'
  - Council's head office will be located in Delhi
- Under Section 31(2) of Act, MCI is constituted as a body corporate with perpetual succession & a common seal, empowered to acquire, hold & dispose of property & to sue or be sued in its own name
- MoS (I/C) in Ministry of Law & Justice: Arjun Ram Meghwal | Constituency – Bikaner, Rajasthan

News - 10

- India secured 'dialogue partner' status in "Global Combat Air Programme (GCAP)"
  - It is 6th-generation fighter jet programme jointly run by UK, Japan & Italy
- GCAP received $6.1 billion in funding in Jul 2026 to advance its full-scale design phase, with induction planned by 2034
- GCAP's industrial backbone, a JV called 'Edgewing', is equally held by BAE Systems (UK), Leonardo (Italy) & Mitsubishi Heavy Industries (Japan), each with a 33.3% stake
- Canada joined GCAP in Jul 2026 as its first observer nation

- India is separately developing its own 5th-generation "Advanced Medium Combat Aircraft (AMCA)"
  - It is expected to join Indian Air Force by 2035

News - 11

- Hindalco Industries – commissioned India's first greenfield Superfine PPT ATH (Precipitated Aluminium Trihydrate) manufacturing plant at Belagavi, Karnataka
  - It marks country's first domestic production of this high-value specialty alumina material
- Phase 1 facility has an annual production capacity of 30,000 tonnes
- This plant is also world's only specialty alumina facility to operate entirely on renewable energy
- Superfine PPT ATH – a halogen-free flame-retardant material used in Halogen-Free Flame Retardant (HFFR) cables, polymer insulators, thermal insulation, composites & paints
- HQs of Hindalco Industries – Mumbai, MH | Chairman – Kumar Mangalam Birla | Established in – 1958

News - 12

- NCCE (DGHS) – finalised India's 1st uniform minimum national standards for mortuary & post-mortem infrastructure
  - Anchored in 'Clinical Establishments (Registration and Regulation) Act, 2010'
  - Applicable to public & private hospitals in States & UTs that have adopted this Act
- Now, mortuaries are prohibited from being located in basements or near hospital waste disposal & dumping areas
  - They must be built on ground floor, with segregated entry points for body movement separate from general hospital patient traffic
- Dead-body cold storage units must maintain a temperature range of 4°C to 8°C
  - Minimum storage capacity – four bodies
  - Each body must be assigned a unique serial number on its storage cabin for traceability
  - Medico-legal case bodies must be stored separately from non-medico-legal remains
- It also prescribes a dedicated autopsy block of about 4,000 square feet

News - 13

- Dr. Jitendra Singh – launched 5th edition of "Swachh Sagar, Surakshit Sagar 2026" (SSSS v5.0) in New Delhi
  - It is a week-long nationwide coastal cleanliness & ocean conservation campaign
  - Led by – Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES) | It will run from Sep 12 to 19, 2026
  - Organised under "Jan Bhagidari" (people's participation) framework
- Govt unveiled 'SSSS 5.0' website, ocean conservation pledge, an introductory video & an activity schedule
  - Alongside 'SAGAR PRAHARI' app for citizen participation
- Swachh Sagar, Surakshit Sagar – originally launched by MoES in 2022 as a 75-day citizen-led coastal clean-up campaign
  - It has been described as world's 1st & longest-running coastal cleanup campaign of its kind
- MoS (I/C) in Earth Sciences: Dr. Jitendra Singh | Constituency – Udhampur, J&K

News - 14

- CARA (MoWCD) – launched theme for 'Adoption Awareness 2026' – "Legal Adoption. Safe Childhood. Secure Future. Say No to Illegal Adoption!"
- CARA & DoWCD (Delhi) – to organise an Adoption Awareness Workshop on Sep 10, 2026, at Delhi Secretariat
- CARA – a statutory body established under Section 68 of Juvenile Justice (Care and Protection of Children) Act, 2015
  - It also serves as India's Central Authority for inter-country adoptions under Hague Convention on Inter-country Adoption, 1993, which India ratified in 2003

News - 15

- C-DOT – unveiled 14 indigenous quantum products during its 43rd Foundation Day celebrations
  - Held at BHIM Hall, Dr. Ambedkar International Centre, New Delhi
- These 14 products span across five categories: Quantum Key Distribution (QKD) hardware systems
  - Post-Quantum Cryptography (PQC)-based encryptors at different network layers & throughput grades
  - Quantum communication sub-components | Endpoint devices | Access infrastructure
- C-DOT also released a "Quantum Product Series" booklet consolidating its indigenous quantum solutions
- HQs of C-DoT – New Delhi | CEO – Rajkumar Upadhyay | C-DoT works under – DoT (Ministry of Communications)

News - 16

- C. P. Radhakrishnan – released "Mission Rangeen Machhli 2031" at a Fisheries Outreach Programme
  - It is a Strategic Action Plan for Ornamental Fisheries Development
  - Programme was organised by – Department of Fisheries, MoFAH&D, in Agatti, Lakshadweep
- Fisheries development projects worth more than ₹62 Cr have been approved for UT under PMMSY & Lakshadweep
  - PMMSY – Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana

News - 17

- Gollala Gudi – declared by ASI as a 'Monument of National Importance' through Gazette Notification
  - Issued under Section 4(3) of Ancient Monuments & Archaeological Sites & Remains Act, 1958
  - It is a Kakatiya-era temple at Palampet village in Mulugu, Telangana
- Gollala Gudi – a Trikutalaya, or three-shrine temple, comprising an east-facing mandapa surrounded by 3 garbhagrihas
- HQs of ASI – New Delhi | Director General – Yadubir Singh Rawat | Established in – 1861

News - 18

- DMRC – became 1st metro organisation in India to receive ISO 55001:2024 certification for its Asset Management System
  - Awarded for its management of Mumbai Metro Line-3, also known as Aqua Line
- ISO 55001:2024 – latest international standard providing a framework for managing physical assets across their entire lifecycle
- DMRC – jointly owned by GoI & Government of Delhi (each holding a 50% stake)
- HQs of DMRC – New Delhi | Chairman – Katikithala Srinivas | MD – Dr. Vikas Kumar | Established in – 1995

News - 19

- Chhattisgarh – ranked 1st nationally in 3rd phase of 'Jal Sanchay Jan Bhagidari (JSJB 3.0)'
  - Chhattisgarh ranked 2nd in both earlier phases
- 5 districts among India's top 10 – Surajpur, Mahasamund, Balod, Balodabazar-Bhatapara & Kabirdham
- Number of water-stressed blocks in Chhattisgarh – declined to 19 (from 26)
- '5 Per Cent Model' (Koriya) – farmers voluntarily set aside ~5% of their agricultural land for rainwater harvesting & groundwater recharge structures
- JSJB – community-participation component of MoJS's 'Catch the Rain' campaign, launched from Gujarat in 2024
- Chhattisgarh: Capital – Raipur | CM – Vishnu Deo Sai | Governor – Ramen Deka

News - 20

- Birkbeck, University of London – received UGC's Letter of Approval to establish & operate a campus in Bengaluru
- Under – UGC's 2023 regulations for Foreign Higher Educational Institutions (FHEIs)
- Campus location – Sattva Tech Park, Bengaluru | Partner – Education Centre of Australia (ECA)
  - It marks Birkbeck's 1st overseas venture
- Courses – UG & PG degrees in business management & business analytics, awarded by University of London

News - 21

- C. Joseph Vijay (TN) – announced 'Tamil Nadu Olympic City' in Chennai & a separate Motor Sports City under Rule 110 of TN Legislative Assembly
- Olympic City – to be developed by Tamil Nadu Sports Development Authority
- Motor Sports City – to have an international-standard racing circuit capable of hosting Formula 1, 2, 3 & 4 events
- Tamil Nadu: Capital – Chennai | CM – C Joseph Vijay | Governor – Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar

News - 22

- Amit Shah – outlined a 3-year roadmap (Jul 2026 - Jul 2029) to make India drug-free by 2029, in Panaji, Goa
- It rests on 4 pillars: Intelligence- & operations-based enforcement | Control of precursor & synthetic drugs
  - Demand & harm reduction | Capacity building & coordination
- It comprises 25 components & 200+ time-bound action points | 2026-2029 – designated as 'mission mode' phase
- Minister of Home Affairs & Cooperation: Amit Shah | Constituency – Gandhinagar, Gujarat
  MoS in Ministry of Home Affairs: Nityanand Rai & Bandi Sanjay Kumar
  MoS in Ministry of Cooperation: Krishan Pal & Murlidhar Mohol

News - 23

- India – submitted 'Rangpur-Sivasagar Historical Ensemble' (Assam) for UNESCO's World Heritage Tentative List under cultural criteria (iii) & (iv)
  - It represents historic capital of Ahom dynasty in Sivasagar district
- Ensemble includes – Rang Ghar, Talatal Ghar, Namdang Stone Bridge & tanks of Sivasagar, Joysagar & Gaurisagar
- Charaideo Moidams (Ahom royal burial mounds) – inscribed as India's 43rd UNESCO World Heritage Site on Jul 26, 2024
- HQs of UNESCO – Paris, France | DG – Khaled El-Enany | Founded in – 1945 | Members – 194 Countries

News - 24

- NITI Aayog – launched two new platforms to scale up electric truck adoption in India
  - At 5th "e-FAST India Summit 2026" in New Delhi
- 1st – 'Platform for Aggregating Clean Transport (PACT)' | 2nd – 'Zero Emission Truck (ZET) Marketplace'
- Electric freight vehicle deployments – rose to 826 in FY26 (from 201 in FY25)
- HQs of NITI Aayog – New Delhi | CEO – Anurag Jain | Chair – Narendra Modi | VC – Ashok Kumar Lahiri

News - 25

- India – joined a global initiative for development & deployment of next-generation 6G telecommunications networks
  - Now, total participating countries – 26 (including UK, Germany & Japan)
- Initiative builds on 'Call to Action for 6G Leadership and Security', launched by US in Jul 2026
  - Led by – National Telecommunications and Information Administration (NTIA), US Department of Commerce
- G20 Innovation Ministers' Meeting – held in Chapel Hill, North Carolina, US
- India's Bharat 6G Mission – targets at least 10% of global 6G patents by 2030

News - 26

- PM Narendra Modi – dedicated ₹73,000 Cr 'Western Dedicated Freight Corridor (DFC)' to the nation
- Western DFC – 1,506 km, connecting Dadri (UP) with JNPA near Mumbai
  - It runs across 5 states – Maharashtra, Gujarat, Rajasthan, Haryana & Uttar Pradesh
  - Financed & supported by – Japan International Cooperation Agency (JICA)
- Final 3 sections – 326 route km, including New Saphale-JNPA stretch
- Eastern DFC – 1,337 km; completed in Oct 2023 at ₹51,000 Cr
- Western + Eastern DFCs = total 2,843 km network, built & operated by DFCCIL | Combined cost – ~₹1.24 lakh Cr
  - It is India's 2nd-largest infrastructure programme after 'Golden Quadrilateral'

News - 27

- Piyush Goyal – set target of 10 million international medical value tourists annually for India
  - Announced at 'Sanjeevani 2026', during 'Bharat Health Global Expo 2026' in New Delhi
- India's clinical care – estimated to be 60-80% cheaper than in developed nations
- At 'Pharma MachTech & LabNext Expo 2026' – announced 100% Central funding through BIS
  - For advanced testing equipment for domestic medical equipment & machinery manufacturers
- Minister of Commerce & Industry: Piyush Goyal | Constituency – Mumbai (North), Maharashtra
  MoS in Ministry of Commerce & Industry: Jitin Prasada

News - 28

- Indian Railways – preparing to raise India's 1st hydrogen train's operational speed to 110 kmph, after trials at 120 kmph
  - Current operation – capped at 75 kmph on 89-km Jind-Sonipat section, Haryana
- It is developed indigenously as per RDSO design specifications
  - 2 Hydrogen Driving Power Cars (1,200 kW each) + 8 Trailer Coaches | Total traction – 2,400 kW
- India aims to deploy 35 hydrogen trains on heritage routes without electrification
- Maintenance facility – Shakurbasti, Delhi
- HQs of Indian Railways – New Delhi | Chairman & CEO – Satish Kumar

News - 29

- MoSPI – launched 'Quarterly Progress Report (QPR) Portal on Data Harmonisation' at a workshop in New Delhi
  - Launched by – Shaktikanta Das, Principal Secretary-2 to PM
  - To strengthen National Data System & promote harmonised use of administrative data
- MoS I/C of Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation: Rao Inderjit Singh | Constituency – Gurgaon, Haryana

News - 30

- Annpurna Devi – launched 9th Rashtriya Poshan Maah 2026 at Rudraksh International Cooperation & Convention Centre
  - Theme – 'Hamari Anganwadi Hamari Jimmedari' | In – Varanasi, UP
- 5 focus themes: Dietary diversity & adequate protein | fresh hot cooked meals at Anganwadi Centres
  - Community ownership & accountability | 10 years of PMMVY
  - Nutrition, early stimulation & education for childhood development
  - PMMVY (Pradhan Mantri Matru Vandana Yojana) – launched on Jan 1, 2017
  - Under Ministry of Women & Child Development's 'Mission Shakti'
  - 1st child – ₹5,000 through DBT in 2 instalments
  - ₹3,000 after early registration & at least 1 Ante-Natal Check-up; ₹2,000 after birth registration & 1st immunization cycle
  - 2nd child – ₹6,000 in single instalment, only if girl child
  - Eligibility:
  - women aged 18 years 7 months-55 years; excluding regular government/PSU employees
  - Weaker sections, including families with annual income below ₹8 lakh, BPL cardholders, MGNREGA workers & Anganwadi/ASHA workers
  - Registration window – up to 270 days from childbirth
- Minister of Women & Child Development: Annpurna Devi | Constituency – Kodarma, Jharkhand
  MoS in Ministry of Women and Child Development: Savitri Thakur

News - 31

- CCEA – approved 8 railway multi-tracking projects worth ₹20,804 Cr under PM Gati Shakti National Master Plan
  - Coverage – 31 districts in 9 states | Added network – ~1,196 km | Completion target – 2029-30
- 5 projects – ₹10,021 Cr; ~540 km across Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka & Telangana
  - Arakkonam-Renigunta & Whitefield-Bangarapet: 3rd & 4th lines
  - Hosur-Omalur & Salem-Karur-Dindigul: doubling; Secunderabad (Ghatkesar)-Kazipet: multitracking
- Remaining 3 projects – ₹10,783 Cr; ~656 km across West Bengal, Jharkhand, Odisha, MP & Chhattisgarh
  - Kharagpur-Jharsuguda (Bagdehi) & Katni-Pendra Road – 4th line | Bilaspur (Uslapur)-Pendra Road – 3rd line

News - 32

- Ministry of Coal + CIL = launched 'Comprehensive CSR Framework for Indian Coal Companies' in New Delhi
  - India's 1st sector-specific CSR framework since introduction of Section 135 of Companies Act, 2013
- 'Thalassemia Bal Sewa Yojana (TBSY)' – up to ₹10 lakh per patient for Bone Marrow Transplants in children with Thalassemia & Aplastic Anaemia
  - Empanelled hospitals – 21 (from 4) | 1,050+ BMTs completed | Outlay – ₹130 Cr across 4 phases
- 'Nanha Sa Dil' – provides free treatment for congenital heart defects in children, including travel & hospitalisation
  - Since Mar'24 launch, 2 lakh+ children screened across 5 coal-producing states & 1,500+ corrective cardiac surgeries
- HQs of CIL – Kolkata, West Bengal | CMD – B. Sairam
- Minister of Coal & Mines: G. Kishan Reddy | Constituency – Secunderabad, Telangana

  MoS in Ministry of Coal & Mines: Satish Chandra Dubey

News - 33

- Karnataka approved "Karnataka Aerospace Policy 2026-31", targeting ₹60,000 Cr in investment & 60,000 jobs over 5 yrs
  - To establish state as a global hub for advanced manufacturing & innovation in aerospace, defence & aviation
  - It adopts a zone-based incentive model
- Karnataka also approved an Employment Fund Programme, "Udyoga Nidhi", with a ₹300 Cr allocation
  - To encourage formal employment across 10 less-developed districts – Yadgir, Bidar, Koppal, Raichur, Kalaburagi, Vijayapura, Belagavi, Vijayanagara, Haveri & Gadag
  - Eligible industries will receive up to ₹2,500 per additional employee per month, for a maximum of 24 months
- Karnataka also cleared: India's 1st state-led drone-testing facility – at Chikkaballapur (₹42.83 Cr)
  - An AI Hub at IIIT-Bangalore | A new Textile & Apparel Policy | An international arbitration centre
  - "Shramika Nivasa" worker-housing initiative, to develop 10,000 houses near industrial workplaces in its 1st phase
- Karnataka: Capital – Bangalore | CM – D. K. Shivakumar | Governor – Thaawarchand Gehlot

News - 34

- TRAI – issued 'Standards of Quality of Service (Duration of Advertisements in Television Channels) (Repealing) Regulations, 2026'
  - It repeals – 'Standards of Quality of Service (Duration of Advertisements in Television Channels) Regulations, 2012'
- 2012 regulations – had prescribed a ceiling of 12 minutes of advertisements in a clock hour of television programming
  - They enforced the advertisement-duration ceiling under Rule 7(11) of 'Cable Television Networks Rules, 1994'
- Rule 7(11) – omitted by Ministry of I&B through an Official Gazette notification on Aug 21, 2026
  - It removed the statutory 12-minute advertisement-duration cap for television channels
- HQs of TRAI – New Delhi | Chairman – Anil Kumar Lahoti | Established in – 1997

News - 35

- Dr. Jitendra Singh – launched India's Ocean Research Vessel (ORV) 'Sagar Manthan' (Yard 3041) at Rishi Bankim Shipyard of GRSE, Kolkata
  - Being built by – GRSE for National Centre for Polar & Ocean Research (MoES)
  - Constructed under Vertical-4 (Deep Ocean Survey & Exploration) of 'Deep Ocean Mission (DOM)' at ~₹840 Cr
- It is an all-weather, multidisciplinary platform with projected service life of 30 years | Length – 89.5m | Width – 18.8m
  - Dual-class certification – Indian Register of Shipping & American Bureau of Shipping
- 'ORV Sagar Manthan' will gradually replace the 43-year-old 'ORV Sagar Kanya' (procured from Germany in 1983)
- Final delivery & commissioning to NCPOR – scheduled for 2028
- MoS (I/C) in the Ministry of Science & Technology & Earth Sciences: Dr. Jitendra Singh | Constituency – Udhampur, J&K

News - 36

- Akasa Air – operated its 1st commercial flight using conventional Aviation Turbine Fuel (ATF) blended with 1% Sustainable Aviation Fuel (SAF), supplied by BPCL
  - Route – Mumbai (Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj International Airport) to Goa (Manohar International Airport)
- India's target – 5% mandatory SAF blending by 2030
- Akasa Air – also 1st Indian airline to voluntarily discontinue traditional water-cannon salutes during route inaugurations
- HQs of Akasa Air – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Founder & CEO – Vinay Dube

News - 37

- Department of Land Resources (MoRD) – launched Operational Guidelines for 3rd phase of 'Digital India Land Records Modernisation Programme (DILRMP 3.0)'
  - Unveiled by – Shivraj Singh Chouhan (Union Minister for Rural Development)
- DILRMP 3.0 – a Central Sector Scheme, to be implemented from Apr 1, 2026 to Mar 31, 2031 | Outlay – ₹565.50 Cr
- Key feature – 'Bhu-Aadhaar' or 'Unique Land Parcel Identification Number' (a 14-digit unique ID for every land parcel)
- 75 high-footfall Sub-Registrar Offices – to be modernised as 'Registration Seva Kendras' | Outlay – ₹37.5 Cr
- Minister of Rural Development: Shivraj Singh Chouhan | Constituency – Vidisha, Madhya Pradesh
- MoS in Ministry of Rural Development: Dr. Chandra Sekhar Pemmasani & Kamlesh Paswan

News - 38

- India – launched 'India Photonics Association', its 1st independent, ecosystem-led photonics industry body, in Delhi
  - Aim: To boost innovation, strengthen industry collaboration & fuel India's capabilities in the photonics sector
  - 1st Director General – Ashwini Aggarwal
- India's photonics market – ~$78.4 billion in 2025; projected to reach $155 billion by 2034
  - Silicon photonics – growing at nearly 29% Compound Annual Growth Rate (CAGR)

News - 39

- Chhattisgarh – approved 'Chief Minister Startup and NIPUN Mission' | Outlay – ₹500 Cr over next 5 years
  - NIPUN – **N**ew Age **I**ndustrial **P**reparedness for **U**pskilling **N**ew Generation Youth
- Under it – Entrepreneurship Development Centres in all 33 districts, 100 Emerging Technology Labs & 5 Industry Excellence Centres
- Cabinet also approved – 'Chhattisgarh Export Promotion Policy 2026-30', to develop the state as a major export hub
- Maximum age limit for applying to other government services & higher positions – raised to 45 years (from 38 years)
- Free allotment of 10 acres of land at Tendua village, Nava Raipur Atal Nagar – approved for a National Skill Training Institute (NSTI) | Estimated cost – ₹200 Cr
  - Allotted to – Directorate General of Training, Union Ministry of Skill Development & Entrepreneurship
- Chhattisgarh: Capital – Raipur | CM – Vishnu Deo Sai | Governor – Ramen Deka

News - 40

- Gujarat – completed mangrove plantation across 27,000 hectares in Kutch under 'MISHTI' scheme
  - MISHTI – **M**angrove **I**nitiative for **S**horeline **H**abitats and **T**angible **I**ncomes | District target – 29,000 hectares
- Bhupender Yadav – launched the "Mangrove GIS (MGIS) Portal"
  - also released the "Coffee Table Book on Kachchh Mangroves" & "Mangroves Atlas of Gujarat"
- Inland Mangrove of Guneri (Kutch, Gujarat) – was declared Gujarat's 1st Biodiversity Heritage Site in Jan 2025
- MISHTI – launched by Central Govt on Jun 5, 2023 (World Environment Day) to expand mangrove cover on India's coasts
- Gujarat: Capital – Gandhinagar | CM – Bhupendra Patel | Governor – Acharya Dev Vrat

News - 41

- India – crossed 80 lakh (8 million) Human Papillomavirus (HPV) vaccine doses administered under 'National HPV Vaccination Campaign'
  - Campaign – launched by PM Narendra Modi from Ajmer, Rajasthan (on Feb 28, 2026)
- It provides a voluntary, free-of-cost single dose of Gardasil-4 quadrivalent HPV vaccine to 14-year-old girls
- Vaccine protects against – HPV types 16 & 18 (responsible for most cervical cancer cases), as well as types 6 & 11
- Annual cohort of eligible 14-year-old girls – ~1.2 crore (per Registrar General of India 2021 estimates)
- 100% coverage of identified target cohorts – Gujarat, Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh & Mizoram
  - Highest number of vaccinations – Uttar Pradesh (22 lakh+)
- Campaign tracks vaccinations through – 'U-WIN' platform

News - 42

- MSDE – flagged off India's largest skilled youth contingent of 70 members for 'WorldSkills Shanghai 2026' competition
  - Flagged off by – Jayant Chaudhary (MoS I/C, Skill Development & Entrepreneurship), at Kaushal Bhawan, New Delhi
- Team India – to compete across 63 skill categories at 48th WorldSkills Competition
  - Event scheduled in – Shanghai, China (Sep 22-27, 2026)
- 1st cohort of 'WorldSkills India Champions Club' – launched at ceremony, comprising 16 members
- India – had secured 8th position in Asia at 'WorldSkills Asia 2025'
- Chaudhary also unveiled – new India competitor attire for WorldSkills Shanghai 2026
- MoS (I/C) in Ministry of Skill Development & Entrepreneurship: Jayant Chaudhary | Constituency – Mathura, UP

News - 43

- NHAI – to upgrade its existing '1033 - National Highway Helpline' with advanced technology
- Aim: To identify precise location of callers, understand calls in different Indian languages & dispatch assistance
- Indian Highways Management Company Limited (promoted by NHAI) – issued an Expression of Interest (EOI)
- '1033' helpline – operational since 2018, available 24x7 | Covers – 1.46 lakh+ km of National Highways
- HQs of NHAI – New Delhi | Chairman – Santosh Kumar Yadav | Founded in – 1988

News - 44

- UP Cabinet (chaired by Yogi Adityanath) – approved 23 development proposals
- 120 KLPD ethanol plant – to be set up at Chhata Sugar Company site, Mathura
- Approved – 'Uttar Pradesh Toy Manufacturing Promotion Policy, 2025'
- 15.172-km 'Chitrakoot Link Expressway' – 6-lane greenfield expressway on EPC basis | Estimated cost – ₹1,008.67 Cr
  - To improve connectivity from Bundelkhand to Chitrakoot Dham; entirely funded by state govt
- ~65 acres in Pure Lal Khan village, Milkipur, Ayodhya – to be allotted free to Centre for NSG regional centre
- UP Govt + Fisheries Department + WorldFish = an MoU for fisheries project in eastern UP
- 20% reservation – for former Agniveers in direct recruitment to post of jail warden
- Exemption from stamp duty & registration fees on lease deeds – up to 10 years
- Amendments easing land requirements for setting up Automated Testing Stations for vehicle fitness
- An additional ₹25 per quintal margin money for fair-price shop dealers based on foodgrain distributed
- UP: Capital – Lucknow | CM – Yogi Adityanath | Governor – Anandiben Patel

News - 45

- Union Cabinet – approved raising EPFO wage ceiling for mandatory coverage to ₹25,000 per month (from ₹15,000)
  - Effective from – Sep 17, 2026 (Vishwakarma Jayanti & Sewa Divas)
- Centre's annual budgetary outgo towards EPFO – to rise to ~₹11,339 Cr (from ~₹10,250 Cr)
  - Estimated expenditure over next 5 years – ~₹56,696 Cr
- EPFO administers 3 schemes – EPF, EPS & EDLI | Contributing members – ~7.98 Cr
  - EPF – **E**mployees' **P**rovident **F**und | EPS – **E**mployees' **P**ension **S**cheme
  - EDLI – **E**mployees' **D**eposit **L**inked **I**nsurance
- HQs of EPFO – New Delhi | CEO – Ramesh Krishnamurthi | Established in – 1952

News - 46

- DARE & ICAR – to participate in 'Special Campaign 6.0' (6th edition), under directions of DARPG
  - Focus – Swachhata & minimising pendency in govt offices
- Implementation phase – Oct 2-31, 2026 | Preparatory phase – Sep 15-30, 2026
- Under Special Campaign 5.0 (2025): DARE/ICAR conducted 8,016 cleanliness drives (target - 8,050)
  - Space freed – 2,35,591 sq ft | Revenue from scrap sale – ₹2.45 Cr
- HQs of ICAR – New Delhi | DG – Mangi Lal Jat | Established in – 1929

News - 47

- Govt – reconstituted Central Board of Film Certification (CBFC) with an 18-member board for 3 years
  - Under – Section 3(1) of 'Cinematograph Act, 1952', read with Rule 3 of 'Cinematograph (Certification) Rules, 2024'
- Chairperson – Shashi Shekhar Vempati (appointed in May 2026, succeeding – Prasoon Joshi)
- Members include: Preity Zinta, Suniel Shetty, Pankaj Tripathi, Priyadarshan, Ricky Kej & Hans Raj Hans
- It is 1st full reconstitution of CBFC board in 6+ years | Previous board – constituted on Aug 11, 2017
- CBFC – functions under Ministry of Information & Broadcasting

News - 48

- AIIA (Ministry of Ayush) – launched 'AyurVarta', a digital dialogue series on Ayurveda
- Launched ahead of – 11th Ayurveda Day (Sep 23)
  - Sep 23 – designated as fixed annual date (in effect since 2025); earlier linked to Dhanvantari Jayanti (Dhanteras)
- The inaugural episode featured a discussion on the theme 'Why is Ayurveda Day celebrated on 23 September?'
- HQs of AIIA – New Delhi | Director – Prof. Pradeep Kumar Prajapati | Established in – 2015

News - 49

- Ram Mohan Naidu – launched 'Hub & Spoke' international flight operations from Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel International Airport, Ahmedabad, Gujarat
  - Ahmedabad – 3rd airport integrated into framework (after Varanasi & Amritsar)
- Designated hub – Delhi | Check-in, customs & immigration – completed at origin airport
- Air India – operating 2 daily 'Easy Connect' flights (Ahmedabad to Delhi), connecting to 26 international destinations
- Framework to be extended to 22 more airports | Planned network – 44 airports (including 4 hub airports)
- India's airports – 160+ (from 74 in 2014) | UDAN routes operational – 679+
- 35% of international passengers travelling from India currently transit through foreign hubs rather than domestic ones

News - 50

- C.P. Radhakrishnan (VP) – released a commemorative postage stamp marking Platinum Jubilee of 'Dinamalar' in Chennai
  - It is a leading daily Tamil-language newspaper
- Dinamalar – founded in 1951 by T.V. Ramasubbaiyer | Began publication – Sep 6, 1951, from Thiruvananthapuram
- Dinamalar's youth publication – 'Pattam'

News - 51

- NBA (MoEF&CC) – crossed cumulative disbursement of ₹200+ Cr under Access & Benefit-Sharing (ABS) framework
  - ABS framework – established under 'Biological Diversity Act, 2002'
- NBA – sanctioned ₹8.23 Cr ABS proceeds to 27 State Biodiversity Boards (SBBs) & 5 UT Biodiversity Councils (UTBCs)
  - From utilisation of biological resources of 4 vegetable crops – Bitter Gourd, Okra, Chilli & Onion
- Proceeds distributed based on – cultivation-area data of Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare
- Largest recipient – Madhya Pradesh (₹1.17 Cr) | 2nd – Maharashtra (₹1.01 Cr)
- HQs of NBA – Chennai, Tamil Nadu | Chairman – Virendra Tiwari

News - 52

- Sikkim – identified 40 high-hazard glacial lakes, classified in Category A, at risk of Glacial Lake Outburst Floods
  - Category A (highest risk) – 16 | Category B (high) – 2 | Category C (moderate to low risk) – 9 | Unclassified – 13
- Disclosed at – media sensitisation workshop on GLOF Risk Mitigation in Gangtok
- Nodal department for GLOF hazard assessment & mitigation – Sikkim's Dept of Science & Technology (since Feb 2025)
- Sikkim: Capital – Gangtok | CM – Prem Singh Tamang | Governor – Om Prakash Mathur

News - 53

- Central Secretariat Service (CSS) Forum – launched 'CSS Shield' in New Delhi
  - A mutual financial support mechanism for bereaved families of CSS officers
- Principle – 'Contribute for Family, Support with Dignity' | Assistance – at least ₹15 lakh to each affected family

News - 54

- MoCAF&PD – reduced sugar stock holding limit for dealers to 2,000 quintals (from 4,000 quintals)
  - Effective – Sep 15-Nov 30, 2026
  - under – Section 3 of 'Essential Commodities Act, 1955', read with clauses 7 & 16 of 'Sugar (Control) Order, 2025'
- Dealers – cannot hold any sugar stock for more than 30 days from date of receipt
- Exception – 4,000-quintal limit retained for Kolkata & its extended metropolitan area
- All-India average retail sugar price – ₹63.28/kg as of Aug 31, 2026 (up 37% from ₹46.02 a year earlier)
- Minister of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution: Pralhad Joshi | Constituency – Dharwad
- MoS in Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution: B. L. Verma & Nimuben Jayantibhai Bambhaniya

News - 55

- MoHUA + DDWS (MoJS) = launched 'Swachhata Hi Seva (SHS) 2026' campaign with a plantation drive
  - Under 'Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam' at India Gate, New Delhi
- Theme – "Swachhata Mein Sahbhag; Swachh Bharat, Viksit Bharat" | Duration – Sep 17-Oct 2, 2026
- 5 pillars: Cleanliness Target Units (CTUs) & clean public places | 'Swachh Paathshala - Yuva for Swachhata'
  - 'SafaiMitra Suraksha Evam Samman Shivirs' | Jan Bhagidari for Swachhata | Swachhata se Samriddhi
- Oct 1 – nationwide shramdaan titled 'Ek Din, Ek Ghanta, Ek Saath'
- Minister of Housing & Urban Affairs: Manohar Lal Khattar | Constituency – Karnal, Haryana
- MoS in Ministry of Housing & Urban Affairs: Tokhan Sahu

News - 56

- Dr. Jitendra Singh – inaugurated 'SPROUT' facility at BRIC-National Institute of Plant Genome Research, New Delhi
  - SPROUT – **S**peedSeed **P**henotyping and **R**esource **O**ptimization for **U**nified **T**rait Analysis
- SPROUT – a season-independent, controlled-environment facility for high-throughput phenotyping & precision stress screening
- 'SpeedSeed' (developed by NIPGR) – can shorten chickpea breeding generation cycle to ~40 days
- Initiative falls under – 'BioE3 (Biotechnology for Economy, Environment and Employment)' policy
- BRIC – formed in 2023 by merging 14 DBT institutes | NIPGR – established in 1998
- MoS (I/C) in Ministry of Science & Technology & Earth Sciences: Dr. Jitendra Singh | Constituency – Udhampur, J&K

News - 57

- Karnataka – issued an order declaring "Engineers' Day" an official State event
  - It also permits engineers to use 'Er.' as a professional prefix before their names
- September 15 – annual state-level observance of this day, commemorating birth anniversary of Sir M. Visvesvaraya
  - He was conferred Bharat Ratna in 1955 | India observed Engineers' Day nationally on Sep 15 since 1968
- Karnataka – has the highest number of engineers among Indian states
- Karnataka: Capital – Bangalore | CM – D. K. Shivakumar | Governor – Thaawarchand Gehlot

News - 58

- KVIC (MSME) – inaugurated "Seva Sankalp, Khadi Mahotsav 2026" at Gandhi Darshan, Rajghat, New Delhi
  - As part of "Seva Sankalp Abhiyan" | Inaugurated by – Manoj Goel (KVIC Chairman)
- KVIC disbursed ₹289 Cr in PMEGP subsidy covering 3,366 new projects
- 'Aashirwad Ka Diya' lamp-lighting programme – also held nationwide
- KVIC – established in 1957 under 'Khadi and Village Industries Commission Act, 1956'
- HQs of KVIC – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Manoj Kumar | Established in – 1957

News - 59

- NHAI – integrated "OneTag", a FASTag portability service, into its "Rajmargyatra" Mobile App
  - It allows FASTag users to switch their issuer bank while retaining same physical tag affixed to their vehicle
- "OneTag" – originally launched by Nitin Gadkari (Union Minister for Road Transport and Highways)
  - At – "Global Fintech Fest (GFF) 2026" in Mumbai (Sep 11, 2026)
  - Launched as a joint initiative of IHMCL & NPCI
- Cooling period of 6 months applies before tag can be ported again
- "Rajmargyatra" App – already offers FASTag Annual Pass, FASTag Local Pass & '1033' Emergency Helpline
- HQs of NHAI – New Delhi | Chairman – Santosh Kumar Yadav | Founded in – 1988

News - 60

- Karnataka Cabinet – decided to accord Tulu the status of state's 2nd additional official language
  - Limited to – Dakshina Kannada & Udupi districts
- Govt will allocate ₹82 lakh annually for translation, training & other activities related to administrative use of Tulu
- Cabinet cleared development projects for coastal region | Worth – ₹32,611 Cr
  - It includes: ~₹16,000 Cr – for rural connectivity & infrastructure, approved "Karavali-Malenadu Karnataka Tourism Policy 2026", a 150-acre fishing park
  - ₹549.79 Cr govt medical college & teaching hospital near Sediyapu in Bannur, Puttur taluk, Dakshina Kannada
- Tulu – a Dravidian language spoken primarily in Dakshina Kannada, Udupi & Kerala's Kasaragod district
- Karnataka: Capital - Bengaluru | Chief Minister - D.K. Shivakumar | Governor - Thaawarchand Gehlot

News - 61

- DGFT (Ministry of C&I) – introduced a 'de minimis exemption' from RCMC (Registration-cum-Membership Certificate)
  - amending 'Foreign Trade Policy, 2023' under Section 5 of 'Foreign Trade (Development & Regulation) Act, 1992'
- RCMC not required for export consignments with FOB (Free-on-Board) value up to ₹3 lakh
  - above ₹3 lakh – RCMC still required
- Consignments up to $3,000 (data: 2021-22 to 2025-26) – ~43% of India's total shipping bills but only ~0.86% of total merchandise export value
- Aim – reduce compliance burden for new/small exporters (MSMEs, artisans, first-time exporters & e-commerce sellers)
- HQs of DGFT – New Delhi | Director General – Lav Aggarwal | Established in – 1991

News - 62

- Flipkart (Walmart-backed) – entered India's online food delivery market with a new service 'Eat In'
  - Piloted first among its own employees in Bengaluru before a consumer rollout in the city
- Built in partnership with – ONDC (Open Network for Digital Commerce)
- Competes with – Zomato, Swiggy, Rapido's 'Ownly' & Swiggy's 'Toing'
- Order processing & fulfilment – to be managed by Flipkart's quick-commerce arm 'Minutes'
  - Flipkart – also launched a standalone 'Minutes' app
- HQs of Flipkart – Bangalore, Karnataka | Chairperson & CEO – Kalyan Krishnamurthy

News - 63

- Maharashtra – progressing towards becoming India's 1st 'tokenised state'
  - Announced by CM Devendra Fadnavis at the 'Global Fintech Fest (GFF) 2026' in Mumbai
- Govt prepared the draft 'Maharashtra Digitisation and Exchange of Land Token Assets Act' (DELTA Act)
  - It is a legal framework for blockchain-based tokenisation of land & immovable property
  - If enacted, Maharashtra would become 1st state with a dedicated statute for tokenised real-world assets (RWAs)
- It could unlock ~₹50 lakh Cr in currently dormant land value
- Expert committee formed (incl. SEBI, BSE & NSE) – to review the drafted Act, benchmarking int. regulatory models
- Maharashtra: Capital – Mumbai | CM – Devendra Fadnavis | Governor – Jishnu Dev Varma

News - 64

- Govt of India – dissolved the Digital Communications Commission (DCC)
  - It is the apex inter-departmental decision-making body of the Department of Telecommunications (DoT)
- DCC – established as the 'Telecom Commission' on Apr 11, 1989
  - re-designated 'Digital Communications Commission' on Oct 22, 2018
- It decided telecom policy matters, spectrum pricing & TRAI recommendations
- HQs of TRAI – New Delhi | Chairman – Anil Kumar Lahoti | Established in – 1997

News - 65

- Anupriya Patel – launched 7th edition of 'National Formulary of India (NFI)'
  - At '6th National Pharmacovigilance Week' programme – organised by Indian Pharmacopoeia Commission (IPC)
  - At Dr. Ambedkar International Centre, New Delhi
- National Pharmacovigilance Week – observed from Sep 17-23, 2026
  - Theme – "Promoting Rational Use of Medicines through Pharmacovigilance: A Step Towards Safer Healthcare"
- She also launched – 'Guidance Document for Hospitals in India for Safety Monitoring and Reporting of Medical Device-Related Adverse Events' & 'ADR-PvPI 2.0 Mobile App' for iOS users
- 'Biovigilance Programme of India' – approved by Govt of India
- India – rose to 8th globally in contributions to WHO patient safety database (from 123rd during 2009-2014)
- NFI 2026 comprises 34 chapters, 20 appendices & 653 drugs, including 42 fixed-dose combinations & 30 immunologicals

News - 66

- MoPNG – made 'Biometric Aadhaar Authentication (BAA)' mandatory for domestic LPG consumers
  - To book refills at Retail Selling Price (RSP) with subsidy, from Oct 1, 2026
- Domestic LPG consumers who completed BAA (as of Sep 19, 2026) – 27.43 crore, a coverage of 89.9%
  - BAA can be done during cylinder delivery, at distributor's showroom or via Oil Marketing Companies mobile apps
- Consumers unwilling/unable to complete BAA – can still get LPG at market price without subsidy, in 5/10 kg cylinders
- Govt compensation to OMCs – ₹30,000 Cr during FY26 & FY27 (₹22,000 Cr was given in FY23)
- Minister of Petroleum & Natural Gas: Hardeep Singh Puri | Constituency – Uttar Pradesh
- MoS in Ministry of Petroleum & Natural Gas: Suresh Gopi

News - 67

- MeitY – brought smartphone screen protectors under compulsory registration framework of BIS
  - It mandates certification for their sale in India
  - Via a gazette notification amending 'Electronics and Information Technology Goods (Requirement of Compulsory Registration) Order, 2021', issued under 'Bureau of Indian Standards Act, 2016'
- They must conform to Indian Standard IS 19348:2025, w.e.f. Apr 1, 2027
- Smartphone screen protectors – become 66th item notified under Compulsory Registration Order, 2021
- Minister of Electronics & Information Technology: Ashwini Vaishnaw | Constituency – Odisha
- MoS in Ministry of Electronics & Information Technology: Jitin Prasada

News - 68

- 'Telecom Consumer Protection (Thirteenth Amendment) Regulations, 2026' – released by TRAI
- It mandates telecom service providers to offer more Special Tariff Vouchers (STVs) exclusively for voice & SMS services, without bundled data
- Operators must offer a voice-and-SMS-only STV for every validity period of 30 days or less
- HQs of TRAI – New Delhi | Chairman – Anil Kumar Lahoti | Established in – 1997

News - 69

- MoPSW – notified 4 ports as India's 1st 'mega ports', via gazette notification under Section 73 of 'Indian Ports Act, 2025'
- The 4 mega ports – Deendayal (Kandla), Jawaharlal Nehru (Nhava Sheva), Paradip & Adani Group's Mundra Port
  - Mundra – the only privately owned port on the list
- Criteria:
  - Bulk port: annual cargo throughput of 150 MMT (Million Metric Tonnes)
  - Container port: 7.5 million TEUs (Twenty-Foot Equivalent Units)

- Mega port status – valid for 5 years
- India has – 12 major ports & 200+ non-major ports
- Minister of Ports, Shipping & Waterways: Sarbananda Sonowal | Constituency – Dibrugarh, Assam
  MoS in Ministry of Ports, Shipping & Waterways: Shantanu Thakur

News - 70

- Premier Energies – commissioned 7 GW N-type TOPCon G12R solar cell manufacturing facility at Naidupeta, Andhra P
  - This takes its total solar cell capacity to 10.6 GW, making it India's largest solar cell manufacturer by capacity
- Spread across 101 acres, built at a capex of ₹3,293 Cr | Designed to make ~88,000 solar cells per hour
- Targeted average solar cell efficiency – ~25.8% (after ramp-up)
- It follows Premier Energies' 5.6 GW solar module facility at Seetharampur, Telangana (Mar 2026), taking total module capacity to 11.1 GW
- HQs of Premier Energies – Hyderabad, Telangana | Chairman – Surender Pal Singh Saluja | MD & CEO – Chiranjeev Singh Saluja

News - 71

- Amit Shah & Bhupendra Patel – flagged off India's 1st LNG-powered train from Sabarmati Railway Station, Ahmedabad
- Amit Shah also launched railway projects worth ₹1,472 Cr in Sabarmati division, including:
  - WAG-12 locomotive maintenance shed (₹700 Cr) & 'Kavach' system on Sabarmati-Kalol-Sabarmati section (₹48 Cr)
- Gujarat: Capital – Gandhinagar | CM – Bhupendra Patel | Governor – Acharya Dev Vrat
- Minister of Home Affairs & Cooperation: Amit Shah | Constituency – Gandhinagar, Gujarat
  MoS in Ministry of Home Affairs: Nityanand Rai & Bandi Sanjay Kumar
  MoS in Ministry of Cooperation: Krishan Pal & Murlidhar Mohol

News - 72

- 'Make in India' initiative – completed 12 years since its launch on Sep 25, 2014
  - Aim: To make India a global hub for manufacturing, design & innovation
- Evolved into 'Make in India 2.0' – covering 27 sectors (15 manufacturing + 12 services)
- India – now world's 2nd-largest mobile phone manufacturer by volume
- Indigenous defence production – rose to ₹1.78 lakh Cr in 2025-26 (from ₹46,429 Cr in 2014-15)
- Cumulative FDI (2014-15 to 2025-26) – reached $843 billion
- 'Production Linked Incentive' schemes (across 14 sectors) – supported ~₹23.8 lakh Cr production & sales

INTERNATIONAL AFFAIRS

News - 73

- A massive flash flood struck Bhote Koshi & Trishuli river systems in north-central Nepal
  - It originated in high-altitude border areas of Rasuwa district
- An initial amount of $2 million has been released from UN's Central Emergency Response Fund (CERF)
- Additional international support include: $1 million – from Switzerland
  - 5-million-Australian-dollar package – from Australia | Relief funding – by UK, EU & other partners
  - World Bank, India, China & US – pledged a combined $229 million towards a relief fund established by Nepal
- UNICEF appealed for $17.2 million to sustain its emergency response & support early recovery
- Nepal – Kathmandu – Nepalese Rupee | President – Ram Chandra Poudel | PM – Balendra Shah

News - 74

- Türkiye – became 71st country to sign "Artemis Accords"
- Artemis Accords – established in Oct 2020 by US & seven other founding countries
  - To set common principles for sustainable & peaceful civil space activity
  - India signed Accords on Jun 21, 2023, as 27th signatory
- With Türkiye's accession, it becomes 7th West Asian nation to join Accords
  - Following United Arab Emirates, Saudi Arabia, Bahrain, Oman, Jordan & Israel
- Türkiye is separately preparing its first uncrewed lunar mission, 'AYAP-1'
  - A follow-up mission, 'AYAP-2', is planned to soft-land a rover on Moon in 2030s
- Türkiye is scheduled to host International Astronautical Congress in Antalya in Oct 2026
- Turkey – Ankara – Turkish Lira | President – Recep Tayyip Erdogan

News - 75

- China's People's Liberation Army Navy – flight-tested "GJ-21" stealth attack drone
  - It is naval variant of "GJ-11" 'Sharp Sword' UCAV
- Sichuan – lead vessel of Type 076 class & is fitted with an electromagnetic catapult launch system
  - Built at – Hudong-Zhonghua Shipyard in Shanghai
- China – Beijing – Renminbi | President – Xi Jinping | PM – Li Qiang

News - 76

- China's People's Liberation Army Navy – test-fired a new stealth-coated variant of "YJ-18A" anti-ship cruise missile
- YJ-18A – a subsonic-cruise, supersonic-terminal-attack missile, cruising at around Mach 0.8 before accelerating to Mach 2.5-3.0 in its terminal phase
- China – Beijing – Renminbi | President – Xi Jinping | PM – Li Qiang

News - 77

- Russia's Strategic Missile Forces conducted a combat training launch of a mobile, solid-fuel ICBM
  - From Plesetsk Cosmodrome in Arkhangelsk region, sending it to Kura test site on Kamchatka Peninsula
- RS-24 Yars – a solid-fuel, three-stage ICBM developed by Moscow Institute of Thermal Technology
- Russia – Moscow – Russian Ruble | PM – Mikhail Mishustin | President – Vladimir Putin

News - 78

- Ministry of Interior (Thailand) – cut maximum visa-free stay for tourists, including Indians, to 30 days (from 60 days)
  - W.e.f. – Sep 15, 2026 | Under revised rules published in Royal Gazette on Aug 31, 2026
- Tourist visa exemption will continue to apply to 60 countries & territories
  - 2 countries will receive a 15-day exemption
  - 3 countries remain eligible only for a paid Visa on Arrival
- Indian passport holders will remain visa-exempt for tourism, avoiding an earlier proposal that would have moved them to paid Visa on Arrival category
- Travellers who enter Thailand on or before Sep 14, 2026, under existing scheme will retain full period granted at entry
  - Travellers arriving from Sep 15, 2026, onward will be limited to 30 days
- Thailand – Bangkok – Thai Baht | King – Maha Vajiralongkorn | PM – Anutin Charnvirakul

News - 79

- UNGA – adopted 'Correct the Map: Rebalancing Global Cartographic Representation and Promoting Equitable Representation of the World's Regions, Particularly Africa' resolution
- Introduced by – Togo, on behalf of 54-member Group of African States
- HQs of UNGA – New York, US | 80th Session's President – Annalena Baerbock (Germany) | Members – 193

News - 80

- UNGA – proclaimed Nov 27 as 'International Day for the Elimination of Child, Early and Forced Marriage'
  - Resolution led by Sierra Leone & co-sponsored by ~70 nations, including India
- 'Bal Vivah Mukt Bharat' campaign – launched on Nov 27, 2024
  - Targets – 10% reduction in child-marriage prevalence by 2026 & child-marriage-free India by 2030
- HQs of UNGA – New York, US | 80th Session's President – Annalena Baerbock (Germany) | Members – 193

News - 81

- UK recognised India's "Carbon Credit Trading Scheme (CCTS)" as a qualifying carbon pricing mechanism
  - Under its "Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM)"
- UK's CBAM – to be introduced on Jan 1, 2027
- India + UK = signed Comprehensive Economic & Trade Agreement (CETA) on Jul 15, 2026
  - Bilateral merchandise trade – $25.1 billion (2025-26) | Services trade – $35.4 billion (2024)
- UK – London – Pound Sterling | PM – Andy Burnham | New King – King Charles lll

News - 82

- India joined a US-led initiative involving 25 other countries to coordinate on development of secure, interoperable & resilient 6G networks
- It builds on the "Call to Action for 6G Leadership and Security", launched in Jul 2026 & backed by 24 other nations across Europe, Americas & Asia-Pacific
  - Led by – National Telecommunications & Information Administration (NTIA)
- India already engages internationally on 6G through the 'Bharat 6G Alliance'

News - 83

- 'Atomic Technologies Licensed for Applications at Sea (ATLAS)' initiative – launched by IAEA
  - A global framework for safe, secure & peaceful use of nuclear power in civilian shipping & floating nuclear power plants (FNPPs)
  - Unveiled at – International High-level Forum hosted by US in Washington, D.C., USA
- Joint statement on ATLAS – signed by 26 countries (including India, Japan, US, UK, France & Saudi Arabia)
- India represented by – Ajit Kumar Mohanty (AEC Chairman & DAE Secretary)
- India's 'Nuclear Energy Mission' – targets 5+ Bharat Small Modular Reactors by 2033 & 100 GW nuclear capacity by 2047
- HQs of IAEA – Vienna, Austria | Director General – Rafael Mariano Grossi | Founded in – 1957

BANKING, DIGITAL / FINANCE, ECONOMIC & INSURANCE AFFAIRS

News - 84

- Tata Capital + Resona Bank (Japan) = an MoU to help Japanese companies explore business opportunities in India
- Tata Capital will set up a dedicated, Japanese-language "Japan Desk" to assist its corporate clients with market insights
- Resona Bank earlier invested $20 million as a Limited Partner in Tata Capital Growth Fund III LP
- HQs of Tata Capital – Mumbai, MH | Chairman – Saurabh Agrawal | MD & CEO – Rajiv Sabharwal
- Japan – Tokyo – Yen | PM – Sanae Takaichi

News - 85

- SEBI issued a circular on introducing an IT Resilience Index (ITRI) framework for Market Infrastructure Institutions (MIIs)
- ITRI will measure robustness of critical IT systems on a 100-point scale across 9 weighted parameters
  - Availability & security – 20% each
  - Integrity, governance, reliability & monitoring, business continuity, and modularity & flexibility – 10% each
  - Scalability & other parameters (including incident handling) – 5% each
- Industry Standards Forum – to formulate baseline parameters, acceptable threshold scores & SOPs for calculating ITRI
- HQs of SEBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Tuhin Kanta Pandey | Established in – 1992

News - 86

- BoB – launched "UPI Global Reverse Acceptance"
- It facilitates cross-border Person-to-Merchant (P2M) transactions in India for visitors from countries participating in NPCI International's Global Payments ecosystem
- UPI is currently operational in 11 countries – UAE, France, Bhutan, Sri Lanka, Nepal, Singapore, Mauritius, Qatar, Cambodia, Greece & Maldives
- HQs of BoB – Vadodara, Gujarat | MD & CEO – Debadatta Chand | Tagline – "India's International Bank"

News - 87

- Cashfree Payments – launched "Relay", an AI 'Super Agent' to automate & run payment operations for SMBs & startups
- Relay is free for all Cashfree merchants at launch
- HQs of Cashfree Payments – Bengaluru, Karnataka | CEO & Co-Founder – Akash Sinha | Established in – 2015

News - 88

- SBI will revise cash withdrawal charges for customers holding Basic Savings Bank Deposit Accounts (BSBD) from Oct'26
- Now, customers can make 4 cash withdrawals through SBI branches every month without paying a fee
  - Each withdrawal beyond monthly limit will attract a charge of ₹15 plus applicable GST (irrespective of amount)
- Revised charges apply specifically to BSBD Account operated through branch channel, under Product Code 1011-1701
- Digital transactions will continue to remain free without any restriction
- HQs of SBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Challa Sreenivasulu Setty
  MDs – Rana Ashutosh Kumar Singh | Ashwini Kumar Tewari | Ravi Ranjan | Rama Mohan Rao Amara

News - 89

- IDFC FIRST Bank + IIM CIP = partnered to launch "IGNITE", a pan-India startup incubation programme
  - To nurture early-stage enterprises working on sustainable business solutions, under FIRST IMPACT initiative
- It will provide total financial & operational support of ₹2 Cr, including a direct startup grant corpus of ₹1.36 Cr
- IIMCIP has so far supported more than 2,000 startups & seed-funded 136 ventures
  - They have collectively raised over ₹2,000 Cr & built a cumulative portfolio valuation of nearly ₹8,000 Cr
- HQs of IDFC First Bank – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO – V. Vaidyanathan | Established in – 2018
- Director of IIM Calcutta – Prof. Alok Kumar Rai

News - 90

- India achieved around 78% of its FY27 budgeted disinvestment & asset monetisation target of ₹80,000 Cr within first 5 months of this financial year
- India raised ₹62,124 Cr through various capital receipt measures, including:
  - ₹55,757 Cr – through minority stake sales in 9 PSUs
  - ₹6,367 Cr – through asset monetisation via Infrastructure Investment Trusts (InvITs)
- Disinvestment proceeds came from: A 6.5% stake sale in LIC – ₹31,515 Cr
  - Followed by – a 2% stake sale in Coal India (₹5,542 Cr) & a 6.01% stake dilution in NHPC (₹4,357 Cr)
  - A 6% stake sale in Hindustan Copper – ₹3,041 Cr

News - 91

- RBI relaxed weekly access rule for its concessional USD-INR swap facility linked to FCNR(B) deposits
  - It allows banks to access facility for transactions above $100 million outside their designated weekly window
- Banks can now approach RBI for swaps above $100 million without waiting for their allotted day
  - Transactions below $100 million continue to be processed only on bank's designated weekly day (as earlier)
- USD-INR forex swap facility – introduced on Jun 8, 2026 & covered FCNR(B) deposits, ECBs & OFCBs
  - It attracted total inflows of $72.85 billion as of Aug 21, 2026
  - Highest contribution – FCNR(B) deposits with $65.40 billion | Followed by – OFCBs ($4.86 bn) & ECBs ($2.59 bn)
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 92

- Bajaj Gen Ins Ltd – launched "My Family Complete", a pioneering health insurance product
  - To offer shared coverage to pet dogs & cats under a single health protection framework
- It comprises adults from 18 years onward, dependent children from 3 months to 30 years & pet dogs or cats from 3 months of age
  - Sum insured options – from ₹5 lakh to ₹5 Cr | Tenures – up to 5 years
- HQs of Bajaj General Insurance – Pune, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Dr. Tapan Singhel

News - 93

- NABARD + NaBFID = an MoU to strengthen collaboration in financing infrastructure projects with significant rural & agricultural linkages
- HQs of NABARD – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Shaji K. V. | Founded in – 1982
- HQs of NaBFID – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – K. V. Kamath

News - 94

- Yuko Keicho (Japan) – appointed as Vice President & Auditor General of World Bank Group
  - She will lead Internal Audit Vice Presidency
- She previously served for 5 years as Auditor General of ADB & also serves on standards committee of IIA
- HQs of World Bank – Washington D.C., US | President – Ajay Banga | MD/CFO – Anshula Kant | Members – 189

News - 95

- IPPB marked its 9th Foundation Day on Sep 1, 2026, & launched:
  - "DakPay Sound Box" – for merchants to strengthen digital payment acceptance
  - "Digital Insurance Technology Platform" – to connect customers to Life, Health & General Insurance
  - "Digital Mutual Fund Platform" – for digital investment
- IPPB processed ₹21.61 lakh Cr in digital financial transactions, including:
  - ₹7.41 lakh Cr – in UPI remittances | ₹36,140 Cr – 12.06 crore AePS transactions
  - ₹1.55 lakh Cr – benefits disbursed to 6.5 crore Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) beneficiaries
- It also issued 29.43 lakh Digital Life Certificates to pensioners
  - It also processed: 9.47 crore – Aadhaar Mobile Updates | 1.35 crore – Bal Aadhaar enrolments
- Over past year, IPPB introduced 3 savings account variants:
  - "SHG Savings Account" – for Self Help Groups & rural micro-entrepreneurs
  - "Surakshit Savings Account" – offering ₹25,000 cyber-insurance cover against phishing, spoofing & SIM jacking
  - "Sampoorna Savings Account" – combining Aarogya wellness & Surakshit cyber-protection benefits
- IPPB – 100% government-owned & was launched on Sep 1, 2018
- HQs of IPPB – New Delhi | MD & CEO – R Viswesvaran | Chairman – Subrat Das | Established on – Sep 1, 2018

News - 96

- PhonePe – launched "PhonePe UPI 123Pay", extending UPI payment capability to feature phone users across India without requiring an internet connection
- It will come pre-bundled on select feature phones from Nokia, HMD, Lava International & Itel Mobile
  - To activate, users open pre-installed app, accept terms, register device, select bank, enter last 6 digits of debit card & expiry date, and set a UPI PIN
- PhonePe also introduced an AI-powered voice helpline supporting English & 12 Indian languages to assist activation
- PhonePe's own branded service builds on NPCI's broader UPI123Pay framework
  - It was first launched by RBI Governor Shaktikanta Das on Mar 8, 2022
- PhonePe currently leads India's UPI ecosystem, processing 10.86 billion UPI transactions worth ₹14.44 lakh Cr in Jul'26
- HQs of PhonePe – Bangalore, Karnataka | MD & CEO – Sameer Nigam | Founded in – 2015

News - 97

- NCDEX – launched "RAINCHNNAI", a SEBI-approved, cash-settled futures contract, with trading beginning on Aug 31
  - To hedge financial exposure to Chennai's Northeast monsoon
- Northeast monsoon accounts for nearly 70% of Chennai's roughly 1,400 mm annual rainfall
- This contract is built on a Cumulative Deviation Rainfall (CDR) model

- RAINCHNNAI contracts will be available for September, October, November & December
  - It has a tick size of 1 millimetre & a maximum order lot size of 50 lots
  - It will trade Monday to Friday between 10 am & 11:30 pm/11:55 pm
- Together, RAINCHNNAI & RAINMUMBAI extend rainfall risk management across India's full monsoon cycle
  - From Southwest Monsoon (Jun-Sep) to Northeast Monsoon (Sep-Dec)
- RAINMUMBAI – India's 1st SEBI-approved exchange-traded weather derivatives contract
  - It is benchmarked against a 30-year (1991-2020) historical LPA dataset
- HQs of NCDEX – Mumbai, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Vikas Goel | Established in – 2003

News - 98

- As per data released by NSO (MoSPI), India's real GDP grew 7.8% y-o-y in 1st quarter of FY27 (Apr-Jun 2026)
- Real GDP at constant prices – ₹81.36 lakh Cr in Q1 FY27 (from ₹75.46 lakh Cr in Q1 FY26)
  - Nominal GDP – grew 10.3% to ₹88.27 lakh Cr (from ₹80.00 lakh Cr)
- Real GVA – increased 8.2% to ₹73.82 lakh Cr (from ₹68.21 lakh Cr)
  - Nominal GVA – grew 11.5% to ₹80.53 lakh Cr (from ₹72.24 lakh Cr)
- Q1 FY27 growth rate moderated from a revised 8.6% in Q4 FY26 (Jan-Mar 2026)
- Agriculture – grew 3.6% (against 4.4%) | Mining & quarrying – contracted 2.4%
- RBI's own full-year GDP growth projection for FY27 – 6.7%

News - 99

- LIC – launched two new insurance plans, "Bima Platinum" & "Jeevan Raksha" to mark its 70th anniversary
- Bima Platinum – guaranteed additions of ₹70 for every ₹1,000 of annual premium paid during premium-paying term
  - Minimum Basic Sum Assured – ₹3 lakh | It offers premium-paying terms of 7, 10, 12, 15 or 18 years
  - Minimum entry age – 30 days
- Jeevan Raksha – available to individuals aged 18 to 45 at entry | Maturity age – 33 to 60 years
  - Basic Sum Assured – ₹5 lakh to ₹24 lakh
- HQs of LIC – Mumbai | CEO – R Doraiswamy | Founded in – 1956 | Tagline – 'Yogakshemam Vahamyaham'

News - 100

- Suman Ray (Regional Director for Maharashtra) – appointed as Executive Director of RBI, w.e.f. Sep 1, 2026
- Now, he will oversee Department of DICGC & Premises Department
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935

  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 101

- Jio Platforms – received SEBI's final approval to proceed with its initial public offering (IPO)
  - It plans to issue up to 270 million fresh equity shares of ₹10 face value each, to raise ~₹37,700 Cr
- Stake of various companies in Jio Platforms: Reliance Industries – 66.43% | Meta – 9.98% | Google – 7.73%
- Of proceeds, around ₹27,500 Cr is earmarked for repaying or prepaying debt held by Reliance Jio Infocomm
- This issue is being managed by a syndicate of 19 Book Running Lead Managers, led by Kotak Mahindra Capital Company
- HQs of Jio Platforms – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Group CEO – Pankaj Mohan Pawar

News - 102

- S&P Global Ratings retained India's long-term sovereign credit rating at 'BBB' with a stable outlook
- S&P projected India's GDP growth to moderate to 6.6% in FY27 (from 7.7% in FY26)
  - It also forecast an average annual growth of 7% over next 3 years
- HQs of S&P Global Ratings – New York City, US | President – Yann Le Pallec | Established in – 1860

News - 103

- India's UPI recorded its highest-ever monthly transaction volume in Aug 2026, processing 24.51 billion transactions
  - Worth – ₹29.82 lakh Cr | From July 2026's 23.66 billion transactions worth ₹29.88 lakh Cr
- All-time high for monthly transaction value – ₹29.90 lakh Cr (May 2026)
- On a y-o-y basis, transaction volume grew 22% from 19.63 billion in Aug 2025
  - Transaction value rose 20% from ₹24.85 lakh Cr in same month last year
- Average daily transaction volume – rose to 791 million in Aug 2026 (from 763 million in July)
  - Average daily transaction value – declined to ₹96,205 Cr (from ₹96,383 Cr)
- Annual UPI transaction value – grew to around ₹314 lakh Cr in FY26 (from ₹0.07 lakh Cr in FY17)

News - 104

- NIPL + NIPC (Uzbekistan) = signed a commercial agreement to enable UPI payments across Uzbekistan
- Agreement was backed by regulatory clearances from RBI & Central Bank of Uzbekistan (CBU)
- UPI is now accepted in 11 countries: Singapore, UAE, France, Mauritius, Nepal, Bhutan, Qatar, Sri Lanka, Cambodia, Greece & Maldives
- HQs of NPCI Int. – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO – Ritesh Shukla
- Uzbekistan – Tashkent – Uzbekistani Som | PM – Abdulla Nigmatovich Aripov | President – Shavkat Mirziyoyev

News - 105

- MoSPI – released "National Accounts Statistics (NAS) 2026" publication, alongside its Q1 FY27 GDP estimates press note
  - It is based on revised National Accounts series with base year 2022-23
- It adopted 'Double Deflation Method', under which output values are adjusted using Output Producer Price Index (PPI)
- Secondary sector – grows 8.6% at constant prices
  - Primary sector – grows 2.9% (with Agriculture & Allied Sector recording 3.6% growth)
  - Gross Fixed Capital Formation (GFCF) – grows 11.9% at constant prices (from 5.8% in Q1 FY26)
- India's real GDP in Q1 of FY27 – ₹81.36 lakh Cr (from ₹75.46 lakh Cr in Q1 of FY26)
  - Nominal GDP – grew 10.3% to ₹88.27 lakh Cr | Real GVA – grew 8.2% to ₹73.82 lakh Cr
- MoS I/C of Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation: Rao Inderjit Singh | Constituency – Gurgaon, Haryana

News - 106

- Rajendra Kumar Saboo (ED of UCO Bank) – additional charge extended as MD & CEO of UCO bank (until Nov 30, 2026)
  - He succeeded – Ashwani Kumar (in June 2026)
- HQs of UCO Bank – Kolkata, WB | MD & CEO – Rajendra Kumar Saboo (addi. charge) | Tagline – "Honours your Trust"

News - 107

- SEBI – granted a 'Category I' merchant banking licence to Zerodha Corporate Advisors
- It permits Zerodha Corporate Advisors to manage IPOs, FPOs & rights issues & to act as a Book Running Lead Manager (BRLM) on mainboard IPOs
- Zerodha infused ₹55 Cr into merchant banking business to meet revised net worth requirement
- Under 'SEBI (Merchant Bankers) Amendment Regulations, 2025', w.e.f. Jan 2026, minimum net worth for new Category I merchant bankers – raised to ₹50 Cr (from ₹5 Cr)
  - Alongside a ₹12.5 Cr liquid net-worth requirement & a cap on total underwriting obligations at 20X liquid net worth
  - Category II merchant bankers require only ₹10 Cr net worth but cannot lead-manage mainboard equity IPOs
- As of Aug 31, 2026, SEBI had 248 registered merchant bankers
- HQs of Zerodha – Bengaluru, Karnataka | CEO – Nithin Kamath | CFO – Nikhil Kamath | Established in – 2010
- HQs of SEBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Tuhin Kanta Pandey | Established in – 1992

News - 108

- Carol Kripanayana Furtado – appointed as Interim CEO of Ujjivan SFB for 3 months (succeeding - Sanjeev Nautiyal)
- HQs of Ujjivan SFB – Bengaluru | MD & CEO – Sanjeev Nautiyal | Tagline – "Build a Better Life" | Established in – 2017

News - 109

- Axis Bank + Scapia = launched 'Scapia Axis Bank Credit Card', a co-branded travel credit card
  - Available on – Mastercard & RuPay networks | Onboarding began – Sep 3, 2026
- It marks Scapia's 3rd banking partnership | Earlier partners – BOBCARD & Federal Bank
- HQs of Axis Bank – Mumbai, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Amitabh Chaudhry | Tagline – "Badhti ka Naam Zindagi"
- HQs of Scapia – Bengaluru, Karnataka | CEO – Anil Goteti

News - 110

- Sandeep Kumar – appointed as Additional Director, MD & CEO of LIC Housing Finance (succeeding - T. Adhikari)
- Previously, he served as – Chief Operating Officer of LIC Housing Finance
- HQs of LIC Housing Finance – Mumbai, MH | MD & CEO – Sandeep Kumar | Tagline – "Where Dreams come HOME"

News - 111

- Razorpay + IndusInd Bank = launched 'RAY', a conversational AI Account Manager on WhatsApp for businesses
- Bajaj Finance – among 1st businesses live on the platform
- RAY – provides text/voice-based support for payments, settlements, refunds & account queries
- HQs of Razorpay – Bengaluru, Karnataka | CEO – Harshil Mathur | Co-founders – Harshil Mathur & Shashank Kumar
- HQs of IndusInd Bank – Mumbai, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Rajiv Anand | Tagline – "We Make You Feel Richer"

News - 112

- Bank of Canada – unveiled new vertical CAD 20 banknote featuring King Charles III in Ottawa (replacing – Queen Elizabeth II)
- It is Canada's 1st banknote featuring King Charles III; he is 4th monarch to appear on a Canadian banknote
- It is Canada's 2nd vertical banknote | 1st – CAD 10 note featuring Viola Desmond (2018)
- Reverse side of note – Canadian National Vimy Memorial, France | Portrait by – Jorge Rodrigo Peral
- Canada – Ottawa – Canadian Dollar | PM – Mark Carney

News - 113

- BoB – raised $400 million through reissuance of its 5.3180% August 2031 US dollar bonds | Yield – 5.3890%
  - Total dollar-bond fundraise – $1.1 billion
- BoB – 2nd state-owned bank (after SBI) & 5th issuer overall to cross $1 billion under RBI's discounted funding window
- Indian lenders – raised $11.65 billion through dollar bonds during Jun-Aug 2026
  - Leading issuer – ICICI Bank | Followed by – HDFC Bank & Kotak Mahindra Bank
- RBI's FCNR(B) deposit hedging window – closed on Aug 31, 2026 (earlier scheduled – Sep 30)
- HQs of BoB – Vadodara, Gujarat | MD & CEO – Debadatta Chand | Tagline – "India's International Bank"

News - 114

- WhatsApp – launched native in-app Bill Payments feature in India, powered by Bharat Connect
- It gives access to 22,722 billers across 30 categories | Payment modes – UPI, credit cards & debit cards
- WhatsApp Pay – processed 150 million transactions in Jun 2026 (from 37 million in Jun 2024)
  - Share of UPI transaction volume – rose to ~0.7% (from 0.27% during same period)
- HQs of Meta – California, US | CEO – Mark Zuckerberg | Founded in – 2004

News - 115

- SBI + Bisleri International = a Letter of Association for plastic waste management across SBI branches & offices under 'Bottles for Change' initiative
- SBI's Net Zero target – 2055, covering Scope 1, 2 & 3 emissions
- HQs of Bisleri – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO – Angelo George | Chairman – Ramesh J Chauhan
- HQs of SBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Challa Sreenivasulu Setty

  MDs – Rana Ashutosh Kumar Singh | Ashwini Kumar Tewari | Ravi Ranjan | Rama Mohan Rao Amara

News - 116

- June 2026 'Financial Stability Report (FSR)' – released by RBI
- SCBs' Gross Non-Performing Assets (GNPA) ratio – fell to multi-decadal low of 1.8% as of Mar 2026
- Capital to Risk-weighted Assets Ratio (CRAR) – 17.7% | Common Equity Tier-1 (CET1) ratio – 15.3%
- Aggregate GNPA ratio for large corporate borrowers – fell to 1.2% in Mar 2026 (from 2.4% in Sep 2024)
- Stress tests on 174 NBFCs – aggregate CRAR could fall to 21.7% under baseline stress & 20.9% under severe credit stress
  - Regulatory minimum CRAR for these NBFCs – 15%
  - Top risk identified by surveyed banks & NBFCs – AI-driven cyberattacks
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935

  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 117

- As per RBI, NBFCs' gold loans – grew 68.5% YoY in Jul 2026 (from 43.9% in Jul 2025)
- Banks' gold loans – declined to 88.1% YoY in Jul 2026 (from 136.4% a year earlier)
- Gold loan books (at Jul-end): NBFCs – ~₹3.54 trillion | Banks – ₹5.52 trillion
- Gold loans – fastest-growing category within NBFC retail loans
- Overall NBFC credit – grew 14.9% YoY to ₹59.89 trillion in Jul 2026 (from 10.6% growth a year earlier)
- Banks' overall credit growth – 19.1% YoY during same period
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 118

- Coastal Local Area Bank Ltd – got 'Scheduled Bank' status, by RBI, by including it in Second Schedule to 'RBI Act, 1934'
- Coastal Bank – became India's 1st Local Area Bank (LAB) to achieve Scheduled Bank status
  - It was India's 1st LAB; operational since Dec 27, 1999
- Scheduled Bank status – enables access to certain RBI liquidity facilities & participation in money market operations
- HQs of Coastal Local Area Bank Ltd – Vijayawada, Andhra Pradesh | MD & CEO – B Venugopal Reddy

News - 119

- Bandhan Bank + Mastercard = launched bank's 1st proprietary credit card portfolio
  - It is a 4-tier portfolio – Sparks, Ignite, Flare & Lumina
- HQs of Bandhan Bank – Kolkata | MD & CEO – Partha Pratim Sengupta | Tagline – "Aapka Bhala, Sabki Bhalai" | Established in – 2015
- HQs of Mastercard – New York, US | CEO – Michael Miebach | Founded in – 1966

News - 120

- Tatsuya Fujimoto – appointed as MD & CEO of IFFCO-TOKIO General Insurance (succeeding - Subrata Mondal)
- Previously, he served as – Director (Operations) at IFFCO-TOKIO
- IFFCO-TOKIO Gen Ins – a 51:49 JV between Indian Farmers Fertiliser Co-operative & Tokio Marine Group of Japan
- HQs of IFFCO-TOKIO General Insurance – Gurugram, Haryana | MD & CEO – Subrata Mondal | Tagline – "Muskurate Raho" | Established in – 2000

News - 121

- ICICI Lombard Gen Ins – penalised with ₹1 Cr, by IRDAI, for outsourcing, vendor management & corporate governance lapses
  - Penalty was imposed under – Section 102 of 'Insurance Act, 1938'
- Violations are linked to – 'IRDAI (Outsourcing of Activities by Indian Insurers) Regulations, 2017'
  - Guidelines on Corporate Governance for Insurers in India
- HQs of ICICI Lombard Gen Ins – Mumbai | MD & CEO – Sanjeev Mantri | Tagline – "Nibhaye Vaade"

News - 122

- S&P Global Ratings assigned 'BBB' long-term & 'A-2' short-term issuer credit ratings to Bank of India, with stable outlook
- 'BBB' – denotes adequate capacity to meet financial commitments
- HQs of BOI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO – Rajneesh Karnatak | Tagline – "Relationship Beyond Banking"

News - 123

- Ministry of Cooperation – restored 'CRCS-Sahara Refund Portal' to resume processing ~20 lakh pending depositor claims
  - ₹9,267 Cr – already refunded to 41,56,711 depositors
- 4 societies covered – Sahara Credit Cooperative Society Ltd (Lucknow)
  - Saharayn Universal Multipurpose Society Ltd (Bhopal)
  - Humara India Credit Cooperative Society Ltd (Kolkata)
  - Stars Multipurpose Cooperative Society Ltd (Hyderabad)
- CRCS-Sahara Refund Portal – originally launched on Jul 18, 2023 to facilitate refunds to eligible Sahara depositors
- Refund funds originate from – 'Sahara-SEBI Refund Account' (corpus – ₹24,979.67 Cr)
- Minister of Cooperation: Amit Shah | Constituency – Gandhinagar, Gujarat
  MoS in Ministry of Cooperation: Krishan Pal & Murlidhar Mohol

News - 124

- PhonePe + Visa = launched 'Tap to Pay', 'Cross Border Scan to Pay' & 'Smart Accept'
  - At 7th Global Fintech Fest 2026, Mumbai
- Cross Border Scan to Pay: It allows scanning of Visa-supported QR codes across 14 international markets
  - PhonePe – 1st app in India to offer Visa's Cross Border Scan to Pay for international transactions
- Tap to Pay: Android users can tokenise Visa cards & make contactless payments through smartphones
- Smart Accept: small & micro-merchants can accept card payments on smartphones without separate POS device

- 7th Global Fintech Fest – organised principally by PCI + NPCI + FCC
  - Theme – 'Potential to Impact: Agentic AI | Tokenisation | Quantum: Trusted, Connected, Global Systems for Inclusive Finance'
- HQs of PhonePe – Bangalore, Karnataka | MD & CEO – Sameer Nigam | Founded in – 2015
- HQs of Visa – Foster City, California | CEO – Ryan McInerney | Founded in – 1958

News - 125

- PFRDA – introduced standardised classification of NPS Multiple Scheme Framework (MSF) schemes into 5 equity-allocation-based risk categories
  - A scheme's equity mandate – must fit within a single category
- Pension funds – given 30 days to rename existing MSF schemes
  - Naming format – pension fund abbreviation + NPS + category code + scheme name
  - Tier II schemes also carry 'Tier 2'
- Maximum – 2 schemes per category for each tier
  - Excess schemes – to be merged, restructured or subsumed within 45 days
- HQs of PFRDA – New Delhi | Chairperson – Sivasubramanian Ramann | Founded in – 2003

News - 126

- PFRDA set up a committee to work towards a guaranteed-return pension scheme for non-government sector
  - Announced at "Global Fintech Fest (GFF) 2026" – held in Mumbai
- "Swasthya" scheme – to be launched by PFRDA within about 30 days
- PFRDA took several other steps to expand & ease NPS framework in recent months, including:
  - Lump sum withdrawal limit at exit – raised to 80% of corpus, for non-government subscribers with savings above ₹12 lakh
  - Appointing 3 new trustees to NPS Trust Board | Easing exit norms for NPS Vatsalya
- HQs of PFRDA – New Delhi | Chairperson – Sivasubramanian Ramann | Founded in – 2003

News - 127

- RBI released its quarterly "Basic Statistical Return (BSR)-1 on Credit by Scheduled Commercial Banks" & "BSR-2 on Deposits with Scheduled Commercial Banks" for Jun 2026, on its "Database on Indian Economy" portal
- As per BSR-1: Bank credit growth – accelerated to 16.5% y-o-y at end-Jun 2026 (from 9.9% a year ago)
  - Bank borrowings by private corporate sector – accelerated to 21.1% (from 7.9%)
  - Credit to public sector – grew 14.6% | Credit to household sector – grew 15.2%
  - Credit to female individual borrowers – expanded 19.7% (from 12.9%)
  - Term loans (comprising 64.1% of total bank credit) – grew 15.4% | Working capital loans – grew 18.0%
  - Credit to: Trade – 18.1% | Finance – 22.4% | Agriculture – 15.1% | Industry – 15.5% | Personal loans – 12.7%
  - Weighted Average Lending Rate (WALR) on outstanding credit – eased to 9.26% (from 9.71%)
- As per BSR-2: Deposits with Scheduled Commercial Banks – grew 11.5% y-o-y at end-Jun 2026

Private sector banks' deposit growth – accelerated to 13.8%

  - Public sector banks' deposit growth – rose to 10.3%
- Household sector – held 58.8% of total deposits & accounted for 98.9% of incremental deposits
  - Term deposits – grew 12.9% | Current deposits – 5.3% | Savings deposits – 10.6%
  - Deposits of ₹1 Cr & above accounts for 47.3% of total term deposits
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  - Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 128

- Visa – announced an enhanced version of "A2A Protect", its fraud-prevention solution
  - To help financial institutions stop account-to-account (A2A) fraud before money leaves customer accounts
- It introduces a new unified fraud score, Visa's 1st in-market integration of technology from Featurespace
- It also introduces "Visa Graph IQ", a graph-powered, agentic investigation capability
- A2A Protect has been shown to reduce fraud by over 50% & cut unnecessary fraud alerts by more than 40%
- HQs of Visa – Foster City, California | CEO – Ryan McInerney | Founded in – 1958

News - 129

- Bank of Maharashtra – introduced a '24x7 Automated Locker Facility' at Supreme Court of India
  - Inaugurated by – Chief Justice of India Justice Surya Kant
- It is 1st automated locker of its kind to be launched by a Public Sector Bank in India
  - Automated lockers have been imported from Japan
- Bank of Maharashtra earlier inaugurated a full-service branch within Supreme Court premises in Aug 2024
- HQs of BoM – Pune, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Nidhu Saxena | Tagline – "One Family One Bank"

News - 130

- Axis Bank (India's 3rd-largest private sector bank) – launched 'ARISE Homecoming', a dedicated hiring initiative to connect globally educated Indian talent with career opportunities in India
- Eligibility – Indian students currently pursuing or recently completing education at overseas universities & early-career professionals with up to 2 years of international work experience
  - It is open across degrees, disciplines & institutions, with focus on skills, potential & role fit
- No. of Indian students enrolled in higher education institutions abroad in 2025 – ~12.54 lakh

News - 131

- NPCI – launched 2 agentic Artificial Intelligence (AI) platforms, 'AiNxt' & 'Agentic Orchestration and Messaging (AtOM)'
  - at 'Global Fintech Fest (GFF) 2026' in Mumbai
- AiNxt – an open-source, enterprise-focused agentic AI platform to create & deploy custom AI agents
  - It follows a Bring-Your-Own-Model (BYOM) approach, allowing users to deploy different underlying AI models
  - It comprises 4 components: AiNxt OS | AiNxt Code | iNxt CLI | AiNxt Enterprise
- AtOM – an AI-driven agentic orchestration platform for agent-to-agent orchestration within payments ecosystem
  - It manages system integration, change management & partner onboarding across Unified Payments Interface (UPI)
- NPCI – is separately building a 'Unified Agentic Protocol' & an AI agent registry to verify & monitor AI agents transacting on India's payments network
- UPI – processed 24.51 billion transactions worth ₹29.82 lakh Cr in Aug 2026
- HQs of NPCI – Mumbai | Chairman – Ajay Kumar Choudhary | MD & CEO – Dilip Asbe | Established in – 2008

News - 132

- FOMO Pay (Singapore) + NIPL = partnered to enable UPI QR code acceptance for merchants in Singapore
- Resorts World Sentosa (RWS) – joined as one of 1st merchant partners
- Indian visitors pay in Indian Rupees (INR) – Singapore merchants receive settlement in Singapore Dollars (SGD)
- Indian visitor arrivals to Singapore – record 1.2 million in 2025, making India its 5th-largest source market for tourism
- NIPL + Liquid Group + HitPay = partnered to expand UPI QR acceptance across Singapore
- HQs of NPCI Int. – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO – Ritesh Shukla

News - 133

- TransUnion CIBIL Ltd – penalised with ₹26,82,800 by RBI
  - For non-compliance with RBI's 'Framework for compensation to customers for delayed updation & rectification of credit information'
- CRIF High Mark – penalised ₹6,89,600 | Equifax – penalised ₹1,19,400
- TransUnion CIBIL (formerly Credit Information Bureau (India) Limited) – founded in Aug 2000 as India's 1st & oldest CIC
- India has 4 licensed CICs (all based in Mumbai), generating credit scores on a scale of 300 to 900
  - TransUnion CIBIL, Equifax Credit Info Services, CRIF High Mark Credit Info Services, Experian Credit Info Company
- HQs of TransUnion CIBIL – Mumbai, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Bhavesh Jain | Founded in – 2000

News - 134

- 'Bankers' Books Evidence Act, 2026' – to be effective from Oct 1, 2026, replacing 'Bankers' Books Evidence Act, 1891'
  - Aim – provide a modern legal framework for use of banking records as evidence in legal proceedings
- It adopts a technology-neutral approach, recognising records in physical, electronic, digital, virtual & cloud-based forms
  - Separate certification mechanisms for physical & electronic records – through its 1st & 2nd Schedules
- For 1st time, it defines 'special cause', specifying limited circumstances in which courts may require banks to produce records

News - 135

- REC Limited – concluded India's 1st pilot issuance of tokenised corporate bonds, raising ₹500 Cr
  - Issued under – SEBI's Regulatory Sandbox Framework
- Transaction used – Distributed Ledger Technology & RBI's wholesale Central Bank Digital Currency for settlement
- Showcased by –Sanjay Malhotra (RBI Governor) & Tuhin Kanta Pandey (SEBI Chairman)
  - At – 'Global Fintech Fest (GFF) 2026' in Mumbai
- India's corporate bond market – valued at over $550 billion
- HQs of REC Ltd – New Delhi | Chairman & MD – Jitendra Srivastava | Founded in – 1969

News - 136

- Indian Bank – received board approval to open a representative office in Dubai, to expand its overseas operations
- Existing overseas presence – a full-service international branch in Singapore, branches in Colombo & Jaffna (Sri Lanka) & an IFSC Banking Unit at GIFT City, Gandhinagar
- Domestic branches – 6,003 (as of Jun 30, 2026) | Plans to add 100 more branches during the year
- HQs of Indian Bank – Chennai, Tamil Nadu | MD & CEO – Binod Kumar | Tagline – "Your Own Bank"

News - 137

- PayGlocal – introduced 'Flash', an express checkout experience for int. customers across participating Indian merchants
  - Unveiled at – 'Global Fintech Fest (GFF) 2026' in Mumbai
- With customer consent, Flash recognises previously verified personal & payment information, removing the need to re-enter the same details
- HQs of PayGlocal – Bengaluru, Karnataka | Co-Founder & CEO – Prachi Dharani | Established in – 2021

News - 138

- UIDAI – launched 'Aadhaar Face Authentication Software Development Kit' & 'Aadhaar Face Authentication Sandbox'
  - at 'Global Fintech Fest (GFF) 2026' in Mumbai
- SDK – embeds Face Authentication directly into native Android & iOS applications, removing the need to switch to a separate app
  - It incorporates AI/ML-based liveness & anti-spoofing capabilities
- Face authentication earlier relied on – standalone 'Aadhaar FaceRD' application, downloaded separately
- Sandbox – a secure, controlled environment to integrate, test & validate the complete face authentication journey without external biometric hardware
- Aadhaar Face Authentication – adopted by nearly 200 entities
  - It is used for Digital Life Certificates under Jeevan Pramaan, Ayushman Bharat onboarding, DBT schemes & Aadhaar-enabled payments
  - It received – 'Prime Minister's Award for Excellence in Public Administration 2023' in Innovation category
- UIDAI also unveiled – 'Playbook on Ease of Onboarding' for the BFSI sector
- HQs of UIDAI – New Delhi | Chairman – Neelkanth Mishra | CEO – Saurabh Vijay

News - 139

- RBI – released draft 'Reserve Bank of India (Know Your Customer) Amendment Directions, 2026' for public comments
  - It inserts a Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) for banks to handle accounts & transactions suspected of money-mule activity or cyber-enabled financial fraud
- For AI/ML-flagged unusual transfers of ₹1,000 or more, banks to place a temporary debit hold limited to the disputed transaction amount, freezing the entire account
- Account holders – 20 calendar days to explain or submit documents | Banks – 10 calendar days to assess the response
- Temporary debit holds – generally not to exceed 60 days | Law-enforcement agencies – 30 days from referral to issue a statutory restraint order
- Applicable to – Commercial Banks (including SFBs, PBs, RRBs & Local Area Banks) & Urban Cooperative Banks
  - Effective from – Apr 1, 2027 (banks may adopt earlier)
- Per TransUnion report (Jun 2026) – nearly 7.1% of attempted digital consumer transactions in India suspected of fraud in 2025 (almost double the global rate of 3.8%)
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
- Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 140

- Department of Financial Services – issued a Gazette notification barring charges on UPI transactions of up to ₹2,000
- It also barred any charge on transactions made using RuPay debit cards
  - Issued under – Section 10A of 'Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007'
- No bank or system provider shall impose, directly or indirectly, any charge on a person making or receiving payment through these modes
  - It follows – 'Taxation and Other Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026'
- It amended Section 10A to empower Centre to specify which electronic payment modes remain free of charges
- For Person-to-Merchant (P2M) UPI transactions above ₹2,000 – a nominal 0.4% Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) to come into effect from Oct 15, 2026
- Person-to-Person (P2P) UPI transactions – to remain completely free, regardless of amount
- Minister of Finance: Nirmala Sitharaman | Constituency – Karnataka
- MoS in Ministry of Finance: Pankaj Chaudhary

News - 141

- Jammu & Kashmir Bank (J&K Bank) – conferred 'Best Corporate Social Responsibility Overall Practices' award
  - At – 13th National CSR Leadership Congress & Awards in Bengaluru
- Award received by – Shadab Mehboob (Zonal Head, Bengaluru), at Taj MG Road, Bengaluru
- HQs of J&K Bank – Srinagar | MD & CEO – Amitava Chatterjee | Founded in – 1938 | Tagline – "Serving to Empower"

News - 142

- Sanjay Malhotra (RBI Governor) – unveiled a set of new capabilities for UPI at 'Global Fintech Fest (GFF) 2026' in Mumbai
- 1st feature 'UPI Tap & Pay' – enables contactless payments at compatible Point-of-Sale (PoS) terminals using Near Field Communication (NFC) technology
- PIN-less transactions – allowed up to ₹5,000 | Above that – UPI PIN to be entered on the PoS terminal
- 2nd feature 'MyUPI' – an AI-powered customer support platform built on NPCI's SML 'Finance Model for India (FiMI)'
- 'Safety Switch' – allows users to request declining of UPI debit transactions in case of suspected compromise
- 'UPI Number Delink' – removes a mobile number from receiving UPI payments
- RBI also extended multi-currency foreign exchange services under 'Bharat Connect', integrated with 'FX-Retail'
  - Newly supported currencies – Euro, British Pound, Canadian Dollar, Swiss Franc & UAE Dirham
- UPI – processed 24.51 billion transactions worth ₹29.82 lakh Cr in Aug 2026 | Banks live – 752
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
- Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 143

- 'Provisional Estimates of Wholesale Price Index (WPI) for Aug 2026' – released by DPIIT | Base year – 2022-23
- All-India WPI inflation – rose to 9.92% YoY in Aug 2026 (from 9.78% in Jul 2026)
- All Commodities Index – rose to 110.8 (from 110.0)
- YoY inflation among 3 major groups: Primary Articles – 7.76% (from 8.52%) | Fuel & Power – 22.93% (from 20.05%)
  - Manufactured Products – 8.37% (from 8.29%)
- Group indices – Primary Articles: 118.1 | Fuel & Power: 108.3 | Manufactured Products: 108.8
- WPI Food Index (weight – 24.99%) – recorded YoY inflation of 7.05% in Aug (from 6.65% in Jul)
- Final index for Jun 2026 – revised to 110.3 (from provisional 110.2) | Jun WPI inflation – revised to 9.97% (from 9.87%)
- Weighted response rate – Jun 2026 Final Estimate: 99.3% | Aug 2026 Provisional Estimate: 84.4%

News - 144

- Provisional 'Consumer Price Index (CPI)' & 'Consumer Food Price Index (CFPI)' for Aug 2026 – released by NSO (MoSPI)
  - Based on new base year – 2024=100
- All-India retail inflation (CPI) – rose to 4.82% YoY in Aug 2026 (from 4.45% in Jul)
- All-India combined CPI index – rose to 108.74 in Aug (from 107.95 in Jul)
- Food inflation (CFPI) – rose to 5.95% in Aug (from 5.52% in Jul)
- Rural inflation – 5.23% | Urban inflation – 4.31%
- Rural food inflation – 6.13% | Urban food inflation – 5.64%
- Sharpest deflation among individual items – tomato, contracting by 31.09% YoY

News - 145

- 'Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) Monthly Bulletin for Aug 2026' (17th edition) – released by NSO (MoSPI)
- India's Unemployment Rate (UR) (15+ years) – declined to 5.0% (from 5.1% in Jul 2026)
  - Rural UR – 4.1% (from 4.5%) | Urban UR – 6.8% (from 6.7%)
- Rural Labour Force Participation Rate (LFPR) – 58.2% | Female LFPR – 34.8%
- Overall Worker Population Ratio (WPR) – 52.8% | Rural WPR – 55.8%
- HQs of NSO – New Delhi | Head – Dr. Saurabh Garg

News - 146

- SEBI – barred Prrsaar Sampada, its related entity Chaubara Eats & 4 linked individuals from securities market
  - For – alleged cross-segment price manipulation involving stock futures & options
  - Restriction on Prrsaar Sampada – applies only to its proprietary trading account
- SEBI – directed impounding of alleged wrongful gains totalling ₹28.12 Cr
- HQs of SEBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Tuhin Kanta Pandey | Established in – 1992

News - 147

- Michael Kremer (University of Chicago professor) – appointed as Chief Economist & SVP for Development Economics of World Bank Group, w.e.f. Oct 1, 2026 (succeeding – Indermit Gill)
- He is 1st person to take up the post while already holding a Nobel Prize in Economics
- He jointly won '2019 Sveriges Riksbank Prize in Economic Sciences' with Abhijit Banerjee & Esther Duflo

News - 148

- Novio (Credilio) + IOB = launched a co-branded RuPay credit card for UPI-active & first-time credit users
  - Unveiled at – NPCI Pavilion during 7th 'Global Fintech Fest (GFF) 2026', Jio World Centre, Mumbai
  - GFF jointly organised by – PCI, NPCI & Fintech Convergence Council (FCC)
- Variants – 'RuPay Select' & 'RuPay Platinum' (with digital onboarding & FD-backed options)
- Novio's existing FD-backed RuPay credit card partners – DCB Bank & SBM Bank India
- HQs of Novio – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Founder & CEO – Aditya Gupta | Established in – 2020
- HQs of IOB – Chennai, TN | MD & CEO – Ajay Kumar Srivastava | Tagline – "Good people to grow with"

News - 149

- MoC&I: India's cumulative (merchandise & services) exports rose 15.55% to $399.27 billion during Apr-Aug 2026-27
  - Cumulative Imports – rose 18.01% to $459.65 billion | Cumulative Trade deficit – rose to $60.38 billion
- Merchandise exports (Apr-Aug) – $215.91 billion (+17.85%) | Services exports – $183.36 billion (+12.95%)
  - Services trade surplus – $86.71 billion (from $79.94 billion)
- Aug 2026: total exports – $82.68 billion (+25.41%) | Trade deficit – narrowed to $9.41 billion (from $11.62 billion)
- Top export destinations (Apr-Aug):
- 1st – US ($42.79 bn) | 2nd – UAE ($13.59 bn) | 3rd – China ($9.61 bn) | 4th – Singapore | 5th – Netherlands

News - 150

- Abhinav Trivedi – appointed as MD & CEO of Standard Chartered Capital Ltd
  - It is a systemically important, non-deposit-taking NBFC & wholly owned subsidiary of Standard Chartered Bank
- Previously, he served as – Executive Director at Standard Chartered Bank India
- HQs of Standard Chartered Capital Ltd – Mumbai, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Abhinav Trivedi | Established in – 2003

News - 151

- 'Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana (PMJDY)' – completed 12 years of implementation (on Aug 28, 2026)
  - Launched by – PM Modi on Aug 28, 2014
  - Eligibility: Every citizen of Indian nationality (no upper age limit)
- PMJDY accounts – 59.09 Cr as of Aug 19, 2026 (from 14.72 Cr in 2015)
  - Rural & semi-urban – 45.95 Cr | Urban & metro – 13.14 Cr | Female beneficiaries – 32.92 Cr
- Aggregate deposits – ₹3,16,514 Cr (from ₹15,670 Cr in Mar 2015) | Average deposit per account – ₹5,356
- RuPay debit cards issued – 41.29 Cr
- RuPay card accident insurance – ₹2 lakh (for accounts opened after Aug 2018 | ₹1 lakh for earlier accounts)
- Overdraft facility – up to ₹10,000 (after 6 months of satisfactory account operation)
- Guinness World Record (Jan 2015) – 1,80,96,130 accounts opened in a single week

News - 152

- RBI's special USD-INR forex swap facility for FCNR(B) deposits, ECBs & OFCBs – attracted inflows of $136.4 billion by Aug 31, 2026
  - Facility operationalised on – Jun 8, 2026
- FCNR(B) deposits – $127.23 billion (~93%) | OFCBs – $5.26 billion | ECBs – $3.89 billion
- FCNR(B) window – closed on Aug 31, 2026 (earlier scheduled – Sep 30) | ECB & OFCB channels – open till Dec 31, 2026
- 20 IBUs at GIFT City (IFSCA data) – sanctioned $54.02 billion & disbursed $52.82 billion of FCNR(B) mobilisation
- RBI's net short dollar position in forward market – record $136.77 billion at end-Jul (from $103.33 billion at end-Jun)
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
- Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 153

- Japan Credit Rating Agency – upgraded India's Long-Term Foreign & Local Currency Issuer Ratings to 'A-' (from 'BBB+')
  - Outlook – 'Stable' | Country ceiling – raised by one notch to 'A'
- It marks 1st time in 35 years that a global rating agency placed India in 'A' category
- Cited by JCR: India's real GDP growth – 7.8% in FY26 | Centre's fiscal deficit – 4.4% of GDP in FY26 (from 4.7% in FY25)
- HQs of JCR – Tokyo, Japan | President – Shokichi Takagi | Established in – 1985

News - 154

- ABHICL + ICAI = partnered to offer tailored health insurance & wellness solutions to 17+ lakh CA members & students
  - Plans: 'Activ Yuva' (below 35) | 'Activ One Max Unlimited Care' with Durable Equipment Rider (above 35)
- 'HealthReturns' – up to 100% of premium for completing 325 'Active Dayz' in a policy year & a strong 'Healthy Heart Score'
- HQs of ABHICL – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO – Mayank Bathwal | Established in – 2015
- HQs of ICAI – Kolkata, West Bengal | President – Prasanna Kumar D | Vice-President – Mangesh Pandurang Kinare

News - 155

- PFRDA – revised charge structure for Point of Presence (PoP) entities under NPS & NPS Lite, w.e.f. Oct 1, 2026
- One-time onboarding charge – ₹200 per Permanent Retirement Account Number (PRAN)
  - Annual charge – 0.20% of AUM | Onboarding charge – recovered by CRAs at ₹50 per quarter until fully collected
- Fully digital, non-face-to-face onboarding – PoPs may charge up to ₹100
- Dormant accounts (no contribution for 4 consecutive quarters) – exempt from annual PoP charge
- Not applicable to – schemes under Regulation 4A of Exit Regulations, e.g. NPS Vatsalya, NPS Swasthya & NPS MSME
- HQs of PFRDA – New Delhi | Chairperson – Sivasubramanian Ramann | Founded in – 2003

News - 156

- IRDAI – permitted Indian insurers to invest in 'Maharajah INR Bonds', proposed onshore rupee-denominated bonds of New Development Bank (NDB)
- NDB – proposes to raise ~₹25,000 Cr over 5 years
- These bonds – fall under definition of 'securities' under 'Securities Contracts (Regulation) Act, 1956'
- Category codes: EORB (NDB's onshore rupee bonds) | IORB (infrastructure-approved bonds)
- Masala Bonds – rupee-denominated bonds issued outside India | Maharajah Bonds – onshore, issued within India
- HQs of IRDAI – Hyderabad, Telangana | Chairman – Ajay Seth | Established in – 1999
- HQs of NDB – Shanghai, China | President – Dilma Vana Rousseff | Established in – July 2014 (by BRICS countries) Members (11) – Algeria, Bangladesh, Brazil, China, Colombia, Egypt, India, Russia, South Africa, UAE & Uzbekistan

News - 157

- SEBI – exempted FPIs investing exclusively in government securities from furnishing investor group details
- Earlier exemption (Sep 2025) – only for such FPIs investing under Fully Accessible Route (FAR)
  - It now applies irrespective of route
- HQs of SEBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Tuhin Kanta Pandey | Established in – 1992

News - 158

- NSE – enabled India's 1st tokenised corporate bond issuances under SEBI's 'Regulatory Sandbox Framework'
  - Issuers – REC Ltd & L&T, raising a combined ₹1,000 Cr
- REC – launched India's 1st such issuance on Sep 7: ₹500 Cr (base ₹100 Cr + green shoe ₹400 Cr) at 7.30% coupon
  - Tenor – 1 year & 9 months | Bids received – ₹796 Cr (~7.9 times oversubscribed)
- L&T – ₹500 Cr tokenised bond issuance on Sep 9; 1st private-sector issuer to use the technology
- Unveiled at – 'Global Fintech Fest (GFF) 2026', Mumbai, by Sanjay Malhotra & Tuhin Kanta Pandey
- HQs of NSE – Mumbai, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Ashishkumar Chauhan | Established in – 1992
- HQs of REC Ltd – New Delhi | Chairman & MD – Jitendra Srivastava | Founded in – 1969
- HQs of L&T – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO & MD – S. N. Subrahmanyan | President – R Shankar Raman

News - 159

- Manish Kothari – resigned from the post of Group President and Head - Commercial Bank at Kotak Mahindra Bank
- HQs of Kotak Mahindra Bank – Mumbai, MH | MD & CEO – Ashok Vaswani | Tagline – "Let's make money simple"

News - 160

- Stock brokers & their payment processing partners – to increasingly weigh netbanking over UPI for large fund transfers
  - Once a new 0.02% Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on capital market UPI transactions takes effect from Oct 15, 2026
  - Capped at – ₹300 per transaction
- Under NPCI's broader MDR framework that levies a 0.4% MDR on P2M UPI transactions above ₹2,000
- UPI carries concessional 0.02% MDR for capital market payments
  - Netbanking transactions attract a flat fee of ₹8 to ₹12
- For capital market payments, UPI limit: Per-transaction – ₹5 lakh | Per-day – ₹10 lakh
- In Aug 2026, 84.12 million UPI transactions worth a cumulative ₹63,667.21 Cr were recorded
  - Under securities brokers & dealers category
- "Netbanking 2.0" – being developed by NPCI's Bharat Connect platform
  - To bring uniformity to netbanking ecosystem across different banks & payment aggregators
- HQs of NPCI – Mumbai | Chairman – Ajay Kumar Choudhary | MD & CEO – Dilip Asbe | Established in – 2008

News - 161

- RBI – granted Self-Regulatory Organisation (SRO-FT) recognition to Unified Fintech Forum (UFF)
- It became 2nd such body recognised for fintech sector after Fintech Association for Consumer Empowerment (FACE)
- Announced at "Global Fintech Fest (GFF) 2026" in Mumbai, under RBI's 'Framework for Recognising Self-Regulatory Organisation(s) for FinTech Sector', finalised in May 2024
- UFF – rebranded avatar of Digital Lenders Association of India (DLAI)
- Headed by: President – Manish Lunia (Co-Founder of FlexiLoans)
  - Vice President – Upasana Taku (Co-Founder & Executive Director of MobiKwik)
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
- Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 162

- SBI – launched a digital Savings Account to Salary Account journey, in partnership with ScoreMe Solutions Pvt Ltd
  - It enables eligible existing savings account holders to switch to salary accounts without visiting a branch
  - Launched at "Global Fintech Fest (GFF) 2026" at Jio World Convention Centre in Mumbai
- HQs of SBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Challa Sreenivasulu Setty
- MDs – Rana Ashutosh Kumar Singh | Ashwini Kumar Tewari | Ravi Ranjan | Rama Mohan Rao Amara

News - 163

- RBI – issued the final 'Reserve Bank of India (Commercial Banks - Minimum Capital Requirements for Market Risk) Directions, 2026', aligning market risk norms with the revised Basel III framework
  - Effective from – Apr 1, 2027 | Intermediate transition scalars applicable since Apr 1, 2024
- RBI also eased KYC norms for FPIs (Foreign Portfolio Investors) via the 'Reserve Bank of India (Commercial Banks - Know Your Customer) Amendment Directions, 2026'
  - Banks can now accept original certified copies of specified KYC documents from FPIs certified overseas by authorised officials
- This facility was earlier available only to NRIs & PIOs (Persons of Indian Origin)
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
- Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 164

- Garware Hi-Tech Films Ltd + Pine Labs = a partnership making GHFL 1st company in India's automotive films & detailing industry to offer card-linked EMI at point of sale
- It covers GHFL's domestic automotive portfolio – Paint Protection Film (PPF), Auto Window Films & Garware Detailing Solutions range
- EMI tenures – 3, 6 or 9 months, including on its flagship 'Garware Titanium' PPF (priced upwards of ₹1.5 lakh)
- HQs of Pine Labs – Noida, Uttar Pradesh | CEO – B. Amrish Rao
- HQs of Garware Hi-Tech Films Ltd – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman & MD – Dr. S. B. Garware

News - 165

- Merchants paying new 0.4% MDR on eligible UPI transactions above ₹2,000 – to also bear 18% GST on MDR charged by payment service provider
- 0.4% MDR – applies from Oct 15, 2026, to Person-to-Merchant (P2M) UPI transactions above ₹2,000
  - Capped at ₹300 for payments of ₹75,000 & above
- GST-registered businesses – can claim Input Tax Credit on GST paid; unregistered merchants bear cost themselves
- Flat ₹5 MDR – for specified categories such as railways, telecom services, insurance & fuel (transactions above ₹2,000)
  - Capital market payments – concessional 0.02% MDR, capped at ₹300
- Exempt – small vendors classified as Person-to-Person-Merchant (P2PM) with monthly UPI QR receipts below ₹1 lakh
  - P2M payments up to ₹2,000 & P2P transfers remain free
- Levy rests on – Section 10A of 'Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007'
  - As amended by 'Taxation and Other Laws (Amendment) Act, 2026' (Presidential assent - Aug 17, 2026)

News - 166

- Bank deposit growth – rose to 17.8% y-o-y in fortnight ended Aug 31, 2026 (highest since 2011) | Credit growth – 19.1%
  - Driven by – a surge in FCNR(B) [Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank)] deposits
- Incremental credit-deposit ratio – fell to 62.56% (from 92.22% a fortnight earlier)
  - Overall credit-deposit ratio – declined to 80.32% (from 81.72%)
- FCNR(B) inflows – reached $127.2 billion by Aug 31, 2026
- Deposits mobilised so far in FY27 – ₹16.4 trillion (against ₹10.88 trillion in the corresponding period last year)
- Credit to industry – grew 20% year-on-year in Jul 2026

News - 167

- ISG + Visa = launched 'Visa Payment Passkey' at 'Global Fintech Fest 2026', Jio World Convention Centre, Mumbai
- Participating issuers – Union BoI, Central BoI, Bank of Maharashtra, Indian Overseas Bank & Indian Bank
- HQs of In-Solutions Global Ltd (ISG) – Mumbai, Maharashtra | MD – Adelia Castelino | Established in – 2004
- HQs of Visa – Foster City, California | CEO – Ryan McInerney | Founded in – 1958

News - 168

- ICICI Prudential Life Insurance Company Limited – renamed as 'ICICI Life Insurance Limited'
  - RoC (Registrar of Companies) issued a fresh Certificate of Incorporation, effective Sep 22, 2026
- Follows shareholder approval of a special resolution concluded on Sep 19, 2026 – 99.9994% of votes in favour
- Tied to a restructuring of joint promoter Prudential plc's role – after agreeing to acquire a 75% stake in Bharti Life Insurance, Prudential must cut its stake from ~22% to below 10% & be reclassified from 'promoter' to 'investor'
- HQs of ICICI Prudential Life Ins. – Mumbai, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Anup Bagchi

News - 169

- TBX – launched a B2B Bill Payments capability on its 'TrustHub' platform, through 'Bharat Connect for Business'
  - Unveiled at 'Global Fintech Fest (GFF) 2026' in Mumbai
- TBX TrustHub – operates as a Participating Agent Institution (P-AI) within Bharat Connect for Business
- IDFC FIRST Bank – serves as Sponsor Operating Unit providing underlying banking infrastructure
- HQs of TBX (formerly TransBnk) – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO – Vaibhav Tambe | Established in – 2022

News - 170

- Sagarmala Finance Corporation Ltd (India's 1st maritime-focused NBFC) – to launch India's 1st 'Blue Bond'
  - To raise up to ₹1,100 crore for maritime & coastal infrastructure
- Issue structure – base size ₹600 Cr + green shoe option ₹500 Cr | Tenor – 10 years | Rated 'AA+' by ICRA & CARE
- Arranger – SBI Capital Markets | Proceeds to fund maritime lending, greenfield port projects & coastal road networks
- Blue Bond – a debt instrument to raise capital for ocean, sea, coast & river-linked projects
- Seychelles – issued world's 1st sovereign blue bond (2018); Bank of China issued Asia's 1st blue bond (2020)
- SMFCL – established in 2016 under MoPS&W; received its NBFC licence in Jun 2025
- HQs of SMFCL – New Delhi | Chairman – Vijay Kumar | MD – LVS Sudhakar Babu

News - 171

- PFRDA – issued the 'Operational Guidelines for NPS Swasthya under the National Pension System (NPS), 2026' on Sep 18, 2026, with immediate effect
  - Issued under Section 14 of the 'Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority Act, 2013'
- NPS Swasthya – comprises an investment account + a separate, mandatory super top-up health insurance policy
- Open to any NPS-eligible individual – entry permitted between 18-70 years, renewal allowed up to 85 years
- Health cover – a family floater for the subscriber, spouse & up to 2 dependent children (excluding parents), across deductible tiers up to a cover of ₹30 lakh
- Subscribers can make partial withdrawals of up to 25% of their contributions for outpatient & inpatient expenses
- It was earlier piloted as a 'Proof of Concept' under PFRDA's Regulatory Sandbox framework from Jan 2026
- HQs of PFRDA – New Delhi | Chairperson – Sivasubramanian Ramann | Founded in – 2003

News - 172

- SEBI Board – approved the 'SEBI (Portfolio Managers) Regulations, 2026', replacing the 2020 Regulations
- along with a new 'Portfolio Managers Route for Investing in Mutual Fund Units (PRIM)'
- Under PRIM – existing portfolio managers can offer investments in direct plans of mutual funds, with a minimum ticket size of ₹25 lakh
  - A new applicant registering exclusively for PRIM – needs a net worth of ₹2 Cr
- PRIM management fees – capped at 1% of client AUM (performance-linked fees also permitted)
- Board also approved a new category of Independent Fund Managers (IFMs) – to manage portfolios in association with a registered portfolio manager
- Portfolio managers can now invest in – IPOs, primary market debt issuances, exchange-traded derivatives & specified foreign securities
- HQs of SEBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Tuhin Kanta Pandey | Established in – 1992

News - 173

- ICAI – issued 'SSA 5000 - General Requirements and Framework for Sustainability Assurance Engagements'
- It aligns India's sustainability assurance practice with the IAASB's 'International Standard on Sustainability Assurance (ISSA 5000)', with 2 India-specific carve-outs (joint audits & forward-looking statements)
- SSA 5000 – a standard for assurance of an entity's sustainability disclosures (climate, labour practices & biodiversity)
  - Applicable for financial years starting on or after Apr 1, 2027
- Expected to be used for assurance of BRSR (Business Responsibility and Sustainability Reporting) disclosures, which SEBI mandates for the top 1,000 listed companies by market capitalisation
- With SSA 5000 in effect, existing standards SSAE 3000 & SAE 3410 will stand withdrawn
- HQs of ICAI – Kolkata, West Bengal | President – Prasanna Kumar D | Vice-President – Mangesh Pandurang Kinare

News - 174

- SBI inaugurated a fully digital journey for 'Advantage SBI Card', an FD-backed secured credit card, on the SBI YONO app
- Available across 4 variants – SBI Card Elite, SBI Card Prime, SimplyCLICK SBI Card & SimplySAVE SBI Card
- HQs of SBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Challa Sreenivasulu Setty
  MDs – Rana Ashutosh Kumar Singh | Ashwini Kumar Tewari | Ravi Ranjan | Rama Mohan Rao Amara

News - 175

- RBI – issued the "Reserve Bank of India (All India Financial Institutions - Classification, Valuation, and Operation of Investment Portfolio) Amendment Directions, 2026"
  - issued under Section 45L of the 'Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934'
- It revises valuation norms for units of InvITs & REITs held by AIFIs
- It amends the 2025 Directions, inserting Paragraph 58A (for InvITs) & Paragraph 58B (for REITs)
- Unquoted units – to be valued at the Net Asset Value (NAV) disclosed by the respective trust
  - If the trust fails to disclose NAV as prescribed, or units are infrequently traded – valued at ₹1
- RBI also issued parallel amendment directions covering commercial banks, PBs, SFBs & Local Area Banks
- HQs of RBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Governor – Sanjay Malhotra (26th) | Established on – 1st April, 1935
  Total Deputy Governors (4): Swaminathan Janakiraman | Rohit Jain | Shirish Chandra Murmu | Poonam Gupta

News - 176

- Nirmala Sitharaman – announced first close of 'IITM Unicorn Frontier Fund I' at 'Sangam 2026' in Bengaluru
  - Sangam 2026 – 7th edition of IIT Madras Alumni Association conference
- Deep-tech venture fund – backed by IIT Madras & IIT Madras Research Park | Fund manager – Unicorn India Ventures
- Fund corpus – ₹1,000 Cr (including ₹400 Cr greenshoe option) | First close – ₹450 Cr
- She also unveiled book 'Cashless Nation: How UPI Changed Everything'
  - Authored by – Dr. Santanu Paul & B. Sambamurthy
- Minister of Finance: Nirmala Sitharaman | Constituency – Karnataka

  MoS in Ministry of Finance: Pankaj Chaudhary

DEFENCE AFFAIRS

News - 177

- 2nd edition of joint maritime exercise "SAHYOG HOP-TAC" – concluded off Chennai coast, Tamil Nadu
  - Concluded by – Indian Coast Guard (ICG) & Vietnam Coast Guard (VCG)
- India participated with 8 Coast Guard ships & 6 aircraft | Vietnam deployed its Coast Guard Ship 'CSB 8002'
- Vietnam – Hanoi – Vietnamese dong | PM – Le Minh Hung | President – To Lam

News - 178

- GSL – formally handed over indigenously designed & built FPV "ICGS Ajit" (Yard 1277) to Indian Coast Guard
  - At a ceremony at GSL's facility in Vasco da Gama, Goa
- ICGS Ajit – 7th vessel in Adamya-class FPV series being constructed by GSL for Indian Coast Guard
  - Length – 51.43 metres | Width – 8 metres | Displacement – 330 tonnes | Draught – 2.5 metres
  - Powered by – twin marine diesel engines driving Controllable Pitch Propellers (CPP)
- HQs of GSL – Vasco da Gama, Goa | CMD – Brajesh Kumar Upadhyay
- HQs of ICG – New Delhi | DG – S Paramesh | Founded in – 1977

News - 179

- DRDO tested its indigenously developed 'Military Combat Parachute System (MCPS)' at Nyoma-Mudh Drop Zone in Leh
- Jump was executed by – Wing Commander Rahul Jha, MWO R.J. Singh & MWO Vivek Tiwari
  - From an altitude of 22,000 feet above mean sea level in temperatures as low as minus 15°C
- MCPS was designed & developed by – DRDO's Aerial Delivery Research and Development Establishment (ADRDE), Agra
  - In collaboration with – Defence Bioengineering & Electromedical Laboratory (DEBEL), Bengaluru
- HQs of DRDO – New Delhi | Chairman – Rajesh Kumar Singh (additional charge) | Established in – 1958

News - 180

- L&T delivered "Samarthak" from its Kattupalli shipyard near Chennai
  - It is Indian Navy's 1st indigenously designed & built Multi-Purpose Vessel (MPV)
- It was built under an ₹887 Cr "Buy (Indian)" contract signed between MoD and L&T in Mar 2022, covering 2 vessels
  - 1st vessel, Samarthak – launched at Kattupalli on Oct 14, 2024
  - 2nd vessel, Utkarsh – launched on Jan 14, 2025
- Specifications of Samarthak: Displacement – 3,750 tonnes | Length – 107 metres | Width – 18.6 metres
  - Maximum speed – 15 knots
- HQs of L&T – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO & MD – S. N. Subrahmanyan | President – R Shankar Raman

News - 181

- Indian Army + US = signed a Letter of Offer & Acceptance (LOA) for procurement of FGM-148 "Javelin" anti-tank guided missile system through US Foreign Military Sales (FMS) route
- It covers 100 Javelin missile rounds, 1 fly-to-buy round & 25 "Javelin Lightweight Command Launch Units" (Block-1 CLUs)
  - Valued at – $45.7 million
- It forms part of a combined $93 million Foreign Military Sale clearance notified by US DSCA in Nov 2025
  - It also included 216 M982A1 "Excalibur" precision-guided artillery projectiles | Worth – $47.1 million
- Javelin is manufactured by – Javelin Joint Venture (JJV), a partnership between RTX & Lockheed Martin
- JJV + TASL = an MoU, on Aug 30, 2026, selecting TASL as prime Indian partner to co-produce Javelin All Up Round (AUR)
- DRDO is separately developing indigenous Man-Portable Anti-Tank Guided Missile (MPATGM)
- US – Washington, D.C. – US Dollar | 47th President – Donald Trump | 50th VP – James David Vance
- HQs of Indian Army – New Delhi | Chief – General Dhiraj Seth | Vice Chief – Lt. General Sandeep Jain

News - 182

- Indian Army raised its 1st 'Baaz Battalion', a dedicated drone-operating unit
  - Raised at – Jalandhar, Punjab | Operates under – Army's 11 Corps
- Each infantry battalion separately operates an 'Ashini drone platoon' for tactical surveillance
  - Artillery regiments – operate loitering-munition drones
- HQs of Indian Army – New Delhi | Chief – General Dhiraj Seth | Vice Chief – Lt. General Sandeep Jain

News - 183

- Indian Navy – commissioned 'INS Nipun', its 2nd Nistar-class Diving Support Vessel (DSV), at Naval Dockyard in Mumbai
- Indigenously designed & built by – Hindustan Shipyard Limited (HSL), Visakhapatnam
  - Length – 118.4 metres | Width – 22.8 metres | Displacement – 9,350 tonnes
  - Powered by – 2 diesel engines | Cruising speed – 14 knots | Endurance – 60 days
- 'INS Nistar' – commissioned in Jul 2025 | Operating from – Eastern Naval Command
- HQs of Indian Navy – Delhi | Chief – Admiral Krishna Swaminathan | Vice Chief – VAdm Ajay Kochhar

News - 184

- IAF conducted a drop trial of indigenously designed & developed "Khagantak-243" Long Range Glide Bomb (LRGB)
  - Developed by – JSR Dynamics (Indian defence company) | Guidance systems supplied by – Bharat Electronics Ltd
- HQs of IAF – New Delhi | Chief – Air Marshal Amar Preet Singh | Vice Chief – Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit

News - 185

- Rajnath Singh – laid foundation stone of a ₹472 Cr T-series main battle tank overhaul facility
  - At Vehicle Factory Jabalpur (VFJ), Jabalpur, MP
  - It will have an annual overhaul capacity of 80 T-72 "Ajeya" & T-90 "Bhishma" main battle tanks
- Indian Army requires roughly 230 T-series tanks to be overhauled each year
- Heavy Vehicles Factory (HVF) at Avadi, Tamil Nadu – currently handles ~150 tanks annually
- Minister of Defence: Rajnath Singh | Constituency – Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh

  MoS in Ministry of Defence: Sanjay Seth

News - 186

- Thales (France) + KSSL (Bharat Forge) = a Strategic Alliance Agreement to co-develop & manufacture unguided & laser-guided 2.75-inch/70-mm rocket systems in India
- Thales' 70-mm rocket systems – used by 70 armed forces across 55 countries, including India
- 1st fully India-produced rocket under this partnership – targeted for early 2027

- France – Paris – Euro | President – Emmanuel Macron | PM – Sebastien Lecornu
- HQs of KSSL – Pune, Maharashtra | Chairman – Rajinder Singh Bhatia | Established in – 2010

News - 187

- Rajnath Singh – released 'RAKSHA' document on defence diplomacy at Kartavya Bhawan, New Delhi
- It identifies 4 key pillars of India's defence diplomacy strategy: Strategic Partnerships | Capacity Building
  - Indigenous Exports | Maritime Security
- Rajnath Singh + Theo Francken (Belgium's Minister of Defence & Foreign Trade) = held bilateral talks in New Delhi
- Minister of Defence: Rajnath Singh | Constituency – Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh
  MoS in Ministry of Defence: Sanjay Seth

News - 188

- DRDO + ACRHEM (now DIA-CoE, University of Hyderabad) = granted Indian Patent No. 599900 for 'BAM-H24'
- BAM-H24 – a next-generation solid rocket propellant fuel compound | Patent granted on – Aug 20, 2026
  - It is rich in boron, hydrogen & nitrogen
- Inventors – Dr. Muddamarri Hanumantha Rao & Prof. Muralidharan Krishnamurthi
  - Title – 'N1,N1,N1,N4,N4,N4-hexaethylbut-2-yne-1,4-diaminiumdodecaborane: The Next Generation Solid Rocket Propellant Fuel'
- HQs of DRDO – New Delhi | Chairman – Rajesh Kumar Singh (additional charge) | Established in – 1958

News - 189

- MIL + Drogo Aerospace = an MoU to design, develop & integrate indigenous UAVs & loitering munition systems
- 'Delta Wing Kamikaze' – Drogo Aerospace's indigenous one-way attack UAV; preliminary testing held in Hyderabad
- Under development for – mission range of up to 1,000 km & warhead capacity of ~20-30 kg
- HQs of MIL – Pune, Maharashtra | CMD (Addi. charge) – Prakash Agarwala | Established in – 2021
- HQs of Drogo Aerospace – Hyderabad, Telangana | Founder & CEO – Yashwanth Bonthu | Established in – 2021

News - 190

- IAF + JASDF (Japan) = to conduct 2nd 'Veer Guardian 2026' bilateral air combat exercise
  - Scheduled at Air Force Station Jodhpur (Sep 9-21, 2026)
- Japan – deploying 3 Mitsubishi F-2A fighters from 8th Air Wing
  - It marks 1st Japanese fighter deployment to India for a bilateral air combat exercise
- 1st edition of 'Veer Guardian' – Jan 2023, at Hyakuri & Iruma air bases, Japan
- HQs of IAF – New Delhi | Chief – Air Marshal Amar Preet Singh | Vice Chief – Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit

News - 191

- DAC (chaired by Rajnath Singh) – accorded Acceptance of Necessity (AoN) for capital acquisitions worth ~₹1.10 lakh Cr
  - ~98% of procurements – planned to be sourced from Indian industry
- Army approvals – CBRN Reconnaissance Vehicles, High Mobility Vehicles, Self-Propelled Mechanical Mine Layers, ALHs, Trawl Tanks & Sarvatra Bridge System
- Navy approvals – Arudhra Radars & domestically developed Marine Gas Turbines (MGTs)
- Also approved – Ground-Based Multi-Purpose Jammers (GBMPJs) & Defence Forces Secure Access Card (DEFSAC) system
  - DEFSAC – to replace paper-based identity cards, passes & permits with interoperable RFID-based smart cards

News - 192

- Apollyon Dynamics' 'Ahuti Mk II' – became India's fastest multirotor UAV, achieving certified top speed of 498 km/h
  - It entered – 'India Book of Records' | Previous national benchmark – 325 km/h
- Apollyon Dynamics – incubated at BITS Pilani's Hyderabad Campus; founded by Jayant Khatri & Sourya Choudhary
- Record-setting drone was developed by – Aman Virani, Manas Vichare & Ishaan Suri
  - Tested at – Babina & Gopalpur military ranges (with Indian Army support)
- HQs of Apollyon Dynamics – Hyderabad, Telangana | CEO – Jayant Khatri

News - 193

- Adani Defence & Aerospace + IRRPL = a 5-year agreement to supply indigenous 7.62x39 mm ammunition for AK-203 assault rifles
- Adani Defence – to supply small-calibre ammunition required for AK-203 programme over 5-year contract period
- IRRPL – manufactures AK-203 rifles at Korwa, Amethi (UP) | Shareholding: India – 50.5% | Russia – 49.5%
  - Indian shareholders – Advanced Weapons and Equipment India Ltd & Munitions India Ltd
  - Russian shareholders – Concern Kalashnikov & Rosoboronexport
- Indian Govt + IRRPL = contract for production of 6,01,427 AK-203 rifles at Korwa in 2021
- HQs of Adani Defence & Aerospace – Ahmedabad, Gujarat | CEO – Ashish Rajvanshi
- HQs of IRRPL – New Delhi (Production Site – Amethi, UP) | CEO & MD – Maj Gen S.K. Sharma | Established in – 2019

News - 194

- Indian Army – established 'AASHVAST' laboratory at DG EME headquarters, Delhi Cantonment
  - To screen military drones for Chinese-origin components & security vulnerabilities
  - AASHVAST – Assessment and Analysis of Electronic Systems Hardware for Vulnerabilities And Security Threats
- Built by – QuickPay Tech | Inaugurated by – Dhiraj Seth (Army Chief General)
- HQs of Indian Army – New Delhi | Chief – General Dhiraj Seth | Vice Chief – Lt. General Sandeep Jain

News - 195

- DRDO – issued a Request for Proposal (RFP) for 'SHIELD' under Technology Development Fund (TDF) scheme
  - SHIELD – S-band High-Power Microwave Integrated Evaluation System for Lethality and Damage
- Technology – Gallium Nitride (GaN)-based Solid State Power Amplifier
  - Target peak electric field strength – at least 3 kV/m in far field
- HQs of DRDO – New Delhi | Chairman – Rajesh Kumar Singh (additional charge) | Established in – 1958

News - 196

- Indian Army + United States Army = commenced 22nd edition of Exercise 'Yudh Abhyas' 2026 (Sep 9-28, 2026)
  - It held in a two-theatre format for 1st time – at Mahajan Field Firing Range (Rajasthan) & Auli (Uttarakhand)
- Participation – ~350 soldiers from each country (~700 troops)
- It marks 1st deployment to India of 'Apache AH-64' attack helicopters & 'Mobile Low, Slow, Small Unmanned Aircraft Integrated Defeat System' (a counter-drone system)
- 'Yudh Abhyas' – sponsored by US Army Pacific since 2004 | 21st edition held in Alaska, US, in Sep 2025
- HQs of Indian Army – New Delhi | Chief – General Dhiraj Seth | Vice Chief – Lt. General Sandeep Jain
- US – Washington, D.C. – US Dollar | 47th President – Donald Trump | 50th VP – James David Vance

News - 197

- 4th 'Samudra Laksamana' (bilateral maritime exercise between India & Malaysia) – held at Lumut, Malaysia
- Conducted in 2 phases – a harbour phase & an operational phase at sea
- Participant ships: India – INS Mysore | Malaysia – KD Lekir & KD Gagah Samudera
- It builds on – 12th India-Malaysia Sub-Committee Meeting, held on Jul 1, 2026
- 3rd edition of Samudra Laksamana – held in 2024
- Malaysia – Kuala Lumpur – Ringgit | PM – Anwar Ibrahim | King – Sultan Ibrahim Iskandar

News - 198

- West Bengal – approved DRDO's proposal to establish a weapon & missile testing range at Junput, Purba Medinipur
- 'Junput' site (along Bay of Bengal coast) – spans ~8.73 acres
  - It received environmental clearance from MoEF&CC, & completed land acquisition & access-road construction
- It will supplement existing Integrated Test Range (ITR) at Chandipur, Odisha
- Once operational, Junput – to become DRDO's 3rd major weapon & missile testing hub
- Other hubs – 'Chandipur' & newly approved inland facility 'Navdurga' at Nagayalanka, Krishna, Andhra Pradesh
  - 'Navdurga' – being developed to support DRDO's Phase-II Ballistic Missile Defence (BMD) programme
- West Bengal: Capital – Kolkata | CM – Suvendu Adhikari | Governor – R N Ravi

News - 199

- DAD – normalised all 1,45,182 discrepant pension cases of Indian Air Force & Indian Navy on 'SPARSH' platform
  - SPARSH – **S**ystem for **P**ension **A**dministration - **R**ak**sh**a
- Break-up – Indian Air Force: 1,12,638 cases | Indian Navy: 32,544 cases
- Achieved through – a special drive undertaken in mission mode
- For Indian Army – DAD normalised 3,90,336 of the 3,94,779 identified cases (98.8%)
- Overall cases normalised across Army, Navy & Air Force – 5,35,518
- Credited to – Controller General of Defence Accounts & Principal Controller of Defence Accounts (Pension), Prayagraj
- SPARSH – launched in Oct 2020, as Ministry of Defence's centralised

News - 200

- Rajnath Singh – unveiled policy initiatives at 'VIMARSH 2026', a DRDO-Industry Synergy Meet in New Delhi
  - Theme – "Varta se Vikas" | Aim: To deepen participation of MSMEs & deep-tech start-ups in defence sector
- Initiatives include: A framework to lower technical & financial entry barriers for MSMEs & start-ups
  - A standardised framework for sharing DRDO-developed software source codes with licensee industries
- Rajnath Singh – handed over 9 Licensing Agreements for Transfer of Technology (LAToTs) to 13 manufacturing partners
- Strategic MoUs exchanged with – Society of Indian Defence Manufacturers (SIDM) & Laghu Udyog Bharati (LUB)
- Minister of Defence: Rajnath Singh | Constituency – Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh
- MoS in Ministry of Defence: Sanjay Seth

News - 201

- IG Defence (Noida) – successfully flight-tested "KAL", India's 1st indigenous long-range one-way attack drone
  - From a vehicle-mounted platform at Pokhran range in Rajasthan
- KAL belongs to emerging class of 'Shahed-136-type' long-range one-way attack drones
  - Operational range – up to 1,000 km | Endurance – 7-8 hours | Payload capacity – up to 50 kg
  - Maximum take-off weight – 200 kg | Top speed – 200 kmph
- HQs of IG Defence – Noida, UP | CEO – Bodhisattwa Sanghapriya

News - 202

- 18th edition of India-Mongolia Joint Military Exercise "Nomadic Elephant 2026" – commenced at Foreign Training Node in Pithoragarh, Uttarakhand (till Oct 3, 2026)
- Indian Army & Mongolian Armed Forces – participating with 45 personnel each
- 17th edition of this exercise – conducted at Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia (May-Jun 2025)
- Indian Army contingent – represented predominantly by a battalion of Arunachal Scouts
- Mongolia – Ulaanbaatar – Mongolian Togrog | President – Ukhnaa Khurelsukh | PM – Nyam-Osoryn Uchral

News - 203

- 13th annual bilateral maritime exercise between India & Sri Lanka, "SLINEX-26" – conducted at Visakhapatnam
  - Under aegis of – Eastern Naval Command | Timeline – Sep 17 to 21, 2026
- Indian ships – INS Kavaratti (ASW Corvette) & INS Jyoti (Fleet Tanker) | Sri Lankan ship – SLNS Sindurala
- 12th edition – held in Colombo (2025) | SLINEX – conceptualised in 2005
- Sri Lanka – Colombo/Sri Jayawardenepura Kotte – Sri Lankan Rupee
  PM – Harini Amarasuriya | President – Anura Kumar Dissanayake

News - 204

- HAL – handed over 2 LCA Tejas Final Operational Clearance (FOC) twin-seater trainer aircraft to IAF
  - Along with 1st HTT-40 basic trainer aircraft, 'Ankur'
- HAL – also handed over 4 Dhruv Next Generation (NG) helicopters to Pawan Hans Limited (PHL)
- Twin-engine Dhruv NG – powered by 2 indigenous Shakti engines
  - Pawan Hans ordered 10 such helicopters worth over ₹1,800 Cr
- HAL plans to deliver 29 Mk1A twin-seater LCA aircraft to IAF by 2033-34
- HQs of HAL – Bengaluru, Karnataka | Chairman & MD – Kota Ravi (Ravi K.) | Established in – 1940

News - 205

- Nibe Group (India) + Naval Group (France) = an MoU for cooperation in modern naval technologies
- MoU covers – underwater drones & their submarine integration, modular weapon-launching systems, mine countermeasure vessels & submarine systems/technologies
- HQs of Nibe Limited – Pune, Maharashtra | Chairman & MD – Ganesh Ramesh Nibe | Established in – 2005
- France – Paris – Euro | President – Emmanuel Macron | PM – Sebastien Lecornu

News - 206

- 2nd edition of 'Tarang Shakti 2026', IAF's multinational air exercise – to be held at Air Force Station Jodhpur, Rajasthan
  - Scheduled from – Sep 26 to Oct 12, 2026
- US Air Force's 5th-generation F-35 stealth fighter – set to participate
- 1st edition of 'Tarang Shakti' – held in 2024 in 2 phases, at Sulur (Tamil Nadu) & Jodhpur
- HQs of IAF – New Delhi | Chief – Air Marshal Amar Preet Singh | Vice Chief – Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit
- Rajasthan: Capital – Jaipur | CM – Bhajan Lal Sharma | Governor – Haribhau Kisanrao Bagde

News - 207

- INS Trishul – undertook a Passage Exercise with ENS Bernees (Egypt), before entering harbour at Alexandria, Egypt
- On arrival at Alexandria Harbour, INS Trishul was escorted by the Egyptian Naval Ship ENS Al Qadeer
- Egypt – Cairo – Egyptian Pound | President – Abdel Fattah el-Sisi

News - 208

- MoD + BDL = signed a ₹810.79 Cr contract for 160 'Satellite Smart Anti-Airfield Weapon (SAT-SAAW)' systems (with associated equipment) for IAF
- SAT-SAAW – an air-to-ground precision-guided glide bomb, launchable from Jaguar, Hawk & Su-30 MKI
  - Indigenously designed & developed by – DRDO (60% indigenous content)
- HQs of BDL – Hyderabad, Telangana | CMD – Shailesh Vagerwal
- Minister of Defence: Rajnath Singh | Constituency – Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh
- MoS in Ministry of Defence: Sanjay Seth

News - 209

- DRDO – signed its 1st high-value project agreement under 'TDF' scheme with Zero mK India Pvt Ltd (Alwar, Rajasthan)
  - For – indigenous development of a 20 millikelvin (20 mK) Dilution Refrigerator for Quantum Applications
- It is the first high-value project drawn from the ₹500 Cr TDF corpus (approved by Defence Minister Rajnath Singh)
- Dilution refrigerators – cryogenic systems reaching millikelvin-range temperatures needed to operate & test quantum computing platforms
- The project aligns with the 'National Quantum Mission (NQM)'
- TDF – a flagship MoD scheme executed by DRDO under 'Make in India'
- HQs of DRDO – New Delhi | Chairman – Rajesh Kumar Singh (additional charge) | Established in – 1958

News - 210

- INS Sahyadri & Kulish – concluded participation in 23rd "ADMM-Plus Experts' Working Group on Maritime Security Joint Cooperation Activity (EWG-MS JCA)"
  - Held at – Subic Bay, Philippines | Duration – 5 days | Hosted by – Philippine Navy | Co-chaired by – Japan
- HQs of Indian Navy – Delhi | Chief – Admiral Krishna Swaminathan | Vice Chief – VAdm Ajay Kochhar

SPORTS & GAMES

News - 211

- 5th National Taekwondo Poomsae Championship 2026 – held in Pune, MH
- Trilok Subba (Sikkim) – won gold in Senior Men's Under-60 Individual Poomsae event
- It marks his selection trial performance for World Taekwondo Poomsae Championship 2026
  - To be held in – Chuncheon, South Korea
- Adwayti Subba – won silver in Senior Women's Under-30 Individual Poomsae category
- He earlier won gold at Senior National Taekwondo Championship 2025 in Cuttack, Odisha
  - It was his 23rd national gold medal, having remained unbeaten nationally for 16 consecutive years
- He became 1st person from Northeast & 2nd in country to be promoted to Grand Master 8th Dan Black Belt by Kukkiwon
- He is founder of Sikkim Amateur Taekwondo Association (SATA) | Current President – Umesh Tamang

News - 212

- Kajal Dhochak (India) – won gold in Women's 76 kg at "2026 U20 World Wrestling Championships" in Bratislava, Slovakia
  - defeating – Jingru Sun (China)
- She became only 2nd Indian wrestler to win this gold twice (previously won 72 kg gold in 2025)
- In 2026 season, Kajal won 5 consecutive gold medals – U23 Asian Championships, Ulaanbaatar Ranking Series, U20 Asian Championships, Budapest Ranking Series & U20 World Championships
- India also won 2 Women's Wrestling silver medals through – Tanu Sharma & Savita
- Men's Freestyle – USA topped team standings after winning medals in all 10 weight categories
  - ahead of – Russia, Japan, Iran & Kazakhstan

News - 213

- "FIH Hockey World Cup 2026" campaign – held in Belgium & the Netherlands
- Women's hockey team (India) – secured best finish at tournament since inaugural 1974 edition | Defeated – Germany
  - At 1974 edition, India finished 4th under captain Ajinder Kaur
- India finished this tournament with 2 wins, 3 draws & 1 defeat from 6 matches

News - 214

- "2026 GCT Finals" – held at Saint Louis Chess Club
- R. Praggnanandhaa – became 1st Indian to win Grand Chess Tour (GCT) | Defeated – Fabiano Caruana
- This win earned him winning purse of $200,000 & a guaranteed spot in 2027 Grand Chess Tour

News - 215

- 13th North East Zone Shooting Championship 2026 – held in Guwahati, Assam
  - Under aegis of – National Rifle Association of India (NRAI)
- Laxuman Adhikari (Sikkim) – won a bronze medal in Master Men's 10m Air Pistol Individual category
  - This is 1st-ever medal won by a shooter representing Sikkim at North East Zonal level
- Two other Sikkim shooters secured national-level qualification:
  - Anu Chettri – qualified for "69th National Shooting Championship 2026" in 10m Air Pistol event
  - Tshering Yangden Bhutia – qualified in 10m Air Rifle event
- Top state in overall medal table at the Zonal Championship – Assam (80 medals)
  - Followed by – Meghalaya (37) & Manipur (31)
- Adhikari's achievement follows his silver medal in Master Men Individual 10m Air Pistol category
  - At 1st-ever "Sikkim State Shooting Championship 2026", held in June in Gangtok
- Sikkim Rifle Association (affiliated with NRAI) – established in 2024

News - 216

- "Indian Football Awards 2026" – hosted by Football Players' Association of India (FPAI) in Kolkata
- Lallianzuala Chhangte (Mohun Bagan) – "Indian Player of the Year" (Men's)
- This is Chhangte's 3rd FPAI Indian Player of Year title
  - Previously won consecutively at Indian Football Awards 2023 in Gangtok & Indian Football Awards 2024 in Goa
  - He is only 2nd player to win this award three times (after Sunil Chhetri)
- Other winners at the awards:
  - "Indian Player of the Year" (Women's) – Manisha Kalyan
  - "Indian Super League (ISL) champions" – East Bengal FC's men's team
  - "Indian Women's League (IWL) Champions" – East Bengal FC Women
  - "I-League Player of the Year" – Phrangki Buam (Shillong Lajong FC)
  - "Young Player of the Year" – Sanan Mohammed K (Jamshedpur FC)
  - "Foreign Player of the Year" – Miguel Figueira Damasceno
- Sunil Chhetri – holds record for most FPAI Indian Player of the Year wins (four)

News - 217

- "Tuanku Muhriz Trophy 2026", a PSA Challenger Tour 15 event – held in Seremban, Malaysia
- Abhay Singh (India) – won men's singles title | Defeated – Henry Leung (Hong Kong, China)
  - He claimed his 13th PSA Tour title overall & 2nd title of 2026, after his win at "JSW Indian Open" in Mumbai in March
  - This was Abhay's 3rd Tuanku Muhriz Trophy title, after previous wins in 2022 & 2024
- He is part of Indian squash squad for "Asian Games 2026" in Aichi-Nagoya
- Abhay – an Arjuna Award recipient for squash in Jan 2025
  - He was also Asian Squash Federation's Men's Player of the Year for 2025

News - 218

- Vaibhav Suryavanshi (15 years & 157 days) – became youngest player to score a half-century in "Duleep Trophy" history
  - During East Zone's semifinal against Central Zone at BCCI Centre of Excellence Ground 1 in Bengaluru
- Previous record was held by – Laxman Singh (16 years & 23 days) in 1969 edition
- Youngest player to score a century in "Duleep Trophy" – Sachin Tendulkar (17 years & 262 days) in 1990-91 edition

News - 219

- 1st round of "US Open" – held at Arthur Ashe Stadium, New York
- Aryna Sabalenka – won 1st round of "US Open" | Defeated – Camila Osorio (Colombia)
- This win extended Sabalenka's streak to 24 consecutive first-round wins at Grand Slam tournaments
  - It also marked her 14th straight victory at "US Open"
- Sabalenka is seeking to become 1st player to win 3 consecutive "US Open" singles titles since Serena Williams (2012-14)

News - 220

- "Men's FIH Hockey World Cup 2026" final – held at Belfius Hockey Arena, Wavre, Belgium
- Germany – won "Men's FIH Hockey World Cup 2026" | Defeated – Spain
  - It was Germany's 4th Men's World Cup title, equalling Pakistan's record
  - It made Germany 1st men's team to win back-to-back World Cup titles on 2 separate occasions
- "Women's FIH Hockey World Cup 2026" final – held in Amstelveen, Netherlands
- Argentina – won "Women's FIH Hockey World Cup 2026" | Defeated – Netherlands
- It was Argentina's 1st Women's World Cup title since 2010, ending Netherlands' bid for a 4th consecutive title
  - Bronze medal – Belgium | Defeated – Australia
- India's men's team (ranked 8th in world & led by Harmanpreet Singh) – finished 8th overall
- India's women's team (led by Salima Tete) – finished 5th overall

News - 221

- Roger Federer (Switzerland) – inducted into International Tennis Hall of Fame (ITHF) in 'Player Category'
  - At a ceremony held on historic Horseshoe Court in Newport, Rhode Island
- Mary Carillo (Sportscaster and journalist) – inducted in 'Contributor Category'
- Federer (20-time Grand Slam singles champion) – first male player in tennis history to reach this milestone
  - He is one of only eight men to have completed a career Grand Slam in singles
  - He won 103 career ATP titles & held World No.1 ranking for record 237 consecutive weeks between 2004 & 2008
- The weekend also featured "Hall of Fame Celebrity Pro Classic" presented by Fidelity Investments

News - 222

- Inaugural "FIFAe Continental Championship Asia 2026", ft. eFootball Mobile final – held in Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia
- India's eFootball national team – won inaugural "FIFAe Continental Championship Asia 2026" | Defeated – Japan
  - India's eFootball national team – represented by Danial Patel ('DaNiAL') & Mujtaba Husaini ('MujjiCool')
- India secured its 3rd successive qualification for FIFAe World Cup, scheduled to be held in Saudi Arabia later in 2026
- In eFootball Console category of same event, Indonesia were crowned champions | Defeated – Japan

News - 223

- SAI + BAI + SAA = a tripartite agreement to establish North East's 1st National Centre of Excellence for swimming
  - At Amingaon Sports Complex in Kamrup district, Assam
- Under this agreement, Olympic-size swimming pool at Amingaon will be made available to SAI for operating NCoE
  - Swimming pool is built by – Assam government at a cost of approximately ₹50 Cr
- HQs of SAI – New Delhi | DG – Hari Ranjan Rao | Established in – 1984
- HQs of BAI – New Delhi | President – Dr. Himanta Biswa Sarma | Established in – 1934
- Assam: Capital – Dispur | CM – Himanta Biswa Sarma | Governor – Lakshman Prasad Acharya

News - 224

- Lionel Messi (Argentina) – announced his retirement from international football
  - His senior debut was against Hungary in Aug 2005
- He retires as Argentina's most-capped player & all-time leading scorer, with 207 appearances, 125 goals & 68 assists
  - He surpasses Javier Mascherano's previous record of 147
- He played at 6 FIFA World Cups (2006-2026), making a record 34 World Cup appearances & scoring 21 World Cup goals
- His honours with Argentina include: 2022 FIFA World Cup title in Qatar | 2 Copa América titles (2021 & 2024)
  - 2022 Finalissima | An Olympic gold medal at Beijing 2008

News - 225

- Mitchell Starc (Australia) – became leading wicket-taker in history of ICC World Test Championship (WTC)
  - During Australia's 2nd Test against Bangladesh at Mackay
- Now, Starc's WTC wicket tally reached 234, at an average of 24.25
  - Including 11 four-wicket hauls, 8 five-wicket hauls & best figures of 7 for 58
- Mitchell Starc, Pat Cummins & Nathan Lyon – only bowlers with more than 200 WTC wickets
- 'Player of the Series' – Mitchell Starc

News - 226

- ICC Board – ratified India as host of inaugural "ICC Women's Champions Trophy 2027", replacing Sri Lanka
- This T20I-format tournament will be held from Feb 14 to 28, 2027, across two venues:
  - Cricket Club of India (CCI) in Mumbai & Vadodara International Cricket Stadium
  - Qualified teams – Australia, England, India, New Zealand, South Africa & Sri Lanka
- It marks 4th ICC event hosted by India in last 4 years, following:
  - Men's ODI World Cup in 2023 | Women's Cricket World Cup in 2025 | Men's T20 World Cup in 2026
- HQs of ICC – Dubai, UAE | Chairman – Jay Shah | CEO – Sanjog Gupta | Members – 108 countries

News - 227

- 'Budapest Open 2026' (Squash) – held in Budapest, Hungary
- Velavan Senthilkumar (India) – won title | Defeated – Balazs Farkas (Hungary)
  - It is his 11th PSA Squash Tour title & 1st PSA Copper-level title | His world ranking – 54
- Squash – to make its Olympic debut at Los Angeles 2028 Games

News - 228

- 'China Masters 2026' (Badminton, BWF Super 750) – held at Shenzhen Arena, Shenzhen, China
- Satwiksairaj Rankireddy & Chirag Shetty (India) – won men's doubles title | Defeated – He Jiting & Ren Xiangyu (China)
  - They became 1st Indians to win China Masters since its inception in 2005
  - It was their 10th BWF World Tour title & 4th Super 750 title | 2nd Super 750 title of 2026 (after Singapore Open)
- An Se-young (South Korea) – won women's singles | Defeated – Tomoka Miyazaki
  - It was her 3rd consecutive China Masters title & 7th individual title of 2026

News - 229

- India's U20 football team (Blue Colts) – qualified for 'AFC U20 Asian Cup China 2027'
  - Defeated – Bangladesh at Do'stlik Stadium, Tashkent, Uzbekistan | India's coach – Mahesh Gawali
- India – finished 2nd in Group B | Last appearance – 2006
- Main tournament – China (Mar 24 to Apr 10, 2027) | Top 4 finishers – to qualify for FIFA U20 World Cup 2027

News - 230

- 19th 'International Earth Science Olympiad (IESO) 2026' – held in Turin, Italy (Aug 20-27, 2026)
- India – won 9 medals (4 gold, 3 silver & 2 bronze)
- Team India secured medals across categories: Written & Practical Examinations
  - International Team Field Investigation (ITFI) | Earth Science Project (ESP)
- Soumik Mandal (West Bengal) – won 2 gold & 1 silver; ranked 3rd globally in individual standings
  - Other Indian participants – Aaron Maiti, Riddhi Ranjan & Mohammed Ehtesham Rizvi
- Participation – 39 countries | India's national selection conducted by – Geological Society of India

News - 231

- Smriti Mandhana – became leading run-scorer in women's international cricket across all formats
  - She scored 10,880 international runs | Previous record – Mithali Raj (10,868)
  - She scored 124 off 64 balls against Hong Kong, China, in 'Women's Asia Cup 2026' at Dubai International Stadium
- Most international centuries across formats: Mandhana – 18
  - Previous record: Meg Lanning (Australia) & Laura Wolvaardt (South Africa) – 17 each
- It was her 2nd WT20I century; she became 1st Indian woman with multiple WT20I centuries
  - 1st – 112 against England in 2025
- Her 124 is highest individual score in Women's T20 Asia Cup
  - Previous record – Chamari Athapaththu, Sri Lanka (119 against Malaysia in 2024)
  - It is also highest individual score by an Indian batter in Women's T20Is

News - 232

- 'World Archery Para Series' Stage III – held in Ahmedabad, Gujarat
  - India – won 7 medals on penultimate day (2 gold, 2 silver & 3 bronze)
- Para Compound Men's Team event: gold by Toman Kumar & Shyam Sunder Swami
- Para Recurve Men's Team event: gold by Harvinder Singh & Vijay Sundi
- Para Recurve Women's Team event: silver by Bhawna & Pooja
- W1 Mixed Team event: silver in Adil Mohamed Nazir Ansari & Swati Chaudhary

- 3 Bronze medal: Adil Mohamed Nazir Ansari & Vinayak Amol Breed | Swati Chaudhary & Vasundhra Teotia
  - Swati Chaudhary (individual bronze)

News - 233

- 'Pickleball World Cup 2026' – held in Da Nang, Vietnam
- India – finished 4th among 82 nations (7 gold, 17 silver & 17 bronze) | India finished at 7th place in its previous edition

News - 234

- 'WTT Feeder Olomouc' – held in Czechia
- Ankur Bhattacharjee (India) – won maiden WTT Men's Singles title
  - Defeated – Deni Kozul (Slovenia) | Ankur's world ranking – 78
- Ankur Bhattacharjee + Akash Pal = won Men's Doubles title at same event

News - 235

- East Zone (captain - Ishan Kishan) – won "Duleep Trophy 2026-27" | Defeated – South Zone
  - Held at – MA Chidambaram Stadium, Chennai
- Player of the Match – Ishan Kishan (East Zone) | Player of the Series – Tilak Varma (South Zone)

News - 236

- BCCI – named Campa, SBI Life & ChatGPT as Associate Partners for India's home international cricket season
  - Deal – 35 matches across 2 seasons, running through Mar 2028, covering home bilateral fixtures of both men's & women's teams
- 3 partnerships combined value of over ₹130 Cr for 2-season period
  - It marks a 44% increase over previous commercial cycle
- Campa – highest bidder at ₹1.31 Cr per match | ChatGPT & SBI Life – secured at ₹1.2 Cr per match each
- HQs of BCCI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | President – Mithun Manhas | Secretary – Devajit Saikia | Founded in – 1928

News - 237

- "Women's Asia Cup 2026" final – held at Dubai International Cricket Stadium, UAE
- India Women (captain - Harmanpreet Kaur) – won 'Women's Asia Cup 2026' final | Defeated – Sri Lanka
  - It is India's record-extending 8th Asia Cup title & 4th in tournament's T20 format
- Shafali Verma & Smriti Mandhana – 129 runs for 1st wicket (highest partnership for any wicket in tournament's history)
- Women's Asia Cup – organised by Asian Cricket Council & 1st held in 2004; in T20 format since 2012
  - India – most successful side with 8 titles from 10 editions
- Some important awards related to this tournament:
  - Player of the Series (Player of the Tournament) – Deepti Sharma (India)
  - Highest Run-scorer – Shafali Verma (India)
  - Highest Wicket-taker – Deepti Sharma (India)
- Player of the Match – Shafali Verma (India)

News - 238

- Karan Singh (Tennis - Haryana) – won back-to-back ITF Men's World Tennis Tour M15 singles titles at Bali Beach Country Club, Bali, Indonesia
  - Defeated – Alexander Chang (USA)
- In Semi-final, the 5th-seeded Karan defeated – Digvijay Pratap Singh (compatriot & 4th seed)
- Career total of Karan – 5 ITF singles titles & 3 doubles titles | Ranking points from Bali – 30 (15 from this title)
- Karan had also won ITF M15 Astana doubles title (Kazakhstan) in Aug 2026, partnering Martin Borisiouk (Belarus)

News - 239

- Dhiraj Bommadevara – 1st Indian male archer to win an individual title at 'Archery World Cup Final', at Saltillo, Mexico
  - Defeated – Nakanishi Junya (Japan) in men's recurve event
- Dhiraj became only the 2nd Indian archer overall to win an individual title at the event
  - 1st – Dola Banerjee (women's recurve gold, Dubai, 2007)
- He ended a 16-year wait for an Indian male recurve archer to medal at the World Cup Final
  - Last medal – Jayanta Talukdar's bronze (Edinburgh, 2010)
- India's 2026 Archery World Cup season – 7 medals (4 gold) across 4 stages in Puebla, Shanghai, Antalya & Madrid

News - 240

- India's Junior women's team – won gold at 'AHF Junior Asia Cup 2026' hockey tournament in Moqi, China
  - defeating – hosts China
- Junior women's team – completed a hat-trick with their 3rd consecutive title, remaining unbeaten
  - Captain – Khaidem Shileima Chanu | New Coach – Tim White
  - Sanika Chandrakant Mane – scored the only goal of the final (in the 17th minute)
- The win secured India's qualification for 'FIH Junior Women's World Cup 2027'
- India's Junior men's team – won gold at 'AHF Junior Asia Cup 2026'
  - defeating – South Korea | New Coach – Frederic Soyez | Captain – Anmol Ekka
  - It is their 6th continental title & 4th in succession, after 2004, 2008, 2015, 2023 & 2024
- Hockey India prize money for both men's & women's team – ₹3 lakh per player | ₹1.5 lakh per support staff member
- HQs of Hockey India – New Delhi | President – Dr. Dilip Tirkey | Established in – 2009

News - 241

- Pramod Bhagat (India, former Paralympic champion) – won gold in Men's Singles SL3 event at 'Japan Para Badminton International 2026' in Tokyo, Japan
  - Defeated – fellow Indian U Kumar in the final
- He also won silver in Men's Doubles SL3-SU5, partnering Sukant Kadam
  - Lost to – Hikmat Ramdani & Fredy Setiawan (Indonesia) in the final
- Sukant Kadam – reached a milestone of 100 career medals during the tournament

News - 242

- ATP Challenger 50 'Sport Festival Challenger' in Phan Thiet, Vietnam
- Winner of men's doubles title – S D Prajwal Dev (India) & Constantin Bittoun Kouzmine (France)
  - defeated – Yamato Sueoka & Naoki Tajima (Japan) in the final
- It is Dev's 2nd ATP Challenger Tour doubles title | Maiden title – 2023 President's Cup, Kazakhstan

News - 243

- "US Open 2026" tennis tournament – held at Arthur Ashe Stadium, New York
- Winner of Women's singles title – Elena Rybakina (Kazakhstan) | Defeated – Aryna Sabalenka (Belarus)
  - It is her 3rd Grand Slam singles title & 2nd major of 2026
  - The win made Rybakina the new World No. 1, ending Sabalenka's stint at the top of WTA rankings
- Winner's cheque – $5.5 million
  - It marked Rybakina's 10th career win over a World No. 1 player, 6 of them against Sabalenka
- Winner of Men's singles title – Alexander Zverev | Defeated – Ben Shelton (USA)
  - Ben Shelton – became 1st Black man to reach US Open men's final since Arthur Ashe
- Winner of Women's Doubles title – Katerina Siniakova (Czech Republic) & Taylor Townsend (US)
- Winner of Men's Doubles title – Christian Harrison (US) & Neal Skupski (UK)
- Winner of Mixed Doubles title – Karolina Muchova & Jakub Mensik (Czech Republic)
- US Open – 4th & final Grand Slam of the tennis calendar year (after the Australian Open, French Open & Wimbledon)
  - It's the only Grand Slam held in North America (played on hard court)
- Five main categories – Men's Singles, Women's Singles, Men's Doubles, Women's Doubles, Mixed Doubles

News - 244

- Mansukh Mandaviya – announced a 10-member Task Force to assess feasibility of reviving Formula 1 racing in India
  - India aims to host a race by 2028
  - It will be chaired by – Yugal Kishore Joshi (Programme Director & Adviser, NITI Aayog)
- India last hosted F1 Grand Prix at – Buddh International Circuit, Greater Noida, UP (2011-2013)
- Formula 1 – governed by Federation Internationale de l'Automobile (FIA)
- Minister of Youth Affairs & Sports: Mansukh L. Mandaviya | Constituency – Porbandar, Gujarat
- MoS in Ministry of Youth Affairs & Sports: Raksha Nikhil Khadse

News - 245

- IOA – announced 2 new memorial trophies for best athletes at Asian Games | 2026 edition in – Aichi-Nagoya, Japan
  - 'Raja Randhir Singh Trophy' – best male athlete | 'Jaspal Rana Trophy' – best female athlete
- Announced during launch of book – 'Maverick Jaspal', co-authored by S Kannan & G Rajaraman
- Raja Randhir Singh – served as IOA Secretary General for 25 years (1987-2012) & as President of OCA
- Jaspal Rana – shooter & pistol coach who helped Manu Bhaker win 2 bronze medals at Paris 2024 Olympics
  - Honours – Arjuna Award (1994) | Padma Shri (1997) | Dronacharya Award (2020)
- HQs of IOA – New Delhi | President – P. T. Usha | CEO – Raghuram Iyer

News - 246

- James Rodriguez (Colombia) – announced retirement from international football, ending a 15-year career (2011-2026)
- He retires as Colombia's record cap holder – 131 appearances | Goals – 31 | Assists – 43
  - Colombia's all-time leading assist provider & 2nd-highest goalscorer (behind Radamel Falcao Garcia)
- He won 'Golden Boot' at 2014 FIFA World Cup (Brazil), scoring 6 goals in 5 matches
- He was named 'Best Player' of 2024 Copa America; Colombia lost final to Argentina
- His final international appearance – Round of 16 at 2026 World Cup

News - 247

- World Athletics – awarded '2029 World Athletics Championships' to Nairobi, Kenya (venue – Kasarani Stadium)
  - It will be 1st time the event is held in Africa
- 2031 edition – awarded to Munich, Germany | Germany's 3rd time as host (after Stuttgart 1993 & Berlin 2009)
- Decision taken at – 242nd 'World Athletics Council Meeting' in Budapest
- Nairobi 2029 – last World Championships to include marathon; standalone marathon championships from 2030
- UEFA Executive Committee (Thessaloniki, Greece) – named Allianz Arena, Munich as host of '2028 UEFA Champions League' final
  - Its 3rd time hosting final (after 2012 & 2025)
- 2029 final – Camp Nou, Barcelona | 2027 final – Estadio Metropolitano, Madrid (Jun 5, 2027)
- Women's Champions League final: 2028 – Parc Olympique Lyonnais, Lyon-Decines | 2029 – Principality Stadium, Cardiff

News - 248

- 20 NCC girl cadets – completed 'Aparajita - Parang La 2026' All India Girls High Altitude Long Trek
  - Traversed – 5,578-m Parang La Pass, connecting Spiti Valley (HP) with Changthang region (Ladakh)
- Cadets covered ~250 km in 30 days – from Kibber (HP) to Karzok (Ladakh)
- Flagged-in at Karzok by – Lt Gen Virendra Vats (DG NCC) & Dipti Mohil Chawla (Additional Secretary, MoD)
- Flagged off from New Delhi by – Rajnath Singh on Aug 18, 2026

News - 249

- Brendan Taylor (Zimbabwe) – became holder of longest career in men's ODI cricket
  - achieved after being named in Zimbabwe's XI for 1st ODI against Australia in Harare
- His ODI career – 22 years & 148 days | Previous record – Sachin Tendulkar (22 years & 91 days)
  - 3rd – Sanath Jayasuriya, Sri Lanka (21 years & 184 days)
- Tendulkar still holds – most runs in men's ODIs (18,426) & most ODI appearances (463)
- '2027 ODI World Cup' – to be jointly hosted by South Africa, Zimbabwe & Namibia

News - 250

- Suchika Tariyal (Haryana) – won bronze in women's Traditional 60kg MMA at 'Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games 2026'
  - It is India's 1st-ever Asian Games medal in Mixed Martial Arts (MMA); MMA made its debut as a medal sport
- Men's 10m air rifle team (Rudrankksh Patil, Parth Mane & Himanshu Dhillon) – won silver (1890.1)
  - Gold – China (world record 1899) | Bronze – South Korea
- Elavenil Valarivan – won women's 10m air rifle team silver (with Sonam Maskar & Vidarsa Vinod) & individual silver
  - Individual gold – Hinata Taichi (Japan)

News - 251

- 46th 'FIDE Chess Olympiad' – held in Samarkand, Uzbekistan
- Indian men's team – won (5 consecutive match wins) | Defeated – Netherlands
- R Praggnanandhaa – defeated Anish Giri | D Gukesh (World Champion) – defeated Erwin l'Ami
- Indian women's team (dropped to 8th place) – lost to Poland

News - 252

- "Asian Games 2026" – held in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan | India – won three shooting medals
- In men's 10m air rifle individual event: Himanshu Dhillon – won silver | Rudrankksh Patil – won bronze
- In men's 10m air rifle team event: Men's team (Patil, Dhillon & Parth Rakesh Mane) – won silver
- Earlier winners: In women's individual 10m air rifle event – Elavenil Valarivan (silver)
  - In women's team event of 10m air rifle event – India (silver)
  - In women's 60kg category – Suchika Tariyal (bronze)
- Suchika Tariyal – became 1st Indian athlete to win a medal in Mixed Martial Arts (MMA)
- India – moved to 12th place in overall medal standings with 6 medals (4 silver & 2 bronze)
- "Asian Games 2026" – 20th edition of quadrennial multi-sport event

News - 253

- Yugan Sakthivel Muthukumaar (IN) – gold in men's trap event at 'ISSF Junior World Cup Shotgun 2026' in Porpetto, Italy
  - Silver – Francesco Tanfoglio (Italy) | Bronze – Simone Roncen (Italy)
- It was India's 1st medal at the Porpetto meet – the 2nd ISSF Junior World Cup of 2026
- Opening tournament – held in Cairo, Egypt (Apr 2026)
  - India topped the medal tally with 16 medals (5 gold, 6 silver & 5 bronze)

News - 254

- Pawan Sehrawat (Kabaddi) – named India's male flag-bearer for the opening ceremony of the 20th Asian Games at Aichi-Nagoya, Japan
  - Female flag-bearer – Manu Bhaker (double Olympic medallist)
- He was a late replacement for – Tajinderpal Singh Toor (shot putter)
- Sehrawat was part of India's gold-medal-winning men's kabaddi team at the previous Asian Games (Hangzhou)

News - 255

- India – to host the 11th Asian Senior Wushu Championships in 2028, for the 1st time in the country
  - Decision approved at – the Wushu Federation of Asia (WFA) Congress in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan
- Bhupender Singh Bajwa (WAI President) – nominated as a member of the Executive Committee of the WFA
- HQs of Wushu Association of India – Meerut, UP | President – Bhupender Singh Bajwa | Established in – 1989
- HQs of Wushu Federation of Asia – Macau, China | President – Chan Weng Kit | Established in – 1987

News - 256

- 'Asian Games 2026' (20th edition) – held in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan
- Mirabai Chanu (India) – won silver in women's 49kg weightlifting event | It is her maiden Asian Games medal
  - She lifted a total of 198kg – 87kg (snatch) + 111kg (clean & jerk)
- Gold – Ri Song Gum (North Korea), with (94kg + 121kg) | Bronze – Luluk Diana Tri Wijayana (Indonesia), 191kg
- Last Indian lifter on podium – Karnam Malleswari (silver, women's 63kg, Bangkok 1998)

News - 257

- Savita Punia (goalkeeper) – became most-capped player in Indian women's hockey history
  - It makes her 321st senior international appearance
  - Milestone reached in India's Pool B match against Indonesia at 'Asian Games 2026' in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan
- Previous record – 320 caps by Vandana Katariya

- She reached her 300th cap in Feb 2025: 2nd Indian woman – after Vandana
  - 2nd Indian goalkeeper to cross 300 caps – after PR Sreejesh
- Hockey India announced a cash reward of ₹10 lakh for her

News - 258

- India women's cricket team – retained their Asian Games title in final at Korogi Sports Park, Nisshin, Japan
  - Defeated – Sri Lanka | It was their 2nd consecutive gold, after their maiden title at Hangzhou 2023
- India posted 216/3 in 20 overs – highest total in Women's Asian Games history
- Smriti Mandhana – top-scored with 79 off 45 balls
  - She became 1st woman cricketer to complete 11,000 international runs
- Shafali Verma (48 off 29) – set a new record for most runs by a woman in Women's T20Is in a calendar year
  - Previous record – Laura Wolvaardt (824)
- 147-run margin – India's largest win by runs in Women's T20Is (previous best – 142 runs vs Malaysia in 2018)
- It was India's 1st gold medal of 'Asian Games 2026' (Aichi-Nagoya, Japan)

News - 259

- 'Asian Games 2026' – held in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan | India – added 5 more medals
- Athletics: Seema Kumari – bronze in women's 10,000m, India's 1st medal in event at Asian Games in 16 years
- Athletics: Mixed 4x400m relay team – won silver | Gold – Bahrain (Games record 3:12.87)
  - Relay quartet – Poovamma Raju, Vishal Thennarasu, Vithya Ramraj & Manu TS
- Wushu: Roshibina Devi Naorem – won silver in women's 60kg Sanda (lost 0-2 to China's Zhang Xiaoyu)
- Shooting: Anant Jeet Singh Naruka & Parinaaz Dhaliwal – won bronze in mixed skeet team event
  - India's 1st-ever medal in category
- Rowing: Satnam Singh & Salman Khan – won bronze in men's double sculls

News - 260

- 48th 'WorldSkills Competition' – held in Shanghai, China | India – secured 10th position
  - India won – 6 Silver Medals & 20 Medals for Excellence
- 1st – China (41 gold, 11 silver & 4 bronze) | Followed by – South Korea, Chinese Taipei, Switzerland & France
- India – fielded its largest-ever contingent of 70 competitors across 63 skills
- Participation coordinated by – National Skill Development Corporation (MSDE)

- 6 Silver medals were won by:
  - Smriti Nambiar in 'Bakery' | Mohammed Salam in 'Dental Prosthetics'
  - Kovid Ajay Gangrade in 'Digital Interactive Media Design' | Parth Vohra in 'Industrial Design Technology'
  - Mehrunissa Begum in 'Logistics and Freight Forwarding' | Saniya Joshi in 'Retail Sales'

PERSONS IN NEWS

News - 261

- Air Vice Marshal Shakti Sharma – became 1st woman officer from a non-medical branch in Indian Armed Forces to attain two-star rank of Air Vice Marshal on assuming charge as Assistant Chief of Air Staff (Education) at Air Headquarters
- Air Marshal Padma Bandopadhyay – earlier became Indian Air Force's 1st woman Air Vice Marshal in 2002 & later its 1st woman Air Marshal, but from Medical Branch
- HQs of IAF – New Delhi | Chief – Air Marshal Amar Preet Singh | Vice Chief – Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit

News - 262

- Krishiv Tekchandani (Golfer) – launched 'XII NOON', an ultra-luxury watch house of Bharat origin
- XII NOON – plans to produce only 45 timepieces annually, positioning around rarity, craftsmanship & exclusivity

SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

News - 263

- Google – launched "Back to School 2026" campaign introducing AI-powered education tools & student offers across Google Search, Gemini and Google Classroom
- Eligible college students outside US, including India – offered 12 months of Google AI Plus free with higher Gemini usage limits & 400 GB storage
- Student offer: Google AI Pro + YouTube Premium bundle available at up to 70% discount
- HQs of Google – California, US | CEO – Sundar Pichai | Founded in – 1998
  India Head – Preeti Lobana

News - 264

- IASST + IIT Guwahati – developed "RK-251", an experimental smart anticancer compound designed to activate selectively inside cancer cells
- The findings were published in – Journal of Medicinal Chemistry of American Chemical Society
- RK-251 – remains inactive until detecting elevated Reactive Oxygen Species (ROS) inside cancer cells, then releases anticancer compound "NBDHEX"
- NBDHEX – targets 'GSTP1' protein associated with cancer-cell survival & treatment resistance
- HQs of IASST – Guwahati, Assam | Director – Prof. Ashis K. Mukherjee | Established in – 1979
- Director of IIT Guwahati – Prof. Devendra Jalihal

News - 265

- SpaceX – to build a $100 billion rocket launch complex in southern Louisiana, its largest launch site yet
  - To support Starship & AI satellite missions
  - This 1,25,000-acre site on Pecan Island in Vermilion Parish is named as "Starbase Louisiana"
- HQs of SpaceX – Texas, U.S. | Founder & CEO – Elon Musk | Founded in – 2002

News - 266

- VP C. P. Radhakrishnan – launched "Gnani Artha", a sovereign AI stack developed by GNANI AI, at Uprashtrapati Bhavan
  - It combines 'Evon v3.3' & 'Plexus'
- Evon v3.3 – trained across 11 Indian languages, with its weights released under Apache 2.0 licence
  - It is made available on Hugging Face
- GNANI AI – a voice AI startup led by CEO Ganesh Gopalan & Co-Founder and CTO Ananth Nagaraj
  - It raised $10 million in a Series B round earlier in 2026, led by Aavishkaar Capital

News - 267

- NQM + Foundation for QC Innovation (IISc, Bengaluru) = form India's Quantum Computing Thematic Hub (QC T-Hub)
- FQCI – registered as a Section-8, not-for-profit company & operates under NQM
  - It is housed at TATA Smart-X Hub Building on IISc campus
- NQM – implemented by Department of Science and Technology (DST), Government of India
  - It was approved by Cabinet on Apr 19, 2023, with a total outlay of ₹6,003.65 Cr (2023-24 to 2030-31)
- Quantum Computing Hub – sanctioned ₹653.13 Cr

News - 268

- NASA – launched "Nancy Grace Roman Space Telescope" aboard a SpaceX Falcon Heavy rocket
  - From Launch Complex 39A at Kennedy Space Center, Florida
  - It is a flagship astrophysics observatory | Total mission cost – $4.3 billion
- It is travelling to Sun-Earth Lagrange Point 2 (L2), a journey expected to take about 100 days
- Its main instrument, Wide Field Instrument, is a 300-megapixel infrared camera built around 18 detectors
- It was ranked top-priority large space mission by 2010 US Astronomy & Decadal Survey | Estimated cost – $1.6 billion
- Its primary mirror was one of two complete telescope optical systems donated to NASA by National Reconnaissance Office in 2012
- HQs of NASA – Washington D.C., US | Administrator (15th) – Jared Isaacman | Founded in – 1958

News - 269

- Agnikawach Safety Solutions Pvt. Ltd. – launched "Agnikawach™", 1st platform of its kind globally
- Aim: To make advanced industrial safety technology accessible, affordable & scalable

News - 270

- Dr. Jitendra Singh – launched 'BIO-NIVESH', a platform connecting biotechnology innovators & investors, in New Delhi
  - Launched during a roundtable participation of 20 biotechnology & deep-tech startups & ~50 investors
- BIRAC (DBT) – designated as Second-Level Fund Manager for Research, Development & Innovation (RDI) Fund
  - Overall outlay of RDI Fund – ₹1 lakh Cr for biotechnology
- MoS (I/C) in the Ministry of Science & Technology & Earth Sciences: Dr. Jitendra Singh | Constituency – Udhampur, J&K

News - 271

- ISRO – launched 'EOS-05' (GISAT-1A) aboard GSLV-F17 rocket from 2nd Launch Pad at SDSC, Sriharikota, Andhra Pradesh
- It was initially placed in – Sub-Geosynchronous Transfer Orbit (Sub-GTO) | Final orbital altitude – nearly 36,000 km
- EOS-05 – a hyperspectral Earth imager with 414 spectral channels; imagery refresh – roughly every 30 minutes
- GSLV-F17 – 19th GSLV flight | Cryogenic upper stage powered by – indigenous CE-7.5 engine
- It marked ISRO's 1st successful launch of 2026 | Predecessor GISAT-1/EOS-03 – lost in 2021
- HQs of ISRO – Bengaluru, Karnataka | Director – Dr. V. Narayanan | Formed on – August 15, 1969

News - 272

- Central University of South Bihar (Gaya) – secured its 1st Indian patent for solar catalyst technology
- Inventors – Amiya Priyam, Bhavesh K. Dadhich & Bhavya Bhushan
- Technology – hollow, plasmonic silver nanoshells tunable across 1st & 2nd near-infrared windows
- Bihar: Capital – Patna | CM – Samrat Choudhary | Governor – Lt. Gen. (Retired) Syed Ata Hasnain

News - 273

- OpenAI – launched 'GPT-6 Astra', described by company as 'world's most intelligent' AI model
- HQs of OpenAI – San Francisco, USA | Chairman – Bret Taylor | CEO – Sam Altman | Established in – 2015

News - 274

- Pixxel – raised $100 million in Series C funding, India's largest single space-tech funding round
  - Now, its total funding reached – $195 million
- Round was co-led by – Temasek (Singapore) & Seraphim (UK)
- It will develop 'Honeybee' hyperspectral satellite constellation | 1st satellite launch expected – 2027
- PixxelSpace India – leads Allied Orbits consortium
  - It secured India's 1st fully indigenous commercial Earth Observation constellation contract under EO-PPP framework
- HQs of Pixxel – Bengaluru, Karnataka | Founder & CEO – Awais Ahmed

News - 275

- Bodhan AI (IIT Madras) – launched 4 foundational AI models for Indian languages, developed with AI4Bharat
- They cover: Automatic Speech Recognition (ASR) – 27 languages | Optical Character Recognition (OCR) – 23 languages
  - Text-to-Speech (TTS) – 23 languages | Bodhan-Translate – 22 Indian languages
- These models are being released as Digital Public Goods, as part of proposed 'Bharat EduAI Stack'
- Bodhan AI also launched – 'Student TutorBot' for Classes 6-12 in 22 Indian languages & a Teacher Assistant Bot
- Director of IIT Madras – Prof. V. Kamakoti

News - 276

- Isar Aerospace (Munich, Germany) – placed 'Spectrum' rocket into orbit during its 2nd test flight, 'Onward and Upward'
  - It became 1st privately developed rocket to reach orbit from continental European soil
  - Launched from – Andøya Spaceport, Norway | Orbit – circular sun-synchronous orbit (~500 km)

- Spectrum – deployed 5 CubeSats & 1 ESA-linked technology demonstration payload
  - It is a 2-stage, liquid-fuelled rocket using propane & liquid oxygen
  - Powered by – Aquila engines (9 in 1st stage & 1 in 2nd)
- 1st test flight – failed in Mar 2025

News - 277

- Astrogate Labs (Bengaluru) – developing India's 1st indigenous Optical Inter-Satellite Link (OISL) terminal
  - Flight-readiness target – 2027 | Unveiled at Bengaluru Space Expo 2026, BIEC
- 'AstroLink Micro' – its 10 Gbps space-to-ground laser communication terminal
- Astrogate – only Indian company to deliver indigenous satellite-to-ground lasercomm terminal to ISRO
- Cross-compatibility testing completed with – University of Western Australia's TeraNet mobile optical ground station
- HQs of Astrogate Labs – Bengaluru, Karnataka | Founder & CEO – Nitish K. Singh

News - 278

- GalaxEye – became 1st Indian startup to receive a US patent specifically for satellite imaging technology, for 'OptoSAR'
  - It synchronises optical & Synthetic Aperture Radar (SAR) sensors for spatially & temporally aligned imaging
- 'Mission Drishti' – world's 1st OptoSAR imaging satellite, launched on May 3, 2026
- GalaxEye – plans constellation of 30 satellites over next 5 years
  - It acquired Bengaluru-based spacecraft engineering firm 'StarOps' in Aug 2026
- HQs of GalaxEye – Bengaluru, Karnataka | CEO & Co-Founder – Suyash Singh

News - 279

- ISRO – conducted flight acceptance hot test of indigenously developed 'CE20' cryogenic engine at an uprated thrust level of 220 kN, at ISRO Propulsion Complex (IPRC), Mahendragiri, Tamil Nadu
  - Engine tested – earmarked for C32 upper stage of an upcoming Launch Vehicle Mark-3 (LVM3) mission
- Uprated configuration – aimed at increasing payload capacity of LVM3, India's heavy-lift launch vehicle
- ISRO – also demonstrated performance of 'LOX Tank Pressurisation Module (LTPM)' during same test
  - LTPM – intended for C32 stages of future Gaganyaan missions
- CE20 – powers cryogenic upper stage of LVM3 (human-rated for Gaganyaan human spaceflight programme)
  - Fuel – liquid hydrogen | Oxidiser – liquid oxygen
- HQs of ISRO – Bengaluru, Karnataka | Director – Dr. V. Narayanan | Formed on – August 15, 1969

News - 280

- Qualcomm + Amazon = a multi-generational collaboration to co-develop custom AI inference silicon & high-bandwidth optical interconnects for AWS hyperscale data centres
- Optical connectivity component – targeting speeds of up to 1.6 terabits per second
  - It draws on technology from Qualcomm's $2.4 billion acquisition of Alphawave Semi
- Qualcomm issued warrants for Amazon to acquire 25 million shares (~$4 billion)
- HQs of Amazon – Seattle, US | CEO – Andy Jassy | Incorporated in – 1994
- HQs of Qualcomm – San Diego, California, USA | President & CEO – Cristiano Amon | Established in – 1985

News - 281

- Samtel Avionics Ltd. (India) + BULL Co. Ltd. (Japan) = an MoU to jointly explore space debris mitigation solutions
- India's goal – debris-free space missions by 2030
- As per ESA – ~40,000 objects currently tracked in orbit; 1.2 million+ debris pieces larger than 1 cm may be present
- HQs of Samtel Avionics Ltd – Delhi | Chairman (Samtel Group) – Satish Kumar Kaura | MD & CEO – Puneet Kaura

News - 282

- Meta – launched 'Muse', a personal AI agent to carry out tasks such as sending emails, online shopping, booking travel & negotiating bills
- Powered by – Meta's 'Muse Spark 1.3' model, developed under Chief AI Officer Alexandr Wang
- Available for users aged 18 & over – launched first in US via web (muse.ai), iOS & Android apps & WhatsApp chats
- Free tier – up to 100 million tokens per week | Paid tiers – 'Power' at $20 per month & 'Maximum' at $100 per month
- HQs of Meta – California, US | CEO – Mark Zuckerberg | Founded in – 2004

News - 283

- MeitY – granted in-principle approval for 'Centre of Excellence in AI' in Bhubaneswar, Odisha, under 'IndiaAI Mission'
  - Implemented by – Software Technology Parks of India (STPI)
- Industry partner – Blue Cloud Softech Solutions (Hyderabad), committing ₹4 Cr
- Odisha-specific priority sectors – Oceanography, Coastal Fisheries, Tidal & Ocean Energy, Women & Child Development
- Odisha: Capital – Bhubaneswar | CM – Mohan Charan Majhi | Governor – Dr Hari Babu Kambhampati

News - 284

- NASA – announced discovery of 'McGetchin' crater on Moon's eastern edge
  - largest newly formed impact crater ever identified in solar system (Named after – lunar scientist Tom McGetchin)
- Formed – between Apr 11 & May 22, 2024 | Size – ~222 m wide & 43 m deep
- Identified using data from – NASA's Lunar Reconnaissance Orbiter (LRO)
  - First spotted by – LRO scientist Robert Wagner on Oct 24, 2025
- The data from LRO's Diviner thermal instrument detected a roughly 7-kilometre-wide "cold spot" around the crater
- Findings published in – 'Science Advances' journal
- HQs of NASA – Washington D.C., US | Administrator (15th) – Jared Isaacman | Founded in – 1958

News - 285

- Dr. Jitendra Singh – inaugurated India's 51st Doppler Weather Radar (DWR) at Jamadarpali, Sambalpur, Odisha
  - under 'Mission Mausam'
- Odisha now has 3 DWRs – Gopalpur, Paradip & Sambalpur
- National DWR network – expanded to 51 (from 14 in 2014) | ~40 more planned, taking total to ~81
- 'Make in India' radar – covers 250 km radius at 150 m resolution, updating every 10 minutes
  - Covers – 13 districts of western Odisha
- IMD – provides weather & early warning support to 13 neighbouring countries
- Odisha: Capital – Bhubaneswar | CM – Mohan Charan Majhi | Governor – Dr Hari Babu Kambhampati

News - 286

- Dr. Jitendra Singh + Prof. Philippe Baptiste (France) = agreed to deepen India-France space cooperation
- Meeting held ahead of – 'International Space Summit' in Paris (Sep 9-10, 2026) & 'Bengaluru Space Expo' (Sep 7-9, 2026)
- The cooperation included 2 joint satellite missions between ISRO + CNES (France) (both launched by PSLV):
  - 'Megha-Tropiques' – launched on Oct 12, 2011, aboard PSLV-C18, to study water cycle in tropical atmosphere
  - 'Satellite for ARGOS and ALTIKA (SARAL)' – launched on Feb 25, 2013, aboard PSLV-C20, uses radar altimetry for oceanographic studies
- France – Paris – Euro | President – Emmanuel Macron | PM – Sebastien Lecornu
- HQs of ISRO – Bengaluru, Karnataka | Director – Dr. V. Narayanan | Formed on – August 15, 1969

News - 287

- NIT (Srinagar) – inaugurated 'NIT Srinagar Observatory for Astronomy and Astrophysics (NSOAA)'
  - NIT Srinagar – 1st NIT to have a dedicated campus-based observatory
- Built around – a 14-inch Celestron C14 EdgeHD aplanatic Schmidt-Cassegrain telescope
- Developed with scientific guidance from – Indian Institute of Astrophysics (IIA), Bengaluru
  - Project led by – Prof. Prince Ahmad Ganai, Head of the Department of Physics at NIT Srinagar

News - 288

- INCOIS – launched pilot phase of 'National Initiative for Remediation of Marine Litter (NIRMaL Sāgar)' at Visakhapatnam
  - Launched on the concluding day of the week-long 'Swachh Sagar, Surakshit Sagar (SSSS) 5.0' campaign
- Aim: To establish India's 1st integrated marine litter tracking framework
- Launched in association with – Andhra University & Vignana Bharati (VIBHA)
- 'Swachh Sagar, Surakshit Sagar' – originally launched by MoES in 2022 as a 75-day citizen-led coastal clean-up campaign
- HQs of INCOIS – Hyderabad, Telangana | Director – Dr. T. M. Balakrishnan Nair | Established in – 1999

News - 289

- ESA + ISRO = signed an exchange of letters extending their 'Cooperative Agreement' for 5 years, until Jan 8, 2032
- It builds on a Joint Statement of Intent on human exploration signed by the two agencies in 2025
- HQs of ESA – Paris, France | DG – Josef Aschbacher
- HQs of ISRO – Bengaluru, Karnataka | Director – Dr. V. Narayanan | Formed on – August 15, 1969

News - 290

- Assam CM – laid the foundation stone of ISRO's (ISTRAC) Advanced Radar Research Facility (IARRF) at Chandrapur
  - Established under – ISRO's 'Project NETRA (Network for Space Object Tracking and Analysis)'
- It will house India's 1st dedicated debris-tracking phased-array radar (+ a separate cloud-research radar), expected to be commissioned by ~Feb 2027
- Project NETRA's other components – an optical telescope facility at Hanle, Ladakh & the central data-fusion/control centre at Bengaluru
- Assam: Capital – Dispur | CM – Himanta Biswa Sarma | Governor – Lakshman Prasad Acharya

News - 291

- TDB (DST) + Agnikul Cosmos = an agreement for ₹200 Cr support under Research Development & Innovation Fund
  - Provided through – Optionally Convertible Debentures (OCD)
- Funding – to develop 'Agnibaan Reusable Launch Vehicle (RLV)'; taking technology from TRL-4+ to TRL-8
- Agnikul's earlier work – 'Agnibaan' orbital-class launch vehicle & 'Agnilet' engine (single-piece 3D-printed rocket engine)
- HQs of Agnikul Cosmos – Chennai, Tamil Nadu | Co-Founder & CEO – Srinath Ravichandran

News - 292

- IIT Delhi – designed India's 1st indigenously designed micro-Graphics Processing Unit (GPU) from a university
- Project led by – Nammi Akash & M. Ravi Teja (M.Tech students) | Under – Professors Jayadeva & Kaushik Saha
- GPU engine – implemented in Register Transfer Language (RTL) & mapped to a Spartan-7 Field Programmable Gate Array (FPGA) platform
- Director of IIT Delhi – Prof. Rangan Banerjee

APPOINTMENTS & RESIGNATIONS

News - 293

- Crown Prince Haakon (Haakon Magnus) – became King Haakon VIII of Norway (succeeding - King Harald V)
- Haakon represents 4th generation of reigning House of Glücksburg
- Norway – Oslo – Norwegian Krone | PM – Jonas Gahr Store

News - 294

- John Ternus – took charge as Apple's CEO on Sep 1, 2026 (succeeding – Tim Cook)
- Tim Cook – appointed as Executive Chairman of Apple's board of directors
- HQs of Apple – California, US | CEO – John Ternus

News - 295

- Air Marshal Vivek Hande – took over as Director General Medical Services (DGMS, Air) of IAF on Sep 1, 2026
  - Succeeding – Air Marshal Sandeep Thareja
- Currently, he is serving as – Director General (Organisation & Personnel), Armed Forces Medical Services (AFMS)

News - 296

- Ashish Shelar – elected as President of Esports Games Federation (ESGF)
- ESGF – a national esports body set up as a rival organisation to Esports Federation of India (EFI)
- Shelar is also a board member of Asian Cricket Council & has previously served as Treasurer of BCCI & President of MCA
- HQs of ESGF – New Delhi, Delhi | President – Shankar Agarwal | Established in – 2023

News - 297

- Air Marshal (Retd.) Jeetendra Mishra – appointed as 1st CEO of Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust, Ayodhya
- Most recently, he served as – Air Officer Commanding-in-Chief, Western Air Command, Indian Air Force
- It also appointed 3 new trustees at same meeting: Mahesh Bhagchandka, Madan Mohan Pandey & Dr Nirmala Yadav

News - 298

- Peyman Kargar – appointed as Director & CEO of TVS Motor, w.e.f. Jan 27, 2026 (succeeding - K. N. Radhakrishnan)
- HQs of TVS Motor Company – Chennai, Tamil Nadu | CMD – Sudarshan Venu | CEO – K N Radhakrishnan

News - 299

- Ülle Madise (Chancellor of Justice) – elected as President of Estonia for 5 years (succeeding - Alar Karis)
  - She became Estonia's 2nd female President | 1st – Kersti Kaljulaid (2016-2021)
- Estonia – Tallinn – Euro | President – Alar Karis (from Oct 12, 2026 – Ulle Madise) | PM – Kristen Michal

News - 300

- Sundeep Sikka (ED & CEO, Nippon Life India Asset Management) – re-elected as Chairman of AMFI
- Vishal Kapoor (CEO, Bandhan Asset Management Company) – re-elected as Vice Chairman of AMFI
- HQs of AMFI – Mumbai | Chairman – Sundeep Sikka | CEO – Venkat Nageswar Chalasani | Incorporated in – 1995

News - 301

- Prof. V. Gopikrishna (Chennai) – became 1st Indian President of International Federation of Endodontic Associations
  - He previously became 1st Indian & 2nd Asian to be elected IFEA Secretary, serving from 2020
  - He was 1st Indian to chair IFEA's Education Committee (2016-2020)
- He is author of – 'Grossman's Endodontic Practice'
- HQs of IFEA – Glen Ellyn, Illinois, US | President – Dr. Elisabetta Cotti (Italy) | Established in – 1986

News - 302

- Anil Chakravarthy – appointed as Adobe's next President & CEO, w.e.f. Dec 1, 2026 (succeeding – Shantanu Narayen)
- Shantanu Narayen – to be appointed as Executive Chair of Adobe
- HQs of Adobe – California, US | President & CEO – Shantanu Narayen (Anil Chakravarthy - from Dec 1, 2026)

News - 303

- President Droupadi Murmu – appointed Chief Justices to 8 High Courts under Articles 217 & 222

Names	Appointed as Chief Justice of
Justice Valluri Kameswar Rao (judge of Delhi High Court)	Patna High Court
Justice Ravindra Vithalrao Ghuge (judge of Bombay High Court)	Calcutta High Court
Justice Sanjay Kumar Agrawal (Acting Chief Justice of Chhattisgarh High Court)	Rajasthan High Court
Justice Mahesh Chandra Tripathi (judge of Allahabad High Court)	Bombay High Court
Justice Krushna Ram Mohapatra (judge of Orissa High Court)	Chhattisgarh High Court
Justice Alpesh Yeshwant Kogje (judge of Gujarat High Court)	MP High Court
Justice Dr. Pushpendra Singh Bhati (judge of Rajasthan High Court)	J&K & Ladakh High Court
Justice Ashwani Kumar Mishra (Acting Chief Justice)	Punjab & Haryana High Court

News - 304

- Giorgia Meloni's govt – became Italy's longest-serving administration since World War II, completing 1,413 consecutive days on Sep 4, 2026
- Previous record – Silvio Berlusconi's 2nd administration serving 1,412 days (2001-2005)
- Giorgia Meloni – Italy's 1st woman PM | Party – Brothers of Italy
- Italy – Rome – Euro | President – Sergio Mattarella | PM – Giorgia Meloni

News - 305

- Dr. Dinesh Sharma – appointed as 15th Lieutenant Governor of Andaman & Nicobar Islands
  - Succeeding – Admiral D.K. Joshi (Retd.)
- Previously, he served as – Deputy Chief Minister of Uttar Pradesh (2017-2022)
- Andaman & Nicobar Islands: Capital – Port Blair | Lieutenant Governor – Dr. Dinesh Sharma

News - 306

- Dr. Vinaya Prakash Singh – re-elected as Secretary-General of Asian-Pacific Postal Union for 2nd consecutive 4-year term
- 14th APPU Congress – held in Bangkok, Thailand | His term – Jan 2027 to Dec 2030
- HQs of APPU Secretariat – Bangkok, Thailand | Secretary General – Dr. Vinaya Prakash Singh | Established in – 1961

News - 307

- Bhagwat Prasad Makwana – appointed as Chairperson of National Commission for Safai Karamcharis up to Mar 31, 2028
- Kaishab Bihari – appointed as Vice-Chairperson of NCSK up to Mar 31, 2028
- Manoj Kumar Balmiki, Sushma Gaudiyal & Ravi Ramu Kalose – appointed as member of NCSK up to Mar 31, 2028
- NCSK – currently a non-statutory body; originally constituted in 1994 under NCSK Act, 1993
- HQs of NCSK – New Delhi | Chairperson – Bhagwat Prasad Makwana | Established in – 1994

News - 308

- Vinai Kumar Saxena (LG of Ladakh) – given additional charge of LG of J&K
  - He became 1st LG of Ladakh to administer oath to incoming Chief Justice of J&K & Ladakh High Court since 2019
- J & K: Capital – Srinagar | CM – Omar Abdullah | Lt. Governor – Vinai Kumar Saxena (addi. charge)

News - 309

- George Kovoor – appointed as CEO of Parle Biscuits
  - He became 1st CEO from outside founding Chauhan family in company's history
- Previously, he served as – Senior VP & General Manager of PepsiCo's India beverages business
- HQs of Parle Biscuits (Parle Products) – Mumbai | CEO – George Kovoor | Established in – 1929

News - 310

- Sai Giridhar – appointed as 38th President of FADA for 2026-28 (succeeding – C S Vigneshwar)
  - FADA – Federation of Automobile Dealers Associations
- HQs of FADA – New Delhi | President – Sai Giridhar | CEO – Saharsh Damani | Established in – 1964

News - 311

- Shenu Agarwal (MD & CEO of Ashok Leyland) – elected as President of Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers (SIAM) for 2026-27 term
  - Succeeding – Shailesh Chandra (MD & CEO of Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles)
- K N Radhakrishnan (Director & CEO of TVS Motor Company) – elected as Vice President of SIAM for 2026-27 term

- Santosh Iyer (MD & CEO of Mercedes-Benz India) – elected as Treasurer of SIAM for 2026-27 term
- SIAM – apex national body representing India's vehicle & vehicular engine manufacturers
- HQs of SIAM – New Delhi | President – Shenu Agarwal (Ashok Leyland) | Established in – 1996

News - 312

- Narayan Dewasi & Swaroop Singh Banjara – appointed as Members of Governing Body of Development & Welfare Board for De-notified, Nomadic & Semi-Nomadic Communities (DWBDNC)
  - Tenure – 3 years or until further orders (whichever is earlier)
  - Appointed by – Department of Social Justice & Empowerment (MoSJE)
- DWBDNC – constituted on Feb 21, 2019 as a society under 'Societies Registration Act, 1860'
  - Chairperson & CEO are appointed for 3 years (extendable up to 5 years)
- HQs of DWBDNC – New Delhi | Chairman – Sudhansh Pant | CEO – Rajan Sehgal | Established in – 2019

News - 313

- IPS Sanjukta Parashar – appointed as IG of CRPF's Commando Battalion for Resolute Action (CoBRA)
  - succeeding – Danesh Rana
- She became 1st woman officer to head CoBRA, a 10-battalion jungle warfare & counter-insurgency force
- Previously, she headed – Criminal Investigation Department (CID) of Assam Police
  - Known as – 'Iron Lady of Assam'
- CoBRA – raised by CRPF in 2008-09 to tackle left-wing extremism
- HQs of CRPF – New Delhi | DG – Gyanendra Pratap Singh | Formed on – July 27, 1939 | Motto – "Service & Loyalty"

News - 314

- Dileep Sanghani (IFFCO Chairman) – elected as At-Large Director to Global Board of International Cooperative Alliance (ICA) for 2026-2030 term
- Previously, Mr Sanghani served as – President of National Cooperative Union of India (NCUI)
- Elected at – ICA's 2026 General Assembly, Panama Convention Centre, Panama
  - Theme of 'ICA Global Conference Week' – "Building Bridges: Cooperative Contributions to a Peaceful World"
- Dr. Ariel Guarco (Argentina) – re-elected unopposed as ICA President
- HQs of Global Board of ICA – Brussels, Belgium | President – Ariel Guarco (2026-2030 term) | Established in – 1895

News - 315

- Jayanti Prasad – given additional charge as Chairperson of IBBI, w.e.f. Sep 13, 2026 (succeeding - Ravi Mital)
- Jayanti Prasad currently serves as – Whole-Time Member of Insolvency & Bankruptcy Board of India (IBBI)
- IBBI – statutory regulator established under 'Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, 2016'
- HQs of IBBI – New Delhi, Delhi | Chairperson – Ravi Mital | Established in – 2016

News - 316

- Luke J. Lindberg – appointed as Executive Director of the World Food Programme (WFP) for a 5-year term
  - succeeding – Cindy H. McCain
  - Appointed by – UN Secretary-General Antonio Guterres & FAO Director-General Qu Dongyu
- He is a nominee of US President Donald Trump
- Carl Skau – serving as Acting Executive Director until Lindberg takes over
- HQs of WFP – Rome, Italy | Executive Director – Luke J. Lindberg | Established in – 1961

News - 317

- Tavengwa Mukuhlani (Chairman, Zimbabwe Cricket) – appointed as Deputy Chairperson of the ICC until Nov 2027
  - succeeding – Imran Khwaja
  - He became the 1st Zimbabwean to hold the post | He will work alongside ICC Chairman Jay Shah
- Zimbabwe – to co-host the 'ICC Men's Cricket World Cup 2027' with South Africa & Namibia
  - It will bring the tournament back to Africa for the 1st time in 24 years
- HQs of ICC – Dubai, UAE | Chairman – Jay Shah | CEO – Sanjog Gupta | Members – 108 countries

News - 318

- Harsh Sanghani (India) – re-elected as President of International Cooperative Alliance (ICA) Youth Committee for 2026-2030 term
  - Elected at – ICA Youth Assembly in Panama City, during ICA Global Conference and Assemblies week
  - Theme – 'Building Bridges: Cooperative Contributions to a Peaceful World'
- He was first elected to the post in Jul 2025 & is the 1st Indian to lead the Youth Committee
- As Youth Committee President, he continues as the Youth Representative on the 30-member ICA Global Board
- Assembly also elected 4 members-at-large: Salma Hachimi (Africa) | Samuel Mancilla (Americas)
  - Rami al Kasassbeh Salameh (Asia-Pacific) | Ramil Nasybullin (Europe)
- Ariel Guarco (Argentina) – re-elected unopposed as ICA President for the same term
- HQs of ICA – Brussels, Belgium | President – Ariel Guarco | DG – Jeroen Douglas | Established in – 1895

News - 319

- Mandeep K. Bhandari – appointed as Chairperson of CBSE (succeeding - Lokhande Prashant Sitaram)
- Previously, he served as – Principal Secretary to LG of Jammu & Kashmir
- HQs of CBSE – New Delhi | Chairman – Mandeep K. Bhandari | Established in – 1962

AWARDS, REWARDS, RECOGNITION & PRIZES

News - 320

- DARPG – selected for special "Rajbhasha Utkrishtta Sammaan" for 2025-26 by Department of Official Language (MHA)
- DARPG earlier won "Rajbhasha Kirti Puraskar" (First) for two consecutive years, 2023-24 & 2024-25
- A ministry or department winning 1st prize for 2 consecutive years becomes ineligible for same award in following year
- It will be conferred on DARPG during Hindi Diwas Sammelan to be held in Navi Mumbai on Sep 14, 2026
- DARPG – works under the Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances & Pensions

News - 321

- 46th "Federation of Indian Publishers (FIP) Awards for Excellence in Book Production 2026"
- Publications Division (MoI&B) – won 7 awards, recognising its editorial & publishing work across Hindi, English & Urdu
  - Presented by – Justice Sanjeev Sachdeva | It secured 4 Second Prizes & 3 Third Prizes across various categories
- Second Prize winners: "Bharat 2026" (Hindi) – in Reference Books - Hindi category
  - "Wings to Our Hopes - Volume 2" – in General and Trade Books - English category
  - "Yojana - July 2026" (Hindi), themed 'Viksit Bharat@2047' – in Journals & House Magazines - Hindi category
  - "Kurukshetra - A Rural Development Monthly Since 1952" – in Journals & House Magazines - English category
- Third Prize winners: "Dharti Ki Sehat" – in Children's Books (General Interest, 0-10 Years) - Hindi category
  - "Rangoli Roop Sur Lay Ki" – in Art and Coffee Table Books - Hindi category
  - "Ajkal Urdu - July 2026" – in Journals and House Magazines, Indian Languages (Urdu) category

News - 322

- PM Modi – conferred with "Oliy Darajali Do'stlik" Order (Order of Highest Friendship)
  - It is Uzbekistan's highest state honour for foreign leaders
  - Conferred by – Shavkat Mirziyoyev (President) | At Kuksaroy Presidential Palace in Tashkent
- 26th Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) Summit – held on Aug 31 & Sep 1, 2026
- PM Modi has now received more than 30 prestigious international honours from foreign nations & organisations
- Uzbekistan – Tashkent – Uzbekistani Som | PM – Abdulla Nigmatovich Aripov | President – Shavkat Mirziyoyev

News - 323

- Tommy Koh (Singapore), Runa Khan (Bangladesh) & Bo Kyi (Myanmar) – "2026 Ramon Magsaysay Award" laureates
  - Tommy Koh – for his work in diplomacy, international law & public service
  - Bo Kyi – for his work with Assistance Association for Political Prisoners (AAPP)
  - Runa Khan – for her humanitarian work among Bangladesh's poorest communities
- They will be honoured at a ceremony at Metropolitan Theatre, Manila, on Nov 15, 2026
  - Each will receive a medallion, an inscribed certificate & an undisclosed cash prize

News - 324

- MoYA&S – announced 4 awardees for "Tenzing Norgay National Adventure Awards (TNNAA) 2024"
  - To be conferred by President Droupadi Murmu at Rashtrapati Bhavan alongside National Sports Awards 2025
- Winners: Baljeet Kaur & Skalzang Rigzin (Mountaineers) – in Land Adventure category
  - Rimo Saha – in Water Adventure category | Shiv Prasad Chamoli – in Lifetime Achievement category
- Each Tenzing Norgay National Adventure Award carries a bronze statuette, a certificate, a blazer with a silken tie or saree & prize money of ₹15 lakh
  - It carries a status equivalent to Arjuna Awards
- Tenzing Norgay (along with Sir Edmund Hillary) – 1st confirmed climbers to reach summit of Mount Everest in 1953
- Minister of Youth Affairs & Sports: Mansukh L. Mandaviya | Constituency – Porbandar, Gujarat

  MoS in Ministry of Youth Affairs & Sports: Raksha Nikhil Khadse

News - 325

- 'Green Highways Excellence Awards 2026' – winners announced by NHAI for roadside plantation & greening work
- 1st prize in 'Median Plantation' – Warangal PIU (Hyderabad Regional Office)
- 1st prize in 'Avenue Plantation' – Amaravati PIU (Vijayawada Regional Office)
- 1st prize in 'Plantation in Land Parcels' – Nagpur PIU
- 'Green Highways Excellence Awards' – instituted in 2025 by NHAI, under Green Highways Policy, 2015
- HQs of NHAI – New Delhi | Chairman – Santosh Kumar Yadav | Founded in – 1988

News - 326

- '2026 Ig Nobel Prizes' – presented at 36th First Annual Ig Nobel Prize ceremony at Kongresshaus, Zurich, Switzerland
  - It was 1st ceremony outside US in its 35-year history | Total prizes – 10
- Chemistry – awarded to an international team including Sanchari Banerjee, Nitish Sathyanarayanan, Jandhyam Srikanth & Subramanian Ramaswamy (India)
  - For – finding that viviparous cockroach milk proteins contain ~3 times the energy of cow's milk proteins
- 'Ig Nobel Prizes' – founded in 1991 by Marc Abrahams

News - 327

- 73rd 'Miss World 2026' – held at April 2nd Square, Nha Trang, Khánh Hòa, Vietnam | Pageant's 75th anniversary
- Joheirry Mola Dominguez (Dominican Republic) – crowned 'Miss World 2026'
  - Succeeding – Opal Suchata Chuangsri (Thailand)
- She became 2nd Dominican woman to win Miss World | 1st – Mariasela Álvarez (1982)
- 1st runner-up – Elisabeth Reynés (Spain) | 2nd runner-up – Taanusiya Chetty (Malaysia)

News - 328

- Droupadi Murmu – conferred 'National Teachers' Awards 2026' on 82 educators at Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi
  - Awardees – 48 school teachers, 21 higher education teachers & 13 teachers from MSDE
- Divyendu Sen – recognised for asteroid-candidate tracking training & low-cost science-learning tools
- Anil Kaushik – honoured for physical mathematics laboratory with 40+ original models & a 12-section virtual lab
- Each National Teachers' Award carries – a certificate of merit, a silver medal & a cash prize
- 'National Teachers' Awards' – instituted in 1958; administered by Department of School Education & Literacy (MoE)

News - 329

- MoEFCC – organised 'Swachh Vayu Diwas 2026' & conferred 5th 'Swachh Vayu Sarvekshan Awards' in New Delhi
- 5th "Swachh Vayu Sarvekshan Awards" – also conferred under NCAP
- Cities with population above 10 lakh: 1st – Lucknow (198/200 points) | 2nd – Indore | 3rd – Jabalpur
- Cities with population between 3-10 lakh: 1st – Rourkela, Odisha (198.5) | 2nd – Firozabad (UP) & Guntur (AP)
  - 3rd – Amravati (Maharashtra) | 4th – Bhubaneswar (Odisha)
- Cities with population below 3 lakh: 1st – Kalinga Nagar | 2nd – Angul | 3rd – Talcher (all in Odisha)
- 108 of 130 cities – improved PM10 levels compared with 2017-18 baseline
- 'Compendium of Best Management Practices under the NCAP' – also released
- Minister of Environment, Forest & Climate Change: Bhupender Yadav | Constituency – Alwar, Rajasthan

  MoS in Ministry of Environment, Forest & Climate Change: Kirtivardhan Singh

News - 330

- Amit Shah – presented 'President's Colour' to Goa Police at Dr. Shyama Prasad Mukherjee Stadium, Bambolim, Panaji
  - President's Colour – highest honour conferred on a military or police unit for service & discipline
- Goa Police – currently ranks 2nd in implementing 3 new criminal codes, with 93.38% progress
- It introduced an AI-based call agent for cybercrime helpline 1930
  - Initially communicates in Konkani, Marathi & Hindi
- 112 emergency response time – improved to 8 minutes (from 18 minutes)

- Minister of Home Affairs & Cooperation: Amit Shah | Constituency – Gandhinagar, Gujarat

  MoS in Ministry of Home Affairs: Nityanand Rai & Bandi Sanjay Kumar

  MoS in Ministry of Cooperation: Krishan Pal & Murlidhar Mohol

News - 331

- 72nd 'National Film Awards' – to be presented by Droupadi Murmu at Statue of Unity, Ekta Nagar, Gujarat (on Sep 22)
  - 92 awardees | Awards honour films certified by CBFC in 2024
- Feature Films Section (some important awardees):
  - Best Feature Film – 'Article 370' (directed by Aditya Suhas Jambhale)
  - Best Actor in a Leading Role – Kartik Aaryan (for 'Chandu Champion') & Mammootty (for 'Bramayugam')
  - Best Actress in a Leading Role – Yami Gautam (for 'Article 370')
  - Best Director – Rajkumar Periasamy (for 'Amaran')
  - Best Film Promoting National, Social, and Environmental Values – 'Captain Miller'
  - Best Debut Film of a Director – Randeep Hooda (for 'Swatantrya Veer Savarkar')
  - Best Children's Film – '35 Chinna Katha Kaadu'
  - Best Cinematography – Shehnad Jalal (for 'Bramayugam')
  - Best Music Direction – Shashwat Sachdev (for 'Article 370')
  - Best Background Music – GV Prakash (for 'Amaran')
  - Best Lyrics – Manoj Muntashir (for 'Maidaan')
  - Best Male Playback Singer – Abhay Jodhpurkar (for "Gharat Ganpati" from 'Navasachi Gauri Mazi')
  - Best Female Playback Singer – Vaikom Vijayalakshmi (for "Angu Vaana Konilu" from 'ARM')
  - Best Choreography – Vijay Ganguly (for 'Stree 2')
  - Special Mention – Dhanush (for 'Captain Miller') & Suren G (for 'Meiyazhagan')
- Non-Feature Films Section (some important awardees):
  - Best Non-Feature Film – 'Bhangaar' (directed by Sumira Roy)
  - Best Debut Film of a Director – 'Angen'
  - Best Animation Film – 'Touched as Water'
  - Best Non-Feature Film Promoting Social and Environmental Values – 'Piplantri: A Tale of Eco Feminism'
  - Best Documentary – 'Ram-Nami'
  - Best Short Film (Up to 30 Minutes) – 'Hamsafar'
  - Best Direction – Aanand L Rai (for 'Statue of Unity – Ekta ka Prateek')
  - Best Cinematography – Edmond Ranson (for 'Life in Loom')
  - Best Film Critic – Sanjeev Shrivastava
  - Special Mention – 'Bhadra-Kali Natakam' & 'Chola Dora aur Sui'

News - 332

- Dr. Karim Maredia (Indian-American agricultural scientist) – won '2026 Borlaug CAST Communication Award'
  - Awarded by – Council for Agricultural Science and Technology (CAST)
- To be conferred at – Library of Congress, Washington, D.C. (Dec 10, 2026)
- He is a Professor, Associate Dean & Director of World Agriculture Center at Michigan State University

News - 333

- P. P. Chaudhary (BJP MoP from Pali, Rajasthan) – honoured with the "Sansad Ratna Award" for the 4th time
  - at the 16th edition of the Sansad Ratna Awards ceremony, held in New Delhi
  - 2026 edition marked the presentation of the 150th Sansad Ratna Award overall since the initiative's inception
- Chaudhary's earlier wins – 2015, 2016, & 2025
- The award is assessed on parameters including attendance, debates initiated, questions raised and private members' Bills introduced
- The 2026 edition honoured a total of 12 Members of Parliament, comprising 10 from the Lok Sabha and 2 from the Rajya Sabha, along with 4 Parliamentary Standing Committees
- Sansad Ratna Awards – instituted in 2010 by the Prime Point Foundation (after a suggestion by Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam)
  - award's 1st-ever recipient – Hansraj Gangaram Ahir
  - Presented by civil society (not conferred by the Government of India)

News - 334

- Kishor Makwana (Chairman, NCSC) – conferred 'Dr. APJ Abdul Kalam Jan Seva Puraskar 2026' in New Delhi
  - Conferred during – 16th edition of 'Sansad Ratna Awards 2026'
- It was nominated by – Prime Point Foundation, along with Jury Committee of Sansad Ratna Awards
- NCSC – a constitutional body established under Article 338 of Constitution of India

News - 335

- Miss India Organisation – launched 'Femina Miss India Telangana 2027' in Hyderabad, Telangana
- Megha Services Private Limited – appointed as exclusive state licensee for a 3-year term commencing in 2026
  - In association with – Media Connect
- State-level auditions – scheduled across Oct & Nov 2026 | Grand finale – likely in Dec 2026, in Hyderabad
- Femina Miss India – India's oldest & most prominent national beauty pageant (1st edition held in 1964)

News - 336

- Eknath Shinde (Deputy CM of Maharashtra) – honoured with 3 international awards during a 3-day visit to London
  - 'Commonwealth Public Leadership Recognition' – received at House of Lords, British Parliament
  - 'Statesmanship Award for Transformative Leadership' – conferred at 9th 'International Conclave 2026: Maharashtra, India-UK Dialogue' at House of Commons
  - 'Global Pride of Maharashtra' – conferred by Maharashtra Mandal at a cultural event in London
- 9th 'International Conclave 2026: Maharashtra, India-UK Dialogue' – organised jointly by Indo-European Business Forum & World Leadership Forum

News - 337

- Justice Dipak Misra (former CJI) – conferred 'Kalinga Ratna Award 2026' by Sarala Sahitya Sansad, in Cuttack, Odisha
  - Award comprises – a silver idol of Goddess Saraswati, a citation & an uttariya
  - Presented at – 46th annual celebration of 'Sarala Sahitya Sansad' held at Sarala Bhavan, Cuttack, Odisha
- Prof. Ramachandra Behera (fiction writer) – honoured with 'Sarala Samman' at the same event
  - carrying a cash prize of ₹1.25 lakh, a citation & an uttariya
- 'Kalinga Ratna Award' – instituted in 2007 | Presented annually to an individual from Odisha
- Justice Dipak Misra – served as 45th CJI (Aug 28, 2017 to Oct 2, 2018)

News - 338

- Dr. Sethuraman Panchanathan – recipient of '2026 Arthur M. Bueche Award' by National Academy of Engineering
  - Currently, he serves as – University Professor of Technology & Innovation at Arizona State University (ASU)
  - He became 1st Indian-American & 1st Arizonan to receive this award
- Award to be presented on – Oct 4, at NAE's Annual Meeting in Washington, D.C.
- He was awarded with – Padma Shri (in 2025) | 'Arthur M. Bueche Award' – instituted in 1983

News - 339

- 'Angh' (directed by Naga filmmaker Theja Rio) – won 'Platform Prize 2026' at Toronto International Film Festival
  - Only Indian entry among 12 films in Platform programme, TIFF's sole competitive section
- Platform Prize – gives a non-English film direct eligibility for Oscar's Best International Feature Film
- Prize – CAD 20,000 & a trophy | Jury President – Pablo Trapero
- Stars – Douglas Henshall (BAFTA-winning Scottish actor) with non-professional Naga actors

News - 340

- Anant Nag – conferred "Dadasaheb Phalke Award" for 2024, India's highest honour in cinema
  - On recommendation of Dadasaheb Phalke Award Selection Committee
- It will be formally presented at 72nd National Film Awards ceremony in Kevadia, Gujarat (Sep 22, 2026)
- Nag's other honours include: A record 6 Filmfare Awards for Best Actor – Kannada (after Dr. Rajkumar's 8)
  - 4 Karnataka State Film Awards for Best Actor | Dr. Vishnuvardhan Award for Lifetime Achievement
- Karnataka Rajyotsava Award in 2007 | Padma Bhushan in 2025

News - 341

- "Gondhal" (Marathi) – selected as India's official entry for Best International Feature Film category
  - At 99th Academy Awards (Oscars 2027) – announced by Film Federation of India (FFI) in Mumbai
  - Written & directed by – Santosh Davakhar
- It was chosen by a 14-member selection committee chaired by P. Sheshadri (Kannada filmmaker)
- It is 4th Marathi-language film to be chosen as India's official Oscar entry
  - First 3 – "Shwaas" (2005), "Harishchandrachi Factory" (2009) & "Court" (2015)
- 99th Academy Awards – to be held at Dolby Theatre in Hollywood, Los Angeles

News - 342

- 'Booker Prize 2026' – shortlist of 6 novels announced by Booker Prize Foundation
  - Judging panel chaired by – Mary Beard (classicist)
- Shortlisted novels: 'The End of Everything' – by M. John Harrison | 'The Disappearers' – by Marlon James
  - 'Black Bag' – by Luke Kennard | 'May We Feed the King' – by Rebecca Perry
  - 'The Things We Never Say' – by Elizabeth Strout | 'John of John' – by Douglas Stuart
- Authors represent 4 countries – England, Scotland, Jamaica & USA
- 2 previous winners on list: Marlon James (2015) – 'A Brief History of Seven Killings'
  - Douglas Stuart (2020) – 'Shuggie Bain'
- Winner – to be announced on Nov 9, 2026, at Old Billingsgate, London | Prize – £50,000

News - 343

- Karan Johar – confirmed as host of 6th 'The Earthshot Prize' Awards Night, to be held in Mumbai on Nov 17, 2026
  - He is 1st Indian to host this ceremony; it is also the 1st time the prize is held in India
- 'The Earthshot Prize' – founded by Prince William in 2020 | Mumbai – 2026 host city at Mumbai Climate Week

- 15 Finalists competing across 5 categories: Protect & Restore Nature | Clean Our Air
  - Revive Our Oceans | Build a Waste-Free World | Fix Our Climate
- 5 winners – each to receive £1 million
- India's 2 Finalists – Mahindra Last Mile Mobility (Clean Our Air) & Mahila Housing Trust (Fix Our Climate)

News - 344

- Z T Lalrithangi ('Pi Mari-i') – selected among "FAO 100 Women Heroes in Agrifood Systems & Rural Development"
- She is a teacher-turned-farmer from Sangau village, Lawngtlai district, Mizoram
  - Honour instituted by the FAO as part of the 'International Year of the Woman Farmer 2026'
  - Chosen from 600+ nominations across 131 countries – 1 of only 2 women selected from India & 1st from Mizoram
- She will be conferred the award at the World Food Forum, FAO headquarters, Rome, Italy (Oct 12-16, 2026)
- She has diversified into value-added products (strawberry wine, dehydrated strawberries & candy)
- HQs of FAO – Rome, Italy | DG – Dr. Qu Dongyu | Founded in – 1945

News - 345

- Lalit Kala Akademi (National Academy of Art) – announced 20 'Lalit Kala Akademi Awards'
  - At – 65th 'National Exhibition of Art (NEA)'
- First-Tier Jury – selected 270 artworks for exhibition | Second-Tier Jury – selected 20 artworks for awards
- 20 Winners:

SCHEMES & INITIATIVES

News - 346

- UP Cabinet approved "Lokmata Ahilyabai Matrushakti Yojana"
  - It provides lifetime free travel across all buses operated by UPSRTC to women aged 60 years & above residing in UP
- Cabinet also approved a ₹425.50 Cr proposal to procure 250 new electric buses
  - UPSRTC will contribute ₹25.50 Cr from its own resources
- UP: Capital – Lucknow | CM – Yogi Adityanath | Governor – Anandiben Patel

News - 347

- Conrad K. Sangma (Meghalaya CM) – launched "CM-IMPACT Read & Rise Meghalaya" programme
  - At Assembly Annexe Hall in Shillong | It is also known as 'Meghalaya Universal Reading Readiness Programme'
  - To strengthen foundational reading skills & improve overall academic performance of schoolchildren
- It is a key component of government's broader CM-IMPACT education reform initiative
  - CM-IMPACT – Chief Minister's Initiative for Maximising Pass Achievement and Classroom Triumph
- Immediate objective: To ensure that every child above 7 years of age in Meghalaya is able to read within 3 months
- At event, dignitaries also officially released "Teacher Training Guide for Universal Reading Readiness Across Meghalaya"
  - Published by – GREENAMMO | Sponsored by – Department of Education
- Meghalaya: Capital – Shillong | CM – Conrad Kongkal Sangma | Governor – CH Vijayashankar

News - 348

- Punjab – became 1st state in India to launch a statewide digital portal, "Pehchaan"
  - To help identify unidentified & unclaimed deceased persons in government mortuaries
  - Launched by – Dr. Balbir Singh (Punjab Health & Family Welfare Minister)
- Facial photographs, permanent identification marks, physical deformities & other identifying details of unidentified bodies will be uploaded to portal within 48 hours of a postmortem examination at government mortuaries
- Pehchaan portal is built on state's existing digital medico-legal software, "MedLEaPR"
  - An NIC-developed system created following directions from Punjab & Haryana High Court
- It complies with 'Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023'
- Punjab: Capital – Chandigarh | CM – Bhagwant Mann | Governor – Gulab Chand Kataria

News - 349

- Pushkar Singh Dhami – launched 'Mukhyamantri Yuva Bhavishya Nirman Yojana'
  - It is a scheme for free online competitive-exam coaching & study material
  - Beneficiaries – students enrolled in universities, government & aided colleges across Uttarakhand
- He also transferred ₹147.05 Cr to 9,91,914 beneficiaries under social security pension schemes for Aug 2026
- Uttarakhand: Capital – Dehradun & Gairsain | CM – Pushkar Singh Dhami | Governor – Lt. Gen. Gurmit Singh

News - 350

- PM-SETU's National Steering Committee – approved ₹735.70 Cr Strategic Investment Plans for 3 ITI clusters
  - Total sanctioned investment – ₹2,171 Cr across 9 clusters
- Bhiwadi (Rajasthan) – ₹241 Cr | Medchal (Telangana) – ₹254.30 Cr | Meerut (UP) – ₹240.40 Cr
- PM-SETU – Pradhan Mantri Skilling and Employability Transformation through Upgraded ITIs
  - It is a Centrally Sponsored Scheme to upgrade 1,000 Government ITIs under hub-and-spoke model
  - Total outlay – ₹60,000 Cr (Centre – ₹30,000 Cr | States – ₹20,000 Cr | Industry – ₹10,000 Cr)
  - 50% of Central share – co-financed equally by ADB & World Bank

News - 351

- 'Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana (PMMSY)' – completed 6 years of implementation | Launched in – 2020-21
  - Implemented by – Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry & Dairying | Total outlay – ₹20,750 Cr
- PMMSY – an umbrella scheme with a Central Sector component & a Centrally Sponsored Scheme component
- Budget Estimates 2026-27 – a record allocation of ₹2,500 Cr under PMMSY
- Fish production – rose to 197.75 lakh tonnes in 2024-25 (from 141.64 lakh tonnes in 2019-20)
- Fisheries exports – rose to ₹73,890 Cr in 2025-26 (from ₹46,663 Cr in 2019-20)
- Employment generated – ~58 lakh persons | Infrastructure supported – ₹3,741.89 Cr
- Fish Farmer Producer Organisations (FFPOs) supported – 2,195, through projects worth ₹544.86 Cr
- Projects approved by Department of Fisheries – ₹21,394.88 Cr (Central share – ₹9,510.89 Cr), as of Aug 11, 2026
- Sub-scheme 'Pradhan Mantri Matsya Kisan Samridhi Sah-Yojana (PM-MKSSY)' – running from 2023-24 to 2026-27
  - It includes 'National Fisheries Digital Platform (NFDP)', launched in Sep 2024 | Outlay – ₹6,000 Cr
- Minister of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry & Dairying: Rajiv Ranjan Singh (Lalan Singh) | Constituency – Munger, Bihar
- MoS in Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry & Dairying: S. P. Singh Baghel & George Kurian

News - 352

- 'Pradhan Mantri Kisan Maandhan Yojana (PM-KMY)' – marked 7 years of implementation
  - Launched on – Sep 12, 2019, from Ranchi, Jharkhand
- PM-KMY – a voluntary, contributory old-age pension scheme for Small & Marginal Farmers (SMFs)
  - It is a Central Sector Scheme administered by Department of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare (MoA&FW)
- Eligibility – landholding SMFs (both male & female) owning up to 2 hectares of cultivable land
- Assured monthly pension – ₹3,000 on attaining the age of 60
  - Farmers aged 18-40 years – contribute ₹55 to ₹200 per month, depending on age at entry
- Pension fund managed by – Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC)
- On a beneficiary's death – spouse entitled to 50% of pension as family pension
- Farmers can also use their PM-KISAN benefits for voluntary contributions towards PM-KMY
- Highest enrolment – Haryana (~5.75 lakh) | Followed by – Bihar (3.46 lakh+)
  - Jharkhand & Uttar Pradesh – over 2.5 lakh each | Chhattisgarh – more than 2 lakh
- Total utilisation (since 2019) – ₹540.66 Cr (as of Feb 2026)

News - 353

- 'PM Vishwakarma Scheme' – completed 3 years on Sep 17, 2026, reaching registration target of 30 lakh
- Launched by – PM Modi on Sep 17, 2023 | Type – Central Sector Scheme (fully funded by Union Govt)
  - Outlay – ₹13,000 Cr (2023-24 to 2027-28) | Covers – 18 identified traditional trades
- Basic skill training completed – 24.37+ lakh beneficiaries | Stipend – ₹500/day (5-7 days)
- Modern toolkits delivered through India Post – 18.15+ lakh | Toolkit incentive – up to ₹15,000
- Collateral-free loans sanctioned – 6.19+ lakh (~₹5,316 Cr) at concessional interest rate of 5% p.a.
  - 2 tranches – up to ₹1 lakh (18 months) & up to ₹2 lakh (30 months) | Govt interest subvention – up to 8%
- Digital transaction incentive – ₹1 per eligible transaction (up to 100 transactions/month)

News - 354

- MoPNG – issued operational guidelines for ₹23,731 Cr "GOBARdhan" National Circular Bioenergy Scheme
  - GOBARdhan – **G**alvanizing **O**rganic **B**io-**A**gro **R**esources **Dhan**
- Compressed Biogas (CBG) producers – assured offtake of up to 100% of CBG available for sale
  - Subject to technical & operational feasibility
- Initial Administered CBG Price (ACP) – ₹2,110 per MMBtu (~₹98/kg of CBG) | Fixed till – Mar 31, 2036
- CBG affordability support to Synchro Operator – capped at ₹10/kg for 10 years
- Financial assistance: new CBG plants – ₹1.25 Cr per TPD (capped at ₹30 Cr/project)
  - Existing biogas plants upgraded to CBG – ₹0.60 Cr per TPD (capped at ₹5 Cr/project)
- Scheme approved by – Union Cabinet in Aug 2026 | Implementation – FY 2026-27 to FY 2035-36
- CBG obligation for City Gas Distribution (CGD) entities – 3% (FY27) | 4% (FY28) | 5% (FY29 onwards)
- Minister of Petroleum & Natural Gas: Hardeep Singh Puri | Constituency – Uttar Pradesh
- MoS in Ministry of Petroleum & Natural Gas: Suresh Gopi

News - 355

- Mohan Yadav (MP CM) – launched 'Swamitva Adhikar Abhilekh Nispadan Evam Panjiyan Yojana-2026'
  - At – Gandhi Nagar Ground, Indore | Launched under – 'Seva Sankalp Abhiyan'
- MP – became 1st state to offer free registration of rural properties
- ~50 lakh private rural properties across all 55 districts – to be registered free, with no stamp duty or registration fee
- Campaign duration – Sep 17-Oct 17, 2026 | Patwaris – appointed as Execution Officers
- Under 'Swamitva Yojana' – rights records prepared for 68.47 lakh properties across 41,568 villages in MP
- Madhya Pradesh: Capital – Bhopal | CM – Mohan Yadav | Governor – Mangubhai Chhaganbhai Patel

News - 356

- C. Joseph Vijay – to launch 'Thaimaaman Thanga Mothiram Thittam' (Maternal Uncle's Gold Ring Scheme)
- Every newborn delivered in govt hospitals – to receive a 1-gram, 22-carat gold ring
  - Applicable retrospectively – for babies born from Jun 22, 2026
- Eligibility – mother must be a TN permanent resident & registered on 'Pregnancy and Infant Cohort Monitoring and Evaluation (PICME)' system
- Annual allocation – ₹755.83 Cr for 4,41,667 rings (~₹17,100 per ring)
- 1st batch – 1.28 lakh rings procured through TNMSC from Joyalukkas & Kalyan Jewellers (~₹220 Cr)
- Tamil Nadu: Capital – Chennai | CM – C Joseph Vijay | Governor – Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar

News - 357

- 'Pradhan Mantri Khanij Kshetra Kalyan Yojana (PMKKKY)' – completed 11 years on Sep 17, 2026 (launched in2015)
- Projects sanctioned so far – 4,70,020 (worth ₹1,09,938 Cr)
  - Completed – 2,92,156 projects (worth ₹49,973 Cr) | Under execution – 78,809 projects
- Implemented by – District Mineral Foundations (DMFs), using funds under the 'Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Act, 1957'
- DMFs – set up in 656 districts across 23 States (revised PMKKKY guidelines issued in Jan 2024)
- Mining lease holders contribute – 10% of royalty (leases on/after Jan 12, 2015) | 30% (leases before that date)
- Fund use – at least 70% to high-priority sectors | up to 30% to physical infrastructure & other measures

News - 358

- C R Patil (Union Jal Shakti Minister) – launched 'Swachh Seva Aankalan (SSA)', during a virtual meeting with States/UTs
- SSA – an annual, Gram Panchayat-level digital self-assessment framework for sanitation service delivery in rural areas
  - Developed by – Department of Drinking Water and Sanitation (DDWS), Ministry of Jal Shakti
  - under 'Swachh Bharat Mission (Grameen) 2.0'
- It follows the spirit of the '73rd Constitutional Amendment Act', empowering Gram Panchayats & Gram Sabhas
- Minister of Jal Shakti: C R Patil | Constituency – Navsari, Gujarat
- MoS in Ministry of Jal Shakti – V. Somanna & Raj Bhushan Choudhary

News - 359

- 'Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB PM-JAY)' – completed 8 years on Sep 23, 2026
  - Launched by – PM Modi on Sep 23, 2018, at Ranchi, Jharkhand
  - As 2nd component of 'Ayushman Bharat' (recommended by National Health Policy 2017)
- It is world's largest govt-funded health assurance scheme – administered by MoH&FW
- The cost is shared by Centre & States/UTs:
  - For all ordinary States & UTs with a legislature – 60:40 (Central Govt : State/UT)
  - For the North-Eastern States & the 3 Himalayan States (HP, Uttarakhand, and J&K) – 90:10
  - For UTs without a legislature – 100% (by Central Govt)
- Benefit – cashless secondary & tertiary hospitalisation cover of up to ₹5 lakh per family per year
- Union Cabinet approved expansion to all senior citizens aged 70 & above on Sep 11, 2024
  - 'Ayushman Vay Vandana' card rolled out on Oct 29, 2024

News - 360

- Delhi Cabinet – approved 'DURGA (Driving Upliftment and Rozgar for women or transGender green e-Auto)' scheme
  - Aim: To provide safe, clean & dignified employment to women & transgender persons in the capital
- Phase 1 – 1,300 pink electric autos to be allocated: 1,170 for women & 130 for transgender beneficiaries
- Per revenue district – a maximum of 90 e-autos for women & up to 10 for transgender beneficiaries
- Part of Delhi's 'Electric Vehicle Policy 2026' – a ₹15,000 Cr initiative, aiming to make capital pollution-free by 2030
- Delhi: CM – Rekha Gupta | Lt. Governor –Taranjit Singh Sandhu | Chief Secretary – Rajeev Verma

News - 361

- GoI (Ministry of C&I) – approved a one-time, interest-free loan of ₹50,000 per barn for FCV (Flue-Cured Virginia) tobacco growers in Andhra Pradesh, under the 'Interest-Free Working Capital Assistance Scheme'
- It covers ~44,000 growers, with a financial intervention of ~₹220 Cr, provided directly via DBT
- Aim: give growers immediate liquidity to repay institutional loans, buy inputs & reduce dependence on private loan
- FCV tobacco – predominantly cultivated in Andhra Pradesh & Karnataka

News - 362

- PM-SETU's NSC – approved a ₹320 Cr Strategic Investment Plan for the Kurukshetra ITI cluster in Haryana
  - This takes the scheme's total sanctioned investment to ₹2,491 Cr across 10 ITI clusters nationwide
- Cluster developed under PM-SETU's hub-and-spoke model – Government ITI, Kurukshetra as Hub ITI + 6 Spoke ITIs
- Anchor Industry Partner – Jindal Naveen Avsar Ltd
- PM-SETU – Pradhan Mantri Skilling and Employability Transformation through Upgraded ITIs'
- It is Centrally Sponsored Scheme | Outlay - ₹60,000 Cr (Centre ₹30,000 Cr + State ₹20,000 Cr + Industry ₹10,000 Cr)
  - 50% of the Central share is co-financed equally by = ADB + World Bank
- Launched by PM Modi on Oct 4, 2025, to upgrade 1,000 Government ITIs into industry-managed centres of excellence

News - 363

- UP CM Yogi Adityanath – launched 'Bharat Taxi' & 'Mukhyamantri Krishak Samriddhi Yojana' in Lucknow
- Bharat Taxi – country's 1st cooperative-led ride-hailing platform, operated by Sahakar Taxi Cooperative Ltd
  - Launched across 5 cities – Lucknow, Gorakhpur, Varanasi, Kanpur & Prayagraj
- Drivers join on zero commission, with ₹5 lakh social security cover
- Under 'Mukhyamantri Krishak Samriddhi Yojana' – interest rate on long-term loans cut from 11% to 6%
  - Aims to benefit 5 lakh small & marginal farmers
- CM also launched – the scheme's e-portal, the Cooperation Department's 'Urvarak Setu' app & the 'UPCDC' app
- UP: Capital – Lucknow | CM – Yogi Adityanath | Governor – Anandiben Patel

News - 364

- Shivraj Singh Chouhan – laid foundation stone of 36 roads under 'PMGSY-IV' at Ichhawar, Sehore district (MP)
  - PMGSY – Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana
- PMGSY-IV – approved by Union Cabinet on Sep 11, 2024 | Implemented during – FY 2024-25 to 2028-29
  - Total outlay – ₹70,125 Cr (Central share – ₹49,087.50 Cr | State share – ₹21,037.50 Cr)
- Scheme provides – construction of 62,500 km all-weather roads for 25,000 eligible unconnected habitations
- Madhya Pradesh: Capital – Bhopal | CM – Mohan Yadav | Governor – Mangubhai Chhaganbhai Patel

MEETINGS, CONFERENCES & SUMMITS

News - 365

- Indian Pharmacopoeia Commission (IPC) – organised its 1st-ever interactive meeting at CDL & CCL, Kolkata
  - Theme – "IP 2026: Perspectives, Suggestions & Way Forward"
- IPC – launched 7 Indian Pharmacopoeia Nitrosamine Impurities Reference Standards for the 1st time
  - 7 standards – NDMA, NDEA, NEIPA, NDBA, NMPA, NDIPA & NMBA
- Nitrosamines – potent genotoxic & carcinogenic impurities that may arise during pharmaceutical manufacturing, storage, packaging or material contamination
- HQs of IPC – Ghaziabad, UP | Secretary-cum-Scientific Director – Dr. V. Kalaiselvan | Chairperson – Secretary, Ministry of Health & Family Welfare | Established in – 2009

News - 366

- SCO – named Lahore (Pakistan) as 'Tourism & Cultural Capital for 2026-27'
  - Announced at – 26th SCO Council of Heads of State meeting in Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan
- Pakistan – assumed SCO's rotating chairmanship for 2026-27
  - Theme – "Turning Vision into Action: Connectivity, Innovation and Shared Prosperity"
- Previous titleholders include: Varanasi, India (2022-23) | Almaty, Kazakhstan (2023-24)
  - Qingdao, China (2024-25) | Cholpon-Ata, Kyrgyzstan (2025-26)
- HQs of SCO Secretariat – Beijing, China | Secretary-General – Nurlan Yermekbayev | Established in – 2001

News - 367

- Ministry of Steel – set up India Steel Pavilion at 'INNOPROM India 2026', Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi
  - Theme – "Forging Together - For Infinite Progress"
- 'INNOPROM India 2026' – 1st edition of Russian industrial exhibition held in India

- Minister of Steel & Heavy Industries: H. D. Kumaraswamy | Constituency – Mandaya, Karnataka
  MoS in Ministry of Steel: Bhupathi Raju Srinivasa Varma

News - 368

- 18th BRICS Summit – held at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi
  - Theme – "Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability"
- India assumed BRICS Chairship on Jan 1, 2026, marking its 4th Chairship of grouping (after 2012, 2016 & 2021)
- 1st BRIC Summit – held in Yekaterinburg, Russia (Jun 16, 2009)
- Summit was preceded by a BRICS Business Forum at same venue on Sep 11 | Chaired by – PM Modi
- BRICS Members (11): Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa, Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, UAE, Saudi Arabia & Indonesia
  BRICS Chairmanship 2026 – India

News - 369

- India + Vietnam = agreed to observe 2027 as 'Year of India-Vietnam Friendship'
- Agreed at – 19th India-Vietnam Joint Commission Meeting (JCM) on Trade, Economic, Scientific & Technological Cooperation, in New Delhi
  - Co-chaired by – S. Jaishankar (India's External Affairs Minister) & Le Hoai Trung (Vietnam's Foreign Minister)
- Vietnam – Hanoi – Vietnamese dong | PM – Le Minh Hung | President – To Lam

News - 370

- India – joined other G20 members in adopting 4 consensus outcomes at the 'G20 Energy Abundance Ministerial' in Houston, Texas
  - India's delegation led by – Manohar Lal (Union Minister for Power & Housing and Urban Affairs)
- 4 consensus outcomes – 'Household Energy Access' | 'Permitting and Regulatory Efficiency' | 'Water Reuse Initiative' | 'Critical Minerals Statement'
- 3 pillars of the 'Energy Abundance Working Group' – Energy Security & Affordable Baseload | Permitting & Regulatory Efficiency | Critical Minerals & Resilient Supply Chains

News - 371

- India – participated in 14th 'East Asia Summit Economic Ministers' Meeting (EAS-EMM)' & 23rd 'ASEAN-India Economic Ministers Consultation' in Manila, Philippines
  - Indian delegation led by – Nitin Kumar Yadav (Additional Secretary (Dept of Commerce))
- India-ASEAN bilateral trade – $128.38 billion in 2025-26 | ASEAN accounts for 10.55% of India's total global trade

- HQs of ASEAN – Jakarta, Indonesia | SG – Dr. Kao Kim Hourn | 2026 Chairmanship – Philippines | Founded in – 1967
  - Members (11) – Brunei Darussalam, Cambodia, Indonesia, Laos, Malaysia, Myanmar, the Philippines, Singapore, Thailand, Vietnam & Timor-Leste

RANKS, REPORTS & SURVEYS

News - 372

- As assessed by S&P Global following its latest Media & Stakeholder Analysis (MSA) review:
- AESL – achieved highest ESG (Environmental, Social & Governance) score globally among companies in 'Utilities sector'
- AESL's ESG Score – rose to 90 out of 100 (from 81) | Industry average – 41
- HQs of AESL – Ahmedabad, Gujarat | Chairman – Gautam Adani | Established in – 2013

News - 373

- 4th edition of "2026 Work From Anywhere Index" – released by International Workplace Group (IWG)
- Mumbai – only Indian city featured in ranking with a total score of 77
- Top city – Bangkok (Thailand) with 106.5 | 2nd – Tokyo (Japan) with 96.5 | 3rd – Barcelona (Spain) with 95.5
  - 4th – Porto (Portugal) | 5th – Vancouver (Canada) | 6th – Budapest (Hungary) | 7th – Naples (Italy)
  - 8th – Medellin (Colombia) | 9th – Lisbon (Portugal) | 10th – Seoul (South Korea)

News - 374

- "All India Survey on Higher Education (AISHE)" Reports for 2022-23 and 2023-24 – released by Ministry of Education
- Total student enrolment – rose to 4.46 crore in 2022-23 & 4.50 crore in 2023-24 (from 3.42 crore in 2014-15)
- Gross Enrolment Ratio (GER) – climbed to 29.5 & then 30.0 over same period (from 23.7)
  - GER for: Women – 31.2% | Men – 28.9%
  - GER for: SC students – rose to 27.8% (from 18.9%) | ST students – rose to 22.8% (from 13.5%)
- Gender Parity Index (GPI) – reached 1.08 in 2023-24 (remaining above 1.0 for a 7th consecutive year)
- PhD enrolment recorded sharpest rise among all levels, growing to 3.43 lakh students, up 192.9% (from 1.17 lakh)
- STEM enrolment – rose to 1.02 crore (from 91.5 lakh) | Share of women in STEM – rose to 44% (from 38.4%)
- Total faculty strength – reached 17.32 lakh in 2023-24 | Women comprise 44.9% of teaching workforce
- Minister of Education: Pralhad Joshi | Constituency – Dharwad-Hubballi, Karnataka
  MoS in Ministry of Education: Jayant Chaudhary & Sukanta Majumdar

News - 375

- '2026 TIME100 AI' list (4th annual edition) – released by TIME magazine
  - It is divided into 4 categories – Leaders, Innovators, Shapers & Thinkers
- Notable inclusions – Sam Altman, Greg Brockman, Mark Chen, Dario & Daniela Amodei, Larry Ellison, Jeff Bezos, Elon Musk & Liang Rubo
- 70+ honourees – from US | 9 – from China
- 8 Indian Americans included, among them: Arvind Krishna, Anima Anandkumar, Suchi Saria, Sanjay Mehrotra & Ravi Kumar S
- 'TIME100 Impact Dinner: Leaders Shaping the Future of AI' – to be held in San Francisco on Sep 14, 2026

News - 376

- 'Limiting Overshoot' report – released by United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP)
- Global temperature rise – likely to cross 1.5°C above pre-industrial levels within next few years
- Current human-induced warming – close to 1.4°C | Observed warming rate – ~0.25°C per decade
- Recommended pathway – 'overshoot, peak and decline' to bring temperatures back below 1.5°C
- Requires sustained greenhouse gas cuts towards net-zero & long-term net-negative emissions through Carbon Dioxide Removal (CDR)
- 80+% of tropical coral reefs – experienced bleaching during 2023-2025 across at least 83 countries & territories
- 40+% of global glacier loss since 1970s – occurred during 2015-2024

News - 377

- Karnataka – topped semiconductor design support through ChipIN Centre, as per MeitY
  - Supported 81 organisations; 73 chip tape-outs & 88 lakh hours of EDA tool usage
- 2nd – Tamil Nadu (79 organisations; 33 tape-outs) | 3rd – Telangana (42 organisations; 28 tape-outs)
  - 4th – Maharashtra (32 organisations; 24 tape-outs) | 5th – UP (24 organisations: 21 tape-outs)
  - 6th – MP (24 organisations; 18 tape-outs) | 7th – Kerala | 8th – West Bengal | 9th – Odisha | 10th – Punjab
- ChipIN Centre – established at C-DAC; supports Chips to Start-up Programme & Design Linked Incentive Scheme
- 'Semicon 2.0' – approved in Jul 2026 with ₹1,27,500 Cr outlay
- Karnataka: Capital – Bangalore | CM – D. K. Shivakumar | Governor – Thaawarchand Gehlot

News - 378

- NSO (MoSPI) – released India's 1st-ever district-level estimates of unincorporated non-agricultural sector
  - In a report titled – "Unincorporated Sector at the District Level: Insights from ASUSE 2025"
  - ASUSE – Annual Survey of Unincorporated Sector Enterprises

- Top 50 districts spread across 12 states including Gujarat, Telangana, UP, West Bengal, Maharashtra & Bihar
  - They account for nearly 1/3 of sector's total establishments, workforce & Gross Value Added (GVA)
- Top 10 districts (located in Gujarat, Telangana, UP & WB) – contributes 1/10th of national totals
- Roughly 1/3 of all districts have more than 1 lakh unincorporated establishments each
  - 16 districts have crossed 5 lakh establishments (including 8 in WB, 3 in Maharashtra & 2 in Gujarat)
- All-India average GVA per worker – ₹1,56,539 | 280 districts recorded productivity above this average
- Women constituted at least 1/3 of unincorporated-sector workforce in 237 districts & more than half workforce in 25 districts
- HQs of NSO – New Delhi | Chairperson – Dr. Saibal Chattopadhyay

News - 379

- 'Global Gender Gap Report 2026' (20th edition) – released by WEF
- 1st – Iceland (17th consecutive year; 93% gap closed) | 2nd – Finland | 3rd – Norway
  - Bottom 3 also include – Chad (lowest), Iran & Pakistan
- India – retained 131st rank among 145 countries | Parity score – 64.5% (global average – 69.2%)
- Full global gender parity – 120 years away at current pace
- India's subindex scores: Educational Attainment – 96.6% | Health & Survival – 95.6%
  - Economic Participation & Opportunity – 41.2% | Political Empowerment – 24.5% (highest-ranked; globally– 67th)
- Australia – entered global top 10 for 1st time | Biggest climbers – Kenya (65th, up 33) & Ghana (56th, up 32)
- HQs of WEF – Geneva, Switzerland | President & CEO – Alois Zwinggi | Established in – 1971

News - 380

- 'QS Global MBA Rankings 2027' – covered 400+ full-time MBA programmes across 65 countries
- 1st globally – MIT Sloan School of Management (US)
  - Followed by – Stanford Graduate School of Business (US), Wharton (US), Harvard Business School (US), & London Business School (UK)
- No. of Indian institutions ranked – 19 (from 5 in 2020 & 7 in 2022) | New Indian entrants – 5
- IIM Bangalore – joint 64th (from 52nd) | IIM Ahmedabad – joint 70th (from 58th) | IIM Calcutta – 95th (from 64th)
  - These 3 IIMs are India's only institutions in global top 100
  - Decline driven largely by – fall in Return on Investment (ROI) scores
- QS uses 5 weighted indicators to evaluate full-time MBA programmes:
- Employability (40%), Return on Investment (20%), Entrepreneurship & Alumni Outcomes (15%), Thought Leadership (15%) and Diversity (10%)

News - 381

- Rajiv Gauba (NITI Aayog Member) – released 2nd edition of 'India Electric Mobility Index (IEMI) 2025'
  - Developed by – NITI Aayog + WRI India
- Top-performing State/UT in electric mobility adoption: 1st – Delhi (84/100; 2nd consecutive year)
  - 2nd – Maharashtra (78) | 3rd – Karnataka (73) | 4th – Chandigarh (71) | 5th – Goa (65)
- Index assessed 36 States/UTs across 16 indicators under 3 themes: Transport Electrification Progress (50%)
  - Charging Infrastructure Readiness (30%) | EV Research & Innovation Status (20%)
- Theme leaders: Transport Electrification Progress – Delhi | Followed by – Chandigarh & Maharashtra
  - Charging Infrastructure Readiness – Karnataka (97)
  - EV Research & Innovation – Delhi | Followed by – Maharashtra & Karnataka
  - Hilly & Northeastern States category leader – Manipur (46)
  - Sharpest improvement – Madhya Pradesh (7th, from 23rd in 2024)
- National median score – 40 (from 36 in 2024) | 1st edition of IEMI – launched in Aug 2025
- HQs of NITI Aayog – New Delhi | CEO – Anurag Jain | Chair – Narendra Modi | VC – Ashok Lahiri

News - 382

- Ashok Kumar Lahiri (VC, NITI Aayog) – released 9th edition of 'Trade Watch Quarterly (TWQ)' for Q1 FY27
  - Thematic focus – India's metals & ores trade
- India's total merchandise & services trade – rose 15.5% to $506.9 billion in Q1 FY27
- Merchandise exports – $129.5 billion (+16%) | Imports – $216.1 billion (+19.8%)
  - Merchandise trade deficit – $86.6 billion
- India's share in global metals & ores exports – 1.8% in 2025 (from 1.7% in 2015)
- India's metals & ores imports – $60.5 billion in 2025 (from $32.2 billion in 2015)
- India's Digitally Delivered Services exports – rose 15% to $317 billion in 2025
  - India became 4th-largest exporter of such services globally
- TWQ series – launched by NITI Aayog in Dec 2024
- HQs of NITI Aayog – New Delhi | CEO – Anurag Jain | Chair – Narendra Modi | VC – Ashok Lahiri

News - 383

- 40th 'Global Financial Centres Index (GFCI 40)' – published by Z/Yen Partners (UK) & China Development Institute
- GIFT City – ranked 37th globally (from 46th in GFCI 39)
  - Only Indian centre among top 15 financial centres in Asia-Pacific
- Top city (globally) – New York | 2nd – London | 3rd – Hong Kong | 4th – Singapore | 5th – Shanghai
  - 6th – Tokyo | 7th – Seoul | 8th – Shenzhen | 9th – Dubai | 10th – Zurich
- GFCI FinTech ranking: GIFT City – 26th (from 29th)
- Mumbai (India's only other featured centre) – 49th (up 3 places)

News - 384

- 'Progress on the SDGs: The Gender Snapshot 2026' report – released by UN Women & UN DESA
- 1 in 3 institutional mechanisms for gender equality – had its power weakened over the past 2 years
- No target under SDG 5 (Gender Equality) is on track for 2030 | At the current rate, gender equality is 171 years away
- Women hold 27.4% of national parliament seats in 2026 | Parliamentary parity is 63 years away
- Women's share of national cabinets – fell to 22.4% in 2026 (from a peak of 23.3% in 2024)
- Women hold only 6% of global corporate CEO positions | Only 31 of 175 chief justices worldwide are women
- Women – ~22% of AI professionals | 2.9 billion women & girls live in countries highly exposed to climate change
- HQs of UN Women – New York City, USA | Executive Director – Sima Sami Bahous | Established in – 2010
- HQs of UN DESA – New York City, USA | Head (Under-Secretary-General) – Li Junhua | Established in – 1948

News - 385

- 'State of Global Water Resources 2025' report – released by World Meteorological Organization (WMO)
- 2025 – 4th consecutive year in which every major glaciated region recorded a net loss of ice mass
- Glacier mass loss in hydrological year 2025 (Oct 2024 - Sep 2025) – 408 (±132) gigatonnes
  - Equal to 1.1 (±0.4) mm of sea-level rise
  - Cumulative glacier loss during 2023-2025 – 1,400 gigatonnes (~560 million Olympic-sized swimming pools)
- Regions with annual mass balance among their 3 most negative years on record:
  - Central Asia, South Asia West, Russian Arctic, Iceland & Western Canada and USA
- 2025 – one of the driest years for global river discharge in 35 years
- Asia & Africa – accounted for at least half of all recorded water-related extreme events & 80%+ of associated deaths over past 5 years
- HQs of WMO – Geneva, Switzerland | SG – Celeste Saulo | President – Dr Abdulla Al Mandous

News - 386

- India – ranked 1st in 'Global Business Climate Survey 2026'
  - Produced by – Business Sweden with Swedish Chambers of Commerce
- Top ranks: 1st – India & Ireland (joint) | Followed by – Vietnam, Poland & Denmark
- Highest market-level growth projections – India, Philippines & Poland
- Asia-Pacific – most optimistic region | India & Vietnam – among highest-rated markets
- Globally: 80% of Swedish companies – reported a neutral/positive business climate
  - 64% – reported profitability | 65% – expected higher turnover
- Share of Saudi Arabian firms with a positive outlook – fell to 44% in 2026 (from 90% in 2025)

News - 387

- 4th 'World's Best Companies 2026' ranking – released by TIME & Statista
- 1st – Nvidia (USA) for 2nd consecutive year, with a score of 97.51 out of 100 (from 97.62 in 2025)
  - 2nd – Cigna (USA) | 3rd – Apple (USA) | 4th – Meta Platforms (USA) | 5th – AstraZeneca (UK-Sweden)
  - 6th – Microsoft (USA) | 7th – Deutsche Telekom (Germany) | 10th – AMD
- Companies scored on 3 equally weighted dimensions: Employee satisfaction | Revenue growth over last 3 years
  - Sustainability transparency (ESG data)
- New entrants: Wistron (Taiwan) – 16th | Lenovo (China) – 51st | Zurich Insurance Group – 70th
- Among defence companies: Thales (France) – 22nd (from 224th) | Leonardo (Italy) – 25th (from 126th)

News - 388

- 'M3M Hurun India Rich List 2026' – released by Hurun India
- 1st – Gautam Adani & family, with a net worth of ₹9.23 lakh Cr (up 13%)
  - 2nd – Mukesh Ambani & family, whose wealth fell 10% to ₹8.63 lakh Cr
  - 3rd – LN Mittal & family (ArcelorMittal) with ₹3.40 lakh Cr (largest absolute gain on list)
- Among entertainers – Shah Rukh Khan topped for 2nd consecutive year, ₹10,000 Cr
  - Followed by – Amitabh Bachchan (₹4,000 Cr) | Salman Khan (₹3,000 Cr) | Hrithik Roshan (₹2,500 Cr)

News - 389

- 'Megahubs 2026' report – released by OAG (UK)
  - It ranks the world's most internationally connected airports by a connectivity index (top 50)
- 1st globally – Istanbul Airport (Turkiye), for the first time (up from 2nd in 2025), with a connectivity index of 265.4
- 2nd – London Heathrow (UK) | 3rd – Amsterdam Schiphol (Netherlands) | 4th – Kuala Lumpur International (Malaysia)
- 5th – Chicago O'Hare (USA)

- India's Indira Gandhi International Airport, Delhi – climbed 11 places to 28th globally (from 39th in 2025)
  - It is the country's highest-ranked airport | It overtook Dubai, which fell to 31st (from 15th)
- Delhi – also ranked 9th among Asia-Pacific Megahubs & 9th in OAG's Low-Cost Carrier (LCC) Megahubs Index
- Mumbai – fell out of the global top 50 (from 44th in 2024)

News - 390

- 'Electrification' Special Report – released by the IEA
  - Prepared at the request of Turkiye & Australia under the IEA-COP31 strategic partnership
- India's electrification rate – could rise from 19% currently to 32% by 2035 under 'High Electrification Scenario (HES)'
- Global electrification rate – could reach 35% by 2035 (from ~23% currently) | Southeast Asia – from 25% to 37%
- If fuel-importing countries accelerate electrification, global energy import bills could fall by $400+ bn by 2035 (vs 2025)
  - India's energy import reduction – estimated at ~30% of its 2025 import bill
- India's electric car sales – rose 115%+ (Mar-Jun 2026 vs same period 2025) | EVs – 65%+ of 3-wheeler sales in 2025
- HQs of IEA – Paris, France | Executive Director – Dr. Fatih Birol | Member countries – 30

News - 391

- "September 2026 Chief Economists' Outlook" report – released by World Economic Forum (WEF)
- India – strongest growth outlook among geographies covered
- Chief economists expecting strong/very strong growth in India over next 12 months – rose to 74% (from 52% in May'26)
- India's growth forecast for 2026-27 – raised to 6.7% in Aug 2026
- India – slipped from 2nd to 4th in ranking of favourable business destinations for MNCs
  - Only 40% of respondents placed India among top 3 destinations (from 56% earlier)
- HQs of WEF – Geneva, Switzerland | Co-Chairs (Board) – Laurence D. Fink & André Hoffmann | President & CEO – Alois Zwinggi | Established in – 1971

News - 392

- 10th edition of "Travel & Tourism Development Index (TTDI) 2026" – released by World Economic Forum (WEF)
  - Developed with – Zurich Insurance Group
- India – climbed 9 places to 31st among 110 economies | 1st – Japan | Followed by – US, Spain, Australia & France
- India (with China & Mexico) – among top 10 economies for number of World Heritage cultural sites
- HQs of WEF – Geneva, Switzerland | Co-Chairs (Board) – Laurence D. Fink & André Hoffmann | President & CEO – Alois Zwinggi | Established in – 1971

AMOUNT & AGREEMENTS

News - 393

- ADB + Karnataka = a ₹1,750 Cr loan agreement to upgrade 500 government schools into Karnataka Public Schools (KPS) over next 4 years
- 500 selected government schools will be upgraded into KPS
  - Each will be equipped with infrastructure & facilities capable of accommodating at least 1,200 students
- Total programme cost – ₹2,500 Cr (₹1,750 Cr – through ADB assistance | ₹750 Cr – State Govt)
- HQs of ADB – Mandaluyong, Philippines | President – Masato Kanda | Members – 69
- Karnataka: Capital – Bangalore | CM – D. K. Shivakumar | Governor – Thaawarchand Gehlot

News - 394

- ADB + MP = signed ADB's 1st Transaction Advisory Services (TAS) mandate in India
  - For renewable energy projects through PPP model
- ADB – to act as transaction advisor for 3 clean energy projects | Expected private investment – up to $1 billion
- Projects include – solar power generation & Battery Energy Storage System (BESS) facility at Shajapur
- MP Renewable Energy Policy 2025 – targets 50% of state's electricity demand from renewable sources by 2030
- HQs of ADB – Mandaluyong, Philippines | President – Masato Kanda | Members – 69
- Madhya Pradesh: Capital – Bhopal | CM – Mohan Yadav | Governor – Mangubhai Chhaganbhai Patel

News - 395

- Ministry of Finance – secured $1 billion funding from IFC to expand long-term credit to MSMEs
- IFC – already provided $500 million to SIDBI | Remaining $500 million – to be mobilised through SIDBI's lender syndicate
- Facility – swapped into Indian rupees through RBI's special swap window
  - It will enable MSMEs to access loans with tenures of up to 7 years
- Minister of Finance: Nirmala Sitharaman | Constituency – Karnataka

  MoS in Ministry of Finance: Pankaj Chaudhary

News - 396

- Maldives – repaid a $150 million loan to India by settling the final $50 million tranche of Treasury Bills
- The $150 million Treasury Bills – subscribed by SBI in 2019, rolled over 6 times (each for a year) at the Maldives' request
- Maldives paid the principal | India bore the entire interest (~$45 million over the past 5 years)
- India also extended a ₹30 billion currency swap facility to the Maldives
- SBI subscribed to $350 million worth of Treasury bonds valid till 2029 & 2030

News - 397

- World Bank Group – mobilised a record $112 billion in private capital for developing economies in FY26
- Private Capital Mobilisation (PCM) – more than tripled from $35 billion in FY22
  - Total financing & mobilisation in developing economies – exceeded $200 billion
- PCM to lower-middle-income countries – rose to $37 billion (from $14 billion in FY22)
  - Upper-middle-income – $50 billion (from $12 billion)
- PCM in Africa – rose to ~$22 billion (from ~$9 billion) | Low-income countries – maintained at ~$3 billion
- Guarantees issued – $25+ billion, surpassing its goal of $20 billion annual issuance by 2030, 4 years ahead of schedule
  - Growth led by – 'World Bank Group Guarantee Platform', created in 2024
- 55% of Group's total FY26 financing – went to 5 job-rich sectors
  - Infrastructure & energy, agribusiness, healthcare, tourism & value-added manufacturing
- HQs of World Bank – Washington D.C., US | President – Ajay Banga | MD/CFO – Anshula Kant | Members – 189

News - 398

- Bhupender Yadav – launched a workshop on 'Capacity Enhancement for Effective Forest Management Project' in Delhi
  - Organised by = MoEFCC + JICA
- Total outlay – ₹537.10 Cr (JICA - ₹440.42 Cr + GoI - ₹96.68 Cr) | Implementation period – 7 years (2025-26 to 2031-32)
- Aim: strengthen the capacity of frontline forest personnel amid changing forest, wildlife & climate management needs
- HQs of JICA – Tokyo, Japan | President – Akihiko Tanaka

News - 399

- India + Bhutan = signed a concessional Line of Credit (LoC) of ₹4,000 Cr for energy projects in Bhutan
- Jointly inaugurated – 65-bedded Gyaltsuen Jetsun Pema Mother & Child Hospital (Mongar) & 80-metre Jaganathan Bridge (Samdrup Jongkhar-Trashigang Highway)
- India & Bhutan – jointly developed 5 hydroelectric projects | Combined capacity – 3,156 MW
  - Projects – Chukha, Kurichhu, Tala, Mangdechhu & Punatsangchhu-II
- Bhutan – Thimphu – Bhutanese Ngultrum | PM – Tshering Tobgay | Monarch – Jigme Khesar Namgyel Wangchuck

ORDINANCE, BILLS & ACTS

News - 400

- Tribunals Reforms Bill, 2026 – provides for "National Tribunals Data Grid", a centralised digital repository covering case-related information of 16 tribunals & appellate bodies listed in First Schedule, including Income Tax Appellate Tribunal & National Green Tribunal
- Bill repeals 'Tribunals Reforms Act, 2021'
- National Tribunals Commission (NTC) – responsible for developing & maintaining National Tribunals Data Grid
  - It comprises = Chairperson + 2 Judicial Members + 2 Technical Members
  - Chairperson must be former Supreme Court Judge or Chief Justice of High Court
  - Members are appointed by Central Govt for 5 years or till age 70, whichever is earlier
  - Technical Members require minimum 25 years' experience in public administration, finance, law, accountancy, banking, management or technology
- Tribunal pendency – 5.24 lakh+ cases pending across various tribunals

News - 401

- DoCA (MoCAF&PD) – notified "Legal Metrology (Indian Standard Time) Rules, 2026"
  - Framed under Section 52 of Legal Metrology Act, 2009
- Rules establish Indian Standard Time (IST) as single, uniform legal reference for legal, administrative, commercial & official purposes across India
  - It will come into force 180 days after publication in Official Gazette
- Govt offices & public institutions must synchronise their clocks using Network Time Protocol & Precision Time Protocol
- IST – maintained by CSIR-National Physical Laboratory (CSIR-NPL) & not by India Meteorological Department or ISRO
  - It is calculated as Coordinated Universal Time (UTC) plus 5 hours 30 minutes, based on 82.5°E longitude reference
- Minister of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution: Pralhad Joshi | Constituency – Dharwad

  MoS in Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution: B. L. Verma & Nimuben Jayantibhai Bambhaniya

News - 402

- Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla – constituted a 31-member Joint Committee of Parliament (JPC)
  - To examine Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026
  - Chairperson – BJP MP Sanjay Jaiswal (Bettiah in Bihar)
- It comprises 21 members from Lok Sabha & 10 from Rajya Sabha, including:
  - 14 – from BJP | 5 – from Congress | 2 – each from Janata Dal (United), Trinamool Congress & DMK
  - 1 – each from Samajwadi Party, IUML, Shiv Sena, NCP (Sharadchandra Pawar), NCP & Telugu Desam Party
- FCRA Amendment Bill – proposes changes to Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act, 2010
- Committee has to submit its report to Lok Sabha by last day of first week of Parliament's Winter Session

News - 403

- DoCA (MoCAFPD) – notified "Consumer Protection (E-Commerce) (Amendment) Rules, 2026", w.e.f. Jan 1, 2027
  - Under Section 101(2)(zg) of Consumer Protection Act, 2019
  - It amends – Consumer Protection (E-Commerce) Rules, 2020
- Amended rules redefine "ranking" to cover relative prominence or relevance given to sellers, goods or services on an e-commerce platform, irrespective of technological means used
- Where a price reduction is announced, platforms must display both reduced & prior price
- "Prior price" – lowest price offered in preceding 30 days
- E-commerce entities must comply with Guidelines for Prevention and Regulation of Dark Patterns, 2023
- They must conduct an annual self-audit & prominently display a compliance certificate
- Grievance officers must acknowledge consumer complaints within 48 hours, provide a copy of recorded complaint
  - They must redress complaints within 1 month of receipt
- Every e-commerce entity must become a partner in convergence process of National Consumer Helpline (NCH)
- Minister of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution: Pralhad Joshi | Constituency – Dharwad

  MoS in Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution: B. L. Verma & Nimuben Jayantibhai Bambhaniya

News - 404

- 'Registration of Births and Deaths (Amendment) Act, 2026' – to come into force from Oct 1, 2026
  - Notified by – Registrar General of India Mrityunjay Kumar Narayan
- It amends – Section 13(3) of 'Registration of Births and Deaths Act, 1969', tightening provisions for delayed registration
- Delay of more than 1 year (within 2 years) – requires order from DM, SDM or Executive Magistrate
  - After verification & prescribed fee
- Delay beyond 2 years – requires order from Judicial Magistrate of First Class

News - 405

- President Droupadi Murmu – amended "Inter-State Council Order, 1990" with immediate effect
  - To provide for participation of Governors & Lieutenant Governors in meetings of Inter-State Council
  - When specified constitutional or statutory provisions are in force in their respective states or UTs
- Amendment was notified by – MHA, in exercise of powers conferred under Article 263 of Constitution
- Existing proviso in Clause 2 of 1990 Order – substituted with a new provision specifying 4 situations in which concerned Governor or Lieutenant Governor shall be invited to attend Council meetings
  - When a proclamation under Article 356 is in force in a state, its Governor shall be invited
  - When an order under Article 239AB is in force for NCT of Delhi, its Lieutenant Governor shall be invited
  - When an order under Section 51 of 'Government of Union Territories Act, 1963' is in force, Lieutenant Governor of Puducherry shall be invited

- When an order under Section 73 of 'Jammu and Kashmir Reorganisation Act, 2019' is in force, Lieutenant Governor of J&K shall be invited

- Inter-State Council – established under Article 263 of Constitution through Inter-State Council Order, 1990

News - 406

- MEA – notified the 'Passports (Amendment) Rules, 2026', amending passport validity for children below 15 years
  - under Section 24 of the 'Passports Act, 1967'
  - It substitutes Rule 12(1A) of the 'Passports Rules, 1980'
- New rule – a 36-page ordinary passport for a child below 15 will be valid for 5 years from issue OR until the child turns 18, whichever is earlier (earlier – 5 years or until age 15)
- Passport fees revised w.e.f. Jul 1, 2026 – fresh/reissued 36-page minor passport: ₹1,750 Normal (from ₹1,000)
  - ₹4,250 Tatkaal (from ₹3,000)
  - Adult 36-page Normal fee – ₹2,500 (from ₹1,500)
- Minister of External Affairs: S. Jaishankar | Constituency – Gujarat
- MoS in Ministry of External Affairs: Kirtivardhan Singh & Pabitra Margherita

MOUS, COLLABORATIONS & PARTNERSHIPS

News - 407

- UNDP (India) + HUL = partnered to strengthen an inclusive circular economy for plastics across India
  - It targets support for 50,000 Safai Mitras & strengthen waste management systems across 50 cities & ULBs by 2028
- It is structured around 4 priorities: Social Inclusion, Urban Systems, Improving Recycling Efficiency & Knowledge Transfer
- HQs of HUL – Mumbai, Maharashtra | MD & CEO – Priya Nair | Chairman – Nitin Paranjpe
- HQs of UNDP – New York, US | Administrator – Alexander De Croo | Founded in – 1965
  HQs of UNDP India – New Delhi | Resident Representative – Dr. Angela Lusigi

News - 408

- Air India + Drukair (Bhutan) = partnered to enhance seamless travel convenience & strengthen network connectivity between India, Bhutan & beyond
- Air India guests can travel seamlessly to Paro via Delhi from across Air India's international network
- HQs of Air India – New Delhi | MD & CEO – Tewolde Gebremariam (subsidiary of Tata Group)

News - 409

- Andhra Pradesh + UK = a Government-to-Government MoU to bring international expertise, advanced technology & sustainable development practices into state's urban infrastructure programme
  - ₹40,000 Cr worth of projects being taken up across 123 municipalities & municipal corporations
- A joint Government-to-Government Steering Group will oversee implementation of this partnership
- Andhra Pradesh: Capital – Amaravati | CM – N Chandra Babu Naidu | Governor – Syed Abdul Nazeer
- UK – London – Pound Sterling | PM – Andy Burnham | New King – King Charles lll

News - 410

- BHU + CII = 2 MoUs to organise inaugural "Banaras Biennale 2026" & establish a CII "Education to Employment & Enterprise (E2EE) Career Lounge" on BHU campus
- BHU's Bharat Kala Bhawan – to serve as institutional partner for month-long "Banaras Biennale 2026"
  - It will be held from Nov 27 to Dec 31, 2026 | Theme – "KASHI / LIGHT - City as Sensorium"
- CII currently operates 32 E2EE lounges nationally & plans to expand network to 100 centres
- HQs of CII – New Delhi | President – R Mukundan | VP – Shashwat Goenka | DG – Chandrajit Banerjee
- HQs of BHU – Varanasi, UP | Vice Chancellor – Ajit Kumar Chaturvedi | Established in – 1916

News - 411

- Econz IT Services – launched Bengaluru's 1st dedicated "Gemini Enterprise Experience Centre"
  - In collaboration with – Google Cloud
- Visitors can access live demonstrations & custom AI agent development using Google's 'Agent Development Kit (ADK)'
- HQs of Econz IT Services – Bengaluru, Karnataka | CEO – Moby K. Babu | Established in – 2006

News - 412

- OGEL + 4 municipalities in Haryana (Gurugram, Faridabad, Hisar & Ambala) = MoUs to develop integrated Compressed Biogas (CBG) & Waste-to-Energy projects
  - 4 projects will process municipal solid waste at Hisar (500 TPD), Ambala (900 TPD), Faridabad (1,600 TPD) & Gurugram (2,000 TPD)
- Projects are aligned with "GOBARdhan" National Circular Bioenergy Scheme 2026
  - GOBARdhan – Galvanizing Organic Bio-Agro Resources Dhan
- Haryana: Capital – Chandigarh | CM – Nayab Singh Saini | Governor – Prof. Ashim Kumar Ghosh
- HQs of OIL – Noida, Uttar Pradesh | CMD – Arvinder Singh Sahney | Founded in – 1959

News - 413

- IIT Madras + UNESCO MGIEP = signed a cooperation agreement to jointly develop next-generation AI-powered & immersive learning technologies to transform education globally
- UNESCO MGIEP – a UNESCO Category 1 institute headquartered in New Delhi
- Director of IIT Madras – Prof. V. Kamakoti
- HQs of UNESCO MGIEP – New Delhi, Delhi | Director – Obijiofor Aginam | Established in – 2014

News - 414

- HAL + Safran Helicopter Engines (France) = signed a final contract for design, development, manufacture, supply & lifecycle support of "Aravalli"
  - It is a new-generation helicopter engine in 3,500-4,000 shaft horsepower (shp) class
  - It will be through their 50:50 JV SAFHAL Helicopter Engines Pvt. Ltd.
- Aravalli engine – selected to power HAL's upcoming 13-tonne Indian Multi-Role Helicopter & its 12.5-tonne naval variant, Deck-Based Multi-Role Helicopter (DBMRH)
  - It will be manufactured at a SAFHAL facility in Tumakuru, Karnataka
- HQs of HAL – Bengaluru, Karnataka | CMD – Ravi K
- France – Paris – Euro | President – Emmanuel Macron | PM – Sebastien Lecornu

News - 415

- DoT + C-DoT = a strategic 5-year agreement to establish an "End-to-End Optical Network Test Bed"
  - It will be located at C-DoT campus in New Delhi | Funded & supported by – DoT
- HQs of C-DoT – New Delhi | CEO – Rajkumar Upadhyay | C-DoT works under – DoT (Ministry of Communications)

News - 416

- Tata Elxsi + Sarla Aviation = an MoU to collaborate on development of "Shunya"
  - India's 1st indigenous electric vertical take-off & landing (eVTOL) air taxi
- Shunya – a six-seater-plus-pilot eVTOL aircraft combining vertical take-off & landing with fixed-wing cruise efficiency
- Sarla Aviation – previously flight-tested technology for Shunya using a smaller demonstrator aircraft named 'Sylla'
- HQs of Tata Elxsi – Bengaluru, Karnataka | Chairman – Soumitra Bhattacharya | MD & CEO – Manoj Raghavan
- HQs of Sarla Aviation – Bengaluru, Karnataka | Co-Founder & CEO – Adrian Schmidt | Established in – 2023

News - 417

- Bihar + Jharkhand = an MoU on sharing waters of Sone River
  - It allocates 5.75 Million Acre-Feet (MAF) of water to Bihar & 2 MAF to Jharkhand
- Sone River originates at Sonmuda, near Amarkantak in Anuppur, MP & merges with Ganges near Patna
  - It is 2nd largest southern tributary of Ganges
- Bihar: Capital – Patna | CM – Samrat Choudhary | Governor – Lt. Gen. (Retired) Syed Ata Hasnain
- Jharkhand: Capital – Ranchi | CM – Hemant Soren | Governor – Santosh Kumar Gangwar

News - 418

- MoSPI + TIET (Punjab) = an MoU for a research study to develop a Predictive & Analytical Framework for Monthly Consumption Expenditures in India
- MoS I/C of Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation: Rao Inderjit Singh | Constituency – Gurgaon, Haryana

News - 419

- FIFI + EICA = MoU to collaborate on culinary activities, industry outreach & promote global food & beverage products
- EICA currently maintains an active presence across West Bengal, Sikkim, north-eastern states, Odisha & Jharkhand
- HQs of FIFI – New Delhi, Delhi | Founder Director – Amit Lohani | Established in – 2009
- HQs of EICA – Kolkata, West Bengal | President – Chef Abhiru Biswas | Established in – 2024

News - 420

- SCCA + GCAI = an MoU to strengthen cooperation between in-house legal communities of Singapore & India
- "India-Singapore Legal Bridge: Enabling Growth, Investment and Effective Dispute Resolution in a Changing Global Economy" event in Singapore – held alongside Singapore Convention Week
- Key initiative under the partnership – 'Cross-border Immersion Programme' (developed by SCCA Academy & GCAI)
- Singapore – Singapore – Dollar | PM – Lawrence Wong | President – Tharman Shanmugaratnam
- HQs of GCAI – New Delhi | President – C. V. Raghu | Established in – 2021

News - 421

- India + Germany = a Joint Declaration of Intent on Conservation & Wise Use of Wetlands of International Importance
  - During 4th Indo-German Environment Forum (IGEF) – held in New Delhi | Theme – "Together for More Resilience"
- IGEF (established in 2008) – highest-level bilateral platform between India & Germany on environmental policy
- Germany – Berlin – Euro | President – Frank-Walter Steinmeier | Chancellor – Freidrich Merz

News - 422

- NABARD + IMD = MoU to integrate IMD's agro-meteorological data products into 'Data in Climate Resilient Agriculture'
  - It is an open-source digital platform supported by NABARD & United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)
- HQs of NABARD – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Shaji K. V. | Founded in – 1982
- HQs of IMD – New Delhi | Director General – Dr. Mrutyunjay Mohapatra | Founded in – 1875

News - 423

- IBCA + ADB = an MoU to strengthen collaboration in landscape conservation, sustainable development, capacity building, knowledge exchange & nature-positive financing initiatives
- It was formalised during a two-day International Workshop themed "Tiger Landscapes: Conservation, Bioeconomy and Ecotourism as Pillars for Livelihood and Income Generation"
  - Jointly organised by – IBCA, ADB & NTCA
- IBCA – launched by PM Modi on Apr 9, 2023, at Mysuru during commemoration of 50 years of Project Tiger
  - India committed ₹150 Cr over 5 years (2023-24 to 2027-28) to IBCA
- IBCA became a full treaty-based inter-governmental organisation on Jan 23, 2025
  - Following ratification by India, Nicaragua, Eswatini, Somalia & Liberia
- HQs of IBCA – New Delhi | President – Bhupender Yadav | DG – SP Yadav | Founded in – April 2023
- HQs of ADB – Mandaluyong, Philippines | President – Masato Kanda | Members – 69

News - 424

- BPCL + CSE = an MoU to explore collaboration in biofuels, biomass resource utilisation, waste-to-resource solutions & circular economy initiatives
- HQs of BPCL – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman & MD – Sanjay Khanna | Founded in – 1952
- HQs of Centre for Science and Environment (CSE) – New Delhi | DG – Sunita Narain | Established in – 1980

News - 425

- BTTF + Première Vision SA (France) = an MoU to establish a multi-year institutional partnership to strengthen India's engagement with global fashion & textile ecosystem
- HQs of BTTF – New Delhi | Chairman – Naren Goenka | Co-Chairman – Bhadresh Dodia | Established in – 2024

News - 426

- OSDMA – signed 2 MoUs with UNDP & CivicDataLab (CDL) at Lok Seva Bhawan Convention Centre, Bhubaneswar
  - OSDMA + UNDP = an MoU for disaster management, community resilience, preparedness & capacity building
  - OSDMA + CivicDataLab = an MoU to develop Digital Public Infrastructure for Disaster Risk Reduction in Odisha
    - Through – Intelligent Data Solutions for Disaster Risk Reduction (IDS-DRR) platform
- Odisha: Capital – Bhubaneswar | CM – Mohan Charan Majhi | Governor – Dr Hari Babu Kambhampati

News - 427

- SEBI + ESMA = an MoU for cooperation & information exchange relating to SEBI-regulated Central Counterparties (CCPs)
  - It replaces their earlier MoU dated June 21, 2017
- HQs of SEBI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Tuhin Kanta Pandey | Established in – 1992
- HQs of ESMA – Paris, France | Chair – Verena Ross | Established in – 2011

News - 428

- Assam Govt (Samagra Shiksha Assam) – signed MoUs for 6 partnerships to integrate AI into school education
  - Assam + Google AI = an Mou to train teachers in AI-powered educational tools & digital skills
  - IIT Madras + Bodhan AI = an MoU to train ~1 lakh teachers of Grades 6-12 in AI by May 2027
  - LEHS + Wadhwani AI = an MoU to strengthen foundational literacy through AI-enabled assessment
  - Assam + Educate Girls = an MoU to identify, enrol & retain out-of-school adolescents, particularly girls
  - EkStep + AXL = an MoU to personalise AI-assisted learning in foundational literacy & numeracy
  - Assam + Canva Education = an MoU to assist teachers with lesson planning & classroom instruction
- Assam: Capital – Dispur | CM – Himanta Biswa Sarma | Governor – Lakshman Prasad Acharya

News - 429

- Jindal Stainless + JFE Steel Corp. (Japan) = a Technical Assistance Agreement for selected ferritic stainless steel grades
  - JFE Steel – to provide assistance in product quality, manufacturing practices & process efficiency
- HQs of Jindal Stainless Ltd – New Delhi | CEO – Tarun Kumar Khulbe

News - 430

- NALCO + Emirates Global Aluminium = a Technology Licensing Agreement for 'DX+ Ultra' aluminium smelting technology
  - To be deployed at NALCO's proposed 0.5 MTPA brownfield smelter expansion in Angul, Odisha
- HQs of NALCO – Bhubaneswar, Odisha | CMD – Brijendra Pratap Singh | Established in – 1981
- HQs of EGA – Abu Dhabi, UAE | CEO – Abdulnasser Bin Kalban | Established in – 2013

News - 431

- Sergio Gor (US Ambassador) – launched 'TRUST Fellowship' in Bengaluru for collaboration in critical technologies
  - 12-month programme for up to 20 US postdoctoral researchers & early-career faculty, beginning Sep 2026
- Host institutions – IIT Madras, IISc Bengaluru & Manipal Academy of Higher Education (MAHE)
- Monthly stipends: Postdoctoral fellows – $1,650 | Visiting Faculty at IIT-M – $3,650
- Funded by – Kris Gopalakrishnan (Pratithi Investments) & Kiran Mazumdar-Shaw (Mazumdar-Shaw Philanthropy)
- TRUST – Transforming Relationship Utilizing Strategic Technology
  - Initiative announced by Donald Trump + Narendra Modi on Feb 13, 2025; replaced iCET

News - 432

- NCDEX + CAI = a 5-year strategic partnership to deepen participation in cotton derivatives
  - Also to build a more transparent price discovery & risk-management ecosystem for India's cotton sector
- India accounts for 20-23% of global cotton production & nearly 38% of world's cotton acreage
- CAI had earlier held permanent recognition under Forward Contracts (Regulation) Act, 1952
- NCDEX – 1st exchange permitted to resume cotton futures trading when futures were reintroduced in 1998
- HQs of NCDEX – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Chairman – Ashish Bahuguna | MD & CEO – Vikas Goel
- HQs of CAI – Mumbai, Maharashtra | President – Vinay N. Kotak | CMD – Lalit Kumar Gupta | Established in – 1921

News - 433

- ITRA (Jamnagar) + HFI (Hyderabad) = a 5-yr MoU to promote preventive & holistic healthcare through an integrated approach

News - 434

- NIELIT (MeitY) + Saylor University (USA) = collaboration to integrate Saylor's digital learning resources into NIELIT Digital University (NDU) platform
- Learners registered on NDU platform will gain access to University's free, self-paced online courses in various areas
- HQs of NIELIT – New Delhi | DG – Dr Madan Mohan Tripathi | Chairperson – Union Minister of MeitY

News - 435

- NIT Rourkela + NRSC (ISRO) + Tea Board India (MoC&I) = a tripartite MoU for collaborative research under "CHAYANKAN: Comprehensive AI-based Geospatial Data Analytics for Tea Plantation Monitoring"
  - It was signed at Regional Remote Sensing Centre-East (RRSC-East), NRSC, Kolkata
- This 3-year project – commenced in Apr 2026
  - To develop geospatial & AI-based solutions for tea plantation mapping, yield estimation & pest/disease forecasting
- Leader of this project – Dr. Arati Paul (Principal Investigator at RRSC-East, NRSC)
- HQs of ISRO – Bengaluru, Karnataka | Director – Dr. V. Narayanan | Formed on – August 15, 1969
- HQs of Tea Board India – Kolkata, West Bengal | Chairman – Nitin Kumar Yadav, IAS | Established in – 1954

News - 436

- MC^{2+} Foundation + IIT Bombay + SINE (IIT Bombay) = a tripartite MoU to give energy-sector startups access to research facilities, funding, mentors & pilot projects
- Mumbai City Connect of 'MC^{2+} Ignite' (an energy innovation accelerator) – hosted by ONGC at IIT Bombay
- Arun Kumar Singh (ONGC Chairman & CEO) – announced a ₹2,000 Cr AIF for deeptech energy startups
- SINE – supported 324 startups with ₹9,204 Cr in funds raised, across 7 energy innovation themes
- 1st phase – up to 30 startups to receive convertible funding of up to ₹50 lakh each
  - Total potential support – ₹2 Cr per startup
- MC^{2+} Ignite – formally launched at IIT Madras on Aug 19, 2026
- Director of IIT Bombay – Prof. Shireesh Kedare
- HQs of MC^{2+} Foundation – New Delhi | Chairman – Dr. Neeraj Mittal | CEO – Sandeep Maheshwari

News - 437

- JSW Group + Volkswagen Group = a non-binding MoU to advance a proposed 51:49 JV covering Volkswagen's passenger vehicle operations in India
  - Final binding agreement – targeted by Dec 2026
- Proposed venture – a new entity combining JSW & Skoda Auto Volkswagen India Pvt Ltd, separate from JSW MG Motor India (with China's SAIC Motor)
- Venture's capital commitments – estimated at over €1 billion (~₹10,000 Cr)
- HQs of JSW Group – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CMD – Sajjan Jindal
- HQs of Volkswagen Group – Wolfsburg, Germany | CEO – Oliver Blume | Established in – 1937

News - 438

- Industries Dept. (Bihar) + AIM Global Foundation = an MoU to promote a dedicated Food Processing Park in Bihar
  - Anchored by – UAE & wider Gulf region investments
- Exchanged at – 'AIM (Annual Investment Meeting) Congress 2026' in Dubai, UAE
- Bihar: Capital – Patna | CM – Samrat Choudhary | Governor – Lt. Gen. (Retired) Syed Ata Hasnain
- HQs of AIM Global Foundation – Dubai, UAE | Chairman – Dawood Al Shezawi

News - 439

- Odisha – signed MoUs with IHC (Abu Dhabi) & Adani Group to explore 14 projects worth ~₹2,10,500 Cr
- Portfolio includes: A shipbuilding, repair & green ship-recycling cluster – worth ₹20,000 Cr
  - A petrochemical downstream & packaging park at Paradip – worth ₹10,000 Cr (under a proposed Adani-IHC JV)
- Odisha – also signed a Memorandum of Cooperation with Indian Business & Professional Group (IBPG)
  - To strengthen trade & export ties with UAE
- Odisha: Capital – Bhubaneswar | CM – Mohan Charan Majhi | Governor – Dr Hari Babu Kambhampati
- HQs of Adani Group – Ahmedabad, Gujarat | Chairman – Gautam Adani | MD – Rajesh Adani

News - 440

- Digital Bharat Nidhi (DoT) + Jharkhand + JDICL + BSNL + JCNL = an agreement for implementation of 'Amended BharatNet Programme (ABP)' in Jharkhand under state-led model
- Financial support provisioned by Government of India – ₹1,684 Cr
- Implemented through – newly created Jharkhand Digital Infrastructure Corp Ltd (serving as the state's SPV)
- 'Amended BharatNet Programme' – approved by Union Cabinet on Aug 4, 2023
- Jharkhand: Capital – Ranchi | CM – Hemant Soren | Governor – Santosh Kumar Gangwar

News - 441

- India + MERCOSUR = signed 'First Additional Protocol to the India-MERCOSUR Preferential Trade Agreement (PTA)' to facilitate acceptance of electronic Certificates of Origin (e-CoOs)
  - The protocol was signed by – Rajesh Agrawal (India's Commerce Secretary)
- It amends – Article 16 of Annex III governing Rules of Origin, giving electronic Certificates of Origin the same legal validity as paper ones
- India + MERCOSUR = separately launched negotiations to expand the existing PTA
  - announced by Piyush Goyal & Mario Lubetkin (MERCOSUR's Pro Tempore President)
- India-MERCOSUR PTA – signed on Jan 25, 2004 (came into force on Jun 1, 2009)
  - Concessions – India on 450 tariff lines | MERCOSUR (Argentina, Brazil, Paraguay & Uruguay) on 452 tariff lines

News - 442

- Drydocks World (DP World) + Cochin Shipyard Limited (CSL) = signed a 50:50 JV agreement
  - To operate & expand 'International Ship Repair Facility (ISRF)' in Kochi, Kerala
  - At – sidelines of 'BRICS Summit 2026' in New Delhi
- CSL – to hand over ISRF to JV on a slump-sale basis, valued at ~₹1,800 Cr (its estimated net worth)
- Drydocks World – to hold greater operational control, nominating 3 of JV's 5 directors, along with its CEO, CFO & COO
  - CSL – to nominate remaining 2 directors
- ISRF – built at a cost of ₹970 Cr; operational since Aug 2024 | Workstations – 6
- HQs of Drydocks World – Dubai, UAE | CEO – Captain Rado Antolovic | Established in – 1983
- HQs of Cochin Shipyard – Kochi, Kerala | Chairman & MD – Jose V J | Incorporated in – 1972

News - 443

- NIXI + APNIC = an MoU to strengthen security, resilience & long-term development of India's Internet infrastructure
  - NIXI – **N**ational **I**nternet E**x**change of **I**ndia | APNIC – **A**sia **P**acific **N**etwork **I**nformation **C**entre
  - Signed at – 62nd APNIC Conference (APNIC 62) in Mumbai
- Both will work to increase deployment of IPv6 & Resource Public Key Infrastructure (RPKI) technologies among network operators & enterprises in India
- Key component – hosting of an APNIC RPKI repository mirror in India, to be managed by NIXI
- India's IPv6 penetration – nearly 80% (highest in Asia-Pacific region)
- APNIC 62 – hosted by NIXI & co-hosted by Internet Service Providers Association of India | Held in – Mumbai
- NIXI – a not-for-profit organisation under MeitY | It manages India's '.IN' & '.भारत' country-code top-level domains
- HQs of NIXI – New Delhi | Chairman – S Krishnan | CEO – Devesh Tyagi | Established in – 2003
- HQs of APNIC – Brisbane, Australia | Director General – Jia Rong Low | Established in – 1993

News - 444

- US + India = partnered to strengthen security, resilience & diversification of global undersea cable networks
  - Under – US-India '**T**ransforming the **R**elationship **U**tilizing **S**trategic **T**echnology (TRUST)' Initiative
- Both brought together government & industry experts for an 'Undersea Cables Workshop' in Sep 2026
- Undersea fibre-optic cables – carry more than 95% of global digital traffic
- TRUST Initiative – launched during PM Narendra Modi's visit to Washington in Feb 2025
- US – Washington, D.C. – US Dollar | 47th President – Donald Trump | 50th VP – James David Vance

News - 445

- Union Govt + West Bengal + AAI = a tripartite MoU to develop 4 more regional airports in West Bengal
- Proposed sites – Chharra (Purulia), Balurghat (South Dinajpur), Hasimara (Alipurduar) & Kalaikunda (West Midnapore)
  - Hasimara & Kalaikunda – also serve as important Indian Air Force bases
- Aim: To expand regional air connectivity, extend aviation access to districts outside state's existing airport network
- HQs of AAI – New Delhi | Chairman – Vipin Kumar
- West Bengal: Capital – Kolkata | CM – Suvendu Adhikari | Governor – R N Ravi

News - 446

- TCS + DGCX (Dubai, UAE) = partnered to modernise & upgrade DGCX's derivatives market infrastructure
- TCS to integrate: 'BaNCS' (clearing & trading) | 'Quartz' (market surveillance) | 'Quartz Gateway' (market connectivity)
- DGCX – Middle East's largest digital marketplace for trading derivatives
- HQs of TCS – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO – K. Krithivasan | Founded in – 1968

News - 447

- DIBD (MeitY) + Current AI + Kalpa Impact = hosted finale of 'VYOMA Innovation Challenge' at IIIT-Delhi
- 10 finalist teams – demonstrated prototypes built on 'Suno Sutra'
  - Suno Sutra – co-developed by BHASHINI & Current AI | Unveiled at – India AI Impact Summit (Feb 2026)
- 4 winners: Team Asha Sahayak | Team Shravan | Team Sangrah - Apna Saathi | Team Sahyak Mitra - A.V.E.R.A.
- Challenge – launched on Jun 2, 2026 | Total prizes – up to ₹80 lakh
- HQs of Digital India BHASHINI Division – New Delhi | CEO – Amitabh Nag | Established in – 2022
- HQs of Current AI – Paris, France | CEO – Ayah Bdeir | Established in – 2025
- HQs of Kalpa Impact – Mumbai, Maharashtra | Founder & CEO – Sushant Kumar | Established in – 2024

News - 448

- CMs of UP, Uttarakhand, HP, Rajasthan, Delhi & Haryana – signed MoA for 'Kishau Multipurpose Project' in New Delhi
  - It marks resolution of 10th water dispute settled during Modi govt's tenure
- Project – 232.6-m-high concrete gravity dam on Tons River, along Uttarakhand-HP border
  - Storage capacity – 1,562 million cubic metres | Irrigation – 97,000 ha | Hydropower – 1,476 million units annually
- Centre – to bear ~90% of cost of water component as Central Assistance | Remaining 10% – shared among 6 states
- Kishau project traces back to a May 12, 1994 agreement among the Yamuna basin states
- Earlier resolved Upper Yamuna basin disputes – Lakhwar & Renukaji multipurpose dams

News - 449

- CISF + IIT Kanpur = 2 MoUs to strengthen cybersecurity & drone/anti-drone capabilities for protecting critical infra.
- 1st MoU (CISF + C3iHub, IIT Kanpur) – 6-week residential 'Cybersecurity Training Programme' for CISF personnel
- 2nd MoU – 5-year framework to set up a Centre of Excellence (CoE) in drone & anti-drone technology
  - Location – CISF's Major Police Training & Recruitment Centre (MPRTC), Behror, Rajasthan
- HQs of CISF – New Delhi | DG – Praveer Ranjan | Motto – 'Protection & Security' | Founded in – 1969
- Director of IIT Kanpur – Prof. Manindra Agrawal

News - 450

- BHEL + Titagarh = a JV agreement to form a company for maintenance of 80 Vande Bharat Sleeper trainsets for 35 years
  - Under – ₹24,000 Cr Indian Railways contract for manufacture & maintenance
- Stake – 50% each | JV company – private limited company, HQ in Delhi, with initial paid-up capital of ₹50 lakh
- Final assembly – Chennai & Latur | Maintenance depots – Shakur Basti (Delhi) & Jogeshwari (Mumbai)
- HQs of BHEL – New Delhi | Chairman & MD – Koppu Sadashiv Murthy
- HQs of TRSL – Kolkata, West Bengal | Executive Chairman – Jagdish Prasad Chowdhary | Established in – 1997

News - 451

- Bharat Forge + Pratt & Whitney Canada (RTX, US) = a collaboration to evaluate integration of advanced turboprop engines into DRDO's HALE UAV
  - HALE UAV – **H**igh-**A**ltitude **L**ong-**E**ndurance **U**nmanned **A**erial **V**ehicle
- India currently leases similar HALE UAVs from – General Atomics (US) | 31 such systems being procured
- HQs of Bharat Forge – Pune, Maharashtra | Chairman – Baba Kalyani | Founded in – 1961

News - 452

- NIELIT (MeitY) + Intel India = launched 'NIELIT-Intel India Agentic AI Skilling Initiative'
  - During National Leadership Dialogue on 'Preparing the Future Workforce for the Agentic AI Era' at India Habitat Centre, New Delhi
- It comprises 2 programmes: 'Agentic AI for Everyone' | 'Engineering Agentic AI Systems'
- HQs of NIELIT – New Delhi | DG – Dr Madan Mohan Tripathi | Chairperson – Union Minister of MeitY
- HQs of Intel – California, US | Chairman – Dr Craig H Barratt | CEO – Lip-Bu Tan | Funded in – 1968

News - 453

- DoSJE (MoSJE) + The Art of Living = extended MoU under 'Nasha Mukt Bharat Abhiyaan (launched on Aug 15, 2020)'
  - To strengthen awareness, prevention & community mobilisation against substance abuse
- DoSJE – signed MoUs with 12 spiritual organisations under NMBA
  - Including – Brahma Kumaris, ISKCON, Sant Nirankari Mission, University of Patanjali & Chinmaya Mission
- HQs of The Art of Living Foundation – Bengaluru, Karnataka | Founder – Sri Sri Ravi Shankar | Established in – 1981
- Minister of Social Justice & Empowerment: Dr. Virendra Kumar | Constituency – Tikamgarh, Madhya Pradesh

  MoS in Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment: Ramdas Athawale & B. L. Verma

News - 454

- NSTFDC (MoTA) + HPCL = an MoU to set up Computer Lab-cum-Smart Classroom facilities in 29 Eklavya Model Residential Schools (EMRS) across 11 districts of Rajasthan
  - Under – HPCL's Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) initiative
- Budget – ₹16.01 Cr | Completion – within 6 months
- Each school to get – 4 smart classrooms (86-inch interactive flat panels), a networked computer lab & 10 tablets
- Implementation & procurement to be handled by – NSTFDC
- Academic validation to be undertaken by – National Education Society for Tribal Students (NESTS)
- HQs of HPCL – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CMD – Vikas Kaushal | Founded in – 1974
- HQs of NSTFDC – New Delhi, Delhi | CMD – Shri T. Roumuan Paite | Established in – 2001

News - 455

- TCA + IIIT-B = signed an LoI at "electronica India 2026" in Bengaluru, facilitated by TECC, Chennai
  - It marks 1st technology cooperation LoI between Taiwan & South India
- HQs of TCA – Taipei, Taiwan | Chairman – Jason Chen | Established in – 1974

News - 456

- Indo-Russia Innopraktika Technology Hub – signed 4 agreements at "INNOPROM India 2026"
- "INNOPROM India 2026" – 1st edition of Russian industrial exhibition held in India, at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi
- 1st: It launches "India-Russia Artificial Intelligence Centre of Excellence"
  - Established with support from Government of Nizhny Novgorod Region & RUSSOFT Software Developers Association
- 2nd: It involves Russian Direct Investment Fund, Panorama Electronics Pvt Ltd (India) & Innopraktika Technology Hub
- 3rd: It expresses mutual intent to establish a JV on Indian soil
- 4th: SberMedAI – to collaborate on AI-driven healthcare solutions
- Russia – Moscow – Russian Ruble | PM – Mikhail Mishustin | President – Vladimir Putin

News - 457

- MDL + NSHIPML = an MoU to serve as anchor shipyard for a proposed greenfield shipbuilding industrial cluster
  - At Dighi in Raigad district, Maharashtra | Estimated investment – ₹27,000 Cr
- NSHIPML – a Special Purpose Vehicle jointly set up by Maharashtra Maritime Board & Mumbai Port Authority
  - It falls under Centre's Greenfield Shipbuilding Cluster Development Plan
- HQs of MDL – Mumbai, MH | CMD – Capt. Jagmohan

News - 458

- DTTDC + MCD = an MoU to conserve & redevelop Town Hall complex in Chandni Chowk as a 'Global Heritage Centre'
  - DTTDC – nodal agency of Delhi govt's Tourism Department
- Project covers – Grade-I heritage Town Hall, Press Building & Park, with ownership remaining with MCD
- Initial term of MoU – 30 years | Extendable by another 30 years through mutual consent
- Delhi: CM – Rekha Gupta | Lt. Governor –Taranjit Singh Sandhu | Chief Secretary – Rajeev Verma

News - 459

- MoCA + AAI – signed 21 MoUs with States/UTs under next phase of Regional Connectivity Scheme 'UDAN'
  - UDAN – Ude Desh ka Aam Nagrik
- Minister also launched 'Challenge Mode Portal for Aerodrome Development' & released Scheme Document for the next phase of UDAN route bidding
- Next phase – 'Modified UDAN', approved by Cabinet in Mar 2026, for 10 years (FY27 to FY36) | Outlay – ₹28,840 Cr
- It provides for developing 100 airports from existing unserved airstrips & 200 modern helipads in hilly, remote, island & aspirational regions
  - Viability Gap Funding (VGF) for airline operators – ₹10,043 Cr
- HQs of AAI – New Delhi | Chairman – Vipin Kumar
- Minister of Civil Aviation: Kinjarapu Rammohan Naidu | Constituency – Srikakulam, Andhra Pradesh
- MoS in Ministry of Civil Aviation: Murlidhar Mohol

News - 460

- IIT (BHU) Varanasi + University of Michigan (US) = MoU for joint research & innovation in electric vehicles & sustainable mobility
- Director of IIT (BHU), Varanasi – Amit Patra

News - 461

- India + Netherlands = signed 2 tripartite MoUs to advance technical cooperation on Gujarat's 'Kalpasar Project'
  - On sidelines of 9th 'India International Water Week (IIWW) 2026' in New Delhi
- MoUs signed between – CWC, Kalpasar Department (Govt of Gujarat) & Dutch institutions Deltares and TU Delft
- Kalpasar Project – envisages a freshwater reservoir using runoff from the Sabarmati, Mahi & Dhadhar rivers
  - Supplemented by – Narmada water
- Theme of 9th IIWW 2026 – 'Climate Resilient Water Management', held at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi
- Netherlands – The Hague – Euro | PM – Rob Jetten

News - 462

- IIEST, Shibpur + TCS = an MoU to establish a Centre of Excellence (CoE) in Artificial Intelligence (AI)
  - Venue – the institute's on-campus High-Performance Computing Lab
- The CoE will operate across 4 pillars – skill development, collaborative research (NLP, Computer Vision, Image Processing & Advanced Data Analytics), consulting/industrial AI solutions & entrepreneurship support
- IIEST, Shibpur (formerly Bengal Engineering and Science University) – is an 'Institute of National Importance'
- HQs of TCS – Mumbai, Maharashtra | CEO – K. Krithivasan | Founded in – 1968
- HQs of IIEST, Shibpur – Howrah, West Bengal | Director – Prof. V. M. S. R. Murthy | Established in – 1856

News - 463

- MDL + NSHIP-AP = an MoU to develop a greenfield shipyard at Dugarajapatnam, Tirupati district, Andhra Pradesh
  - NSHIP-AP – an SPV jointly formed by AP Maritime Board & Visakhapatnam Port Authority
- MDL envisages an investment of ~₹15,000 Cr over the next 5 to 7 years
- The cluster is being developed under GoI's Shipbuilding Development Scheme (SbDS)
- It comes days after MDL's similar MoU for a ₹15,000 Cr cluster at Dighi, Maharashtra
- HQs of MDL – Mumbai, MH | CMD – Capt. Jagmohan | Established in – 1934

News - 464

- NTPC Ltd + EDF Power Solutions India (subsidiary of Electricité de France) = signed a 50:50 JV agreement
  - To develop pumped storage, hydro power & other renewable energy projects & a distribution business
- HQs of NTPC – New Delhi | CMD – Gurdeep Singh | Founded in – 1975

❖ Important Obituaries in September 2026:

- **Don Nelson** (USA) – a Professional Basketball Player & Head Coach
  (He won 5 NBA titles, inducted into the 'Naismith Memorial Basketball Hall of Fame' in 2012)
- **Yayoi Kusama** ("Polka Dot Queen") – a Legendary Japanese Contemporary Artist
  (Her Artistic Legacy: Polka Dots, Infinity Mirror Rooms, Vibrant Pumpkins, Avant-Garde Leader, Prolific Output)
- **Harald V** – Norway's King
- **Oyo Nyimba Kabamba Iguru Rukidi IV** – Uganda's King
  (He was famously recognized as world's youngest reigning monarch.)
- **M.P. Parameswaran** (Kerala) – a Renowned Nuclear Scientist & Marxist Theorist
  (Awards: Right Livelihood Award (Alternative Nobel Prize) in 1996, UNESCO Literacy Award in 1990, Keralasree Award in 2022)
- **Dolly Rebecca Parton** (USA) – a Renowned Singer-Songwriter, Actress & Businesswoman
  (Dubbed the 'Queen of Country', Parton was one of the most successful country music performers in history.)
- **Krishna AchutaRao** – a Prominent Indian Climate Scientist & Professor at IIT Delhi
  (He served as a Lead Author for both the Fifth and Sixth Assessment Reports of the UN's Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC) Working Group I.)
- **Gaurang Vyas** – a Legendary Gujarati Music Composer & Singer
  (He won approx 11 state-level Best Music Direction awards; Lifetime Achievement Award by Gujarat Govt in 2022)
- **N. Purushothama Mallya** – A Noted Educationist & Prominent Konkani language Activist
  (Awards: Padma Shri in 2015, Sahitya Akademi Translation Award in 2008, Vimala V. Pai Vishwa Konkani Jeevan Siddhi Samman in 2011)
- **R. Sarath** – Malayalam Filmmaker
  (Indira Gandhi Award for Best Debut Film of a Director in 2001, National Film Award for Best Feature Film in Malayalam in 2001, Best Narrative Feature Film in 2011, International Film Festival Awards in 2012)
- **S. R. Janakiraman (SRJ)** – Influential Carnatic Musician
  (Awards: Sangita Kala Acharya in 1997 by the Music Academy Madras, Sangeet Natak Akademi Award in 2000, Padma Shri in 2011, Sangeet Natak Akademi Fellow in 2014)
- **Kuku Kohli** – Veteran Bollywood filmmaker
- **Cassandra Wilson** – a Legendary Jazz Singer & Songwriter
  (2 Grammy Awards in 1995 & 2008)
- **Dr. G. Vijayaraghavan** – Renowned Indian Cardiologist
  (Padma Shri in 2009)
- **Solomon Pappaiah** – Veteran Tamil Scholar & Orator
  (Kalaimamani Award in 2000 by TN Govt; Padma Shri in 2021)
- **Tung Chee-hwa** – Hong Kong's First Post-Colonial Leader
- **Princess Astrid** – Princess of Norway
- **Flight Lieutenant Alfred Tyrone Cooke** (Retd) – a celebrated 1965 Indo-Pak War hero

(Vir Chakra in 1965)

❖ Important One-liner Meetings, Conferences & Summits in September 2026:

- 10th Taiwan-India Industrial Collaboration Summit (by FICCI & CNFI) – **Bengaluru, Karnataka**
- National Conference on Tribal Languages and Museums – **Mysuru, Karnataka**
- 5th Coast Guard Global Summit (in Feb'26) – **New Delhi**
- 7th High-Level Meeting between Indian Coast Guard and Vietnam Coast Guard – **Chennai, Tamil Nadu**
- 4th Indo-German Environmental Forum – **New Delhi**
- BRICS Chief Justices' Forum – **New Delhi**
- 27th World Knowledge Forum – **Seol, South Korea**
  (Theme - "The Promethean Moment: Architecting the Co-Intelligence Order")
- G20 Innovation Ministers' Meeting – **Chapel Hill, North Carolina, US**
- 2027 BRICS Summit (19th edition) – **China**
- 1st International Space Summit 2026 – **Paris, France**
- Global Dryland Congress 2026 – **New Delhi**
  (Theme - "Transforming Dryland Agriculture with South–South Cooperation")
  (Organised by = ICAR + ICRISAT)
- 16th edition of Aero India 2027 – **Bengaluru, Karnataka**
- 26th Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) Council of Heads of State Summit – **Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan**
  (Theme – "25 Years of the SCO: Together for Sustainable Peace, Development and Prosperity")
- 79th Session of the WHO Regional Committee for South-East Asia – **Dili, Timor-Leste**
  (It marks the first time in 11 years that this nation hosted this high-level health governance forum.)
- "Lattice 2026", the annual business conclave of IIM Calcutta – **Kolkata, West Bengal**
  (Theme – "The Capability Decade")
- World Circular Economy Forum 2026 – **Gandhinagar, Gujarat**
  (Theme - "Circular Economy: Transition for People and Prosperity")
- 6th All India Official Language Conference – **Navi Mumbai, Maharashtra**
- 9th ASEAN-India Ministerial Meeting on Agriculture and Forestry – **New Delhi**
- SEMICON India 2026 – **New Delhi**
  (Theme – "Silicon to Systems: Building the Ecosystem")
  (The exhibition features 6 country pavilions representing Japan, South Korea, Malaysia, Netherlands, Singapore & Sweden, and 12 State Government pavilions)
- 81st Session of UN General Assembly – **New York, US**
  (Theme - "Restoring Trust, Managing Transformation: A United Nations that Delivers for All")
  (Indian delegation led by - External Affairs Minister Dr S. Jaishankar)
- Global Conservation Conference of the World Wide Fund for Nature (WWF) – **Jaipur, Rajasthan**
- G20 Energy Abundance Ministerial Meeting – **Houston, USA**
- International Conference on 'The Future of Environment and Climate Dynamics' – **New Delhi**

- 3rd National Conference of Anti-Narcotics Task Force (ANTF) Heads of States and UTs – **New Delhi**
  (Theme – "United Resolve, Shared Responsibility" | Organised by - Narcotics Control Bureau)
- International Conference on 'The Future of Environment and Climate Dynamics' – **New Delhi**
  (Organised by – National Green Tribunal)
- 25th Meeting of Ministers of the SCO Member States Responsible for Foreign Economic and Trade Activities – **Dushanbe**, **Tajikistan**
  (The next Ministerial Meeting will be held in 2027 in Uzbekistan.
- 1st Global Capability Centre (GCC) of Starbucks in India – **Chennai, Tamil Nadu**

❖ Some Important Species found in September 2026:

- "Doronicum Sanctum", a new species of sunflower – Tawang, Arunachal Pradesh
- "Osbeckia ulotricha", a new species of plant – discovered in Kerala-Tamil Nadu Region
- "Gangaichthys Indonepalicus", a new species of subterranean earthworm eel (1st Subterranean Fish) – discovered in Indo-Gangetic Basin, Bihar
- "Ophiopogon japonicus (Thunb) Ker Gawl", a species of small grass-like herb – found in India for the first time in West Kameng district, Arunachal Pradesh
- "Gegeneophis chandgadi", a new species of legless amphibian – discovered in Maharashtra's Western Ghats
- "Ingerana Aizawl" & "Duttaphrynus phawngpui", two news species of frogs – discovered in Mizoram
- "Leopardus tilcayo" (aka. tilcayo cat), a new species of small wild cat – discovered in Bolivia
  (The discovery marks the first time in over a century that a brand-new living feline species has been formally described, since the pampas cat was identified in 1923)
- "Buellia maharajensis", a new species of rock-dwelling Lichen – discovered in Mathikettan Shola National Park, Kerala

❖ Appointments of some Important Brand Ambassadors in September 2026:

- Shah Rukh Khan – Brand Ambassador of Vodafone Idea (while launching its changed logo to "Vi" from "V!")
- Sachin Tendulkar – Brand Ambassador of Kissht (for its 'Loans Without Any Hiccups' campaign)

❖ Grand Prix Winners in September 2026:

- "Dutch Grand Prix 2026" – Lando Norris (British-Belgian – McLaren)
- "Italian Grand Prix 2026" – Kimi Antonelli (Italian - Mercedes)

❖ Some Important Acquisitions & Mergers in September 2026:

- InsuranceDekho and RenewBuy have officially merged to establish India's largest AI-enabled insurance distribution platform by premium generated via point-of-sales persons (PoSP).

- Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) has announced a definitive agreement to acquire 100% of Porsche AG's IT and management consulting subsidiary, MHP Management- und IT-Beratung GmbH (MHP), for an enterprise value of €320 million (approx. ₹3,573 crore). Alongside this acquisition, TCS and Porsche have entered a massive 5-year strategic partnership valued at €1.25 billion (approx. $1.5 billion), anchoring Porsche as a major client for the Indian IT giant.

- ICICI Bank has completed the acquisition of an additional 2% equity stake in its subsidiary, ICICI Prudential Life Insurance Company, for an aggregate consideration of ₹1,470 crore.

- Udaan has acquired LYNK Logistics Limited (LYNK), Swiggy's wholly-owned, technology-driven retail distribution platform, for ₹500 crore. The transaction will be settled through the issuance of preference equity shares to Swiggy in Trustroot Internet Private Limited (TIPL), the parent entity of Udaan. As part of the transaction, Swiggy will acquire about 2.8% stake in Udaan and make a primary equity investment of ₹75 crore in TIPL for an additional 0.4% stake in Udaan.

- Novartis India has acquired the Minipress and Minipres trademarks in India and certain related intellectual property rights from Pfizer Inc and Pfizer Products Inc for Rs 1,250 crore.

- RBI approved Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC) to acquire an aggregate holding of up to 9.99% of the paid-up share capital or voting rights in ICICI Bank.

- ICICI Prudential Asset Management Company has received approval from RBI to acquire aggregate holding of up to 9.95% in four banks - CSB Bank, DCB Bank, Kotak Mahindra Bank and AU Small Finance Bank.

- CCI officially approved the acquisition of 3 prominent cricket franchises under the "Royals" umbrella. The $1.65 billion (~₹15,600 crore) deal involves the takeover of the Rajasthan Royals (Indian Premier League), the Paarl Royals (South Africa's SA20), and the Barbados Royals (Caribbean Premier League). The teams are being acquired by Westview Cricket Limited (a UK-registered investment vehicle owned by the billionaire Lakshmi Mittal family), alongside Poonawalla Sports and Fitness Private Limited, which is wholly owned by Adar Poonawalla.

- Jammu and Kashmir (J&K) Bank signed an independent escrow agreement to sell its 0.5% stake in PNB MetLife India Insurance Company Ltd to MetLife International Holdings, LLC for ₹120.10 crore.

- Mastercard has officially exited Indian merchant commerce platform Pine Labs by offloading its entire 4.31% stake for ₹933.57 crore through a series of open-market block deals on the BSE.

❖ Do not miss to study our "Smart Topic-wise PDF" that includes following topics:

- National Parks / Wildlife Sanctuaries / Tiger Reserves
- Miscellaneous News & Current Static GK
- Appointments (One-liner format)
- Awards & Recognitions (One-liner format)
- India's Ranks in various Reports/Indexes (One-liner format)
- Venues & Themes of All Important Meetings/Summits/Conferences (It includes some extra events too.)
- MoUs, Collaborations & Partnerships (One-liner format)
- Latest GDP Predictions by various organisations (tabular format)

Important Books & Authors	
"Sankalp Se Siddhi Ka Modi Yug" (Released by - VP C. P. Radhakrishnan)	Ghanshyam Tiwari
"Africa Before America"	Arindam Chaudhuri
"Memorable Trials, Unforgettable Cases" (Kannada and English editions of the book were officially released in Shivamogga, Karnataka recently.)	H.N. Nagamohan Das (former Karnataka High Court Judge)
"Kaho Kalidasa!" (Released by – Union Minister Gajendra Singh Shekhawat)	Yugal Joshi
"Bhupen Hazarika: Hundred Years of a Wandering Songs" (Released by - VP C. P. Radhakrishnan)	Ankuran Dutta & Nani Gopal Mahanta
"The Audacity of Being" a memoir-in-essays	Shefali Shah (Indian actor)
"A Century of Service - The RSS in 100 Acts of Seva" (Released by - VP C. P. Radhakrishnan)	Dr. Tamilisai Soundararajan

Important Days	
September	World Alzheimer's Month (since 2012)
September 1-7	National Nutrition Week
September 2	World Coconut Day (Theme - "Coconuts in Times of Uncertainty: Securing Food, Energy, and Livelihoods")
September 3	Skyscraper Day (The day marks the birthday of Louis Sullivan, the father of the modern skyscraper.)
September 4	National Wildlife Day (It is observed twice a year on February 22 and September 4.)
September 5	National Teachers' Day (The day mark the birth anniversary of Dr. Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan, 1st Vice-President and 2nd President of India.)
	UN International Day of Charity (The day commemorates the death anniversary of Mother Teresa.)
	International Vulture Day (1st Saturday of Sep)
September 7	UN International Day of Clean Air for Blue Skies (Theme - "Clean Air for Climate Action")
	UN International Day of Police Cooperation (since 2023) (Theme - "Protecting against Vulnerability – Building Trust and Legitimacy in Policing.")
	World Duchenne Awareness Day (Theme - "Access Changes Lives") (Duchenne Muscular Dystrophy (DMD) is a rare progressive disorder. People with DMD are missing muscle-protecting protein.)
	UN International Day of Clean Air for Blue Skies (since 2020) (Theme – "Clean Air, Healthy Choices: Acting Together for People and Planet")
September 8	International Literacy Day (Theme – "Literacy for People, the Planet and Prosperity.") (UNESCO's global International Literacy Day celebration will be held on September 8 and 9, 2026, in Chiapas, Mexico.)

September 9	International Day to Protect Education from Attack (Theme – "Can Education Survive Attack? The Resilience of Human Communities")
	Himalaya Diwas
	World Electric Vehicle (EV) Day (Theme - "Switching Electric: Driving Down the Cost of Motoring")
September 10	World Suicide Prevention Day (Triennial Theme – "Changing the Narrative on Suicide")
September 11	Digvijay Diwas (to commemorate Swami Vivekananda's iconic and historic address at the World's Parliament of Religions in Chicago in 1893)
	National Forest Martyrs Day (Theme – "Remembering Martyrs, Protecting Forests") (The Khejarli Massacre (1730): The date commemorates a tragic event in Khejarli village, Rajasthan, where 363 members of the Bishnoi community, led by Amrita Devi, gave their lives to protect sacred Khejri trees from being cut down on the orders of the Maharaja of Jodhpur.)
September 12	International Day for South-South Cooperation (Theme – "Solidarity Rising: Global Alliance for Inclusive and Innovative Development.")
September 13	World First Aid Day (2nd Saturday of Sep) (Theme – "First Aid in Migration Contexts")
September 14	National Hindi Diwas (since 1953) (On 14 September, 1949, the Constituent Assembly of India officially adopted Hindi written in the Devanagari script as the official language of the Republic of India under Article 343.)
September 15	International Day of Democracy (Theme – "Bring Human Rights Into Focus")
	National Engineer's Day (The day marks the birth anniversary of the legendary engineer and statesman, Bharat Ratna Sir Mokshagundam Visvesvaraya.)
September 16	International Day for the Preservation of the Ozone Layer or World Ozone Day (Theme – "Global Action For A Cooler Planet"
	International Day for Interventional Cardiology
	International Day of Science, Technology and Innovation for the South
September 7-11	4th edition of Sparsh Week (by Axis Bank) (Theme – "Act with Speed")
September 17	World Patient Safety Day (Theme – "Safe Care for Noncommunicable Diseases")
	77th Raising Day of Indian Defence Service of Engineers (IDSE) (Theme – "Ethics, Accountability and Excellence Towards Achieving the Aim of Viksit Bharat @2047")
September 18	International Equal Pay Day
	World Bamboo Day (Theme – "Bamboo Beyond Borders")
	World Water Monitoring Day (Theme – "Water and Gender")
September 19	International Red Panda Day (3rd Saturday of Sep)
September 20	World Cleanup Day (Theme – "From Clean Plates to Clean Cities")
September 21	International Day of Peace (Theme – "Invest in Peace - For Everyone, Everywhere, Every Day")
	World Alzheimer's Day (Theme – "The Earlier You Know, The More You Can Do: A Dementia Diagnosis Matters.")

September 22	World Car-free Day
	World Rhino Day (Theme – "Keep the Five Alive")
	World Rose Day (Theme - "Bring Hope and Support")
September 21-27	International Week of Deaf People (Theme – "Declaring Deaf People's Human Rights")
September 22-26	9th India International Water Week (in New Delhi) (Theme – "Climate Resilient Water Management")
September 26	World Contraception Day (Theme – "No Barriers, Just Choices.")
	World Environmental Health Day (Theme – "Environmental Health: Standing with Science to Protect Communities.")
September 17-23	6th National Pharmacovigilance Week
September 23	UN International Day of Sign Languages (since 2018) (Theme – "Declaring Deaf People's Human Rights")
	11th National Ayurveda Day (Theme – "Ayurveda for a Healthier Tomorrow")
September 24	World Maritime Day (Theme – "From Policy to Practice: Powering Maritime Excellence")
	National Service Scheme (NSS) Day (Theme – "Service, Sacrifice, Society, Future")
September 25	World Pharmacists Day (Theme – "Empowering Pharmacists For Healthier Futures")
	Antyodaya Diwas 2026 (marking 110th birth anniversary of the visionary thinker and leader Pandit Deendayal Upadhyaya)
September 26	International Day for the Total Elimination of Nuclear Weapons (Theme – "A World United for Peace and Disarmament")
September 27	World Tourism Day (Theme – "Digital Agenda and Artificial Intelligence to Redesign Tourism")
	28th anniversary of Google (with a special, retro-themed Google Doodle) (Although Google was officially incorporated on September 4, 1998, the company has celebrated its official birthday on September 27 since 2006.)
	World Rivers Day (4th Sunday of Sep)
September 28	22nd Formation Day of National Disaster Management Authority (NDMA) (Theme – "Risk Reduction in Action")
	International Day for Universal Access to Information (by UNESCO)
	World Rabies Day (since 2007) (Theme – "Stronger Together")
	International Day of Deaf (last Sunday of Sep)
September 29	International Day of Awareness of Food Loss and Waste (IDAFLW) (Co-convened by = FAO + UNEP)
	World Heart Day (by World Heart Federation + WHO) (Theme – "Don't Miss a Beat")
September 30	International Translation Day (Theme – "Linguistic Diversity and Language Rights")

A GLIMPSE OF SOME GENUINE TESTIMONIALS



I followed Smartkeeda CA MockDrills, and it helped me in securing good marks in the exam. Weekly tests and daily test is really a very good way of retaining current affairs....

Shivani Sharma

RRB PO 2025



According to me, CA Mockdrills are such a blessing for every banking aspirant. I used to read CA Mockdrills for the last 6 months. I have been preparing since 2022,...

Tirtharaj Paul

RRB PO 2025



Smartkeeda Mockdrills and Sectionals were a game-changer!! Especially the AI based revision method. CA can be recalled only by repeating and recalling whic...

SAPTORSHI CHOUDHURY

RRB CLERK 2025



I used CA Mockdrills in my daily routine as I got rejected last year. This is the time, because of the CA Mock Drill, that I achieved my milestone. Thank You Smartkeeda!

Sourabh Sarkar

RRB CLERK 2025



CA Mockdrill was really a game-changer for me. I don't know how to thanks Smartkeeda. I started my preparation in 2023 and now finally cleared RRB PO and S...

Prem Pandit

SBI CLERK 2025



Cleared IBPS PO ✅ Cleared RRB PO ✅ A big thank you to Smartkeeda CA MockDrills for playing a crucial role in my preparation journey 🙏 The quality questions, real exam...

RISHAV RAJ

IBPS PO & RRB PO 2025



Smartkeeda is really helpful. Especially, the CA Mockdrill Pro. The Mockdrill Pro is a wonderful product, and because of this, I was able to recall GA in the Mains exams...

Nikhil Bajaj

RRB PO 2025



I took Smartkeeda CA Mockdrills especially..It helped me alot to secure above average marks this year... Smartkeeda is best source for Current Affairs.

Shambhavi Srivastava

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